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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Tuesday, 18th November, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 12:16 p.m.*

[THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN
SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN, IN
THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

The Speaker: Hon Members, the message that we had changed the Sitting time to 10:00 a.m. this morning, did not reach many. I got to know about it not long ago. I knew we were going to start at 2:00 p.m., so I am not surprised that a lot of your Colleagues are not present. So, we would not take many of the items. But I am told it was as a result of some good reason that the House in adjourning, decided that we should start at 10:00 a.m.

We would move straight to those issues. We would start and I am sure many more Members would come and join. In the meantime, we would do the usual by taking the item numbered 6, which is the Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*. After that, I would hand over to the First Deputy Speaker and rush to a very important meeting.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I am told that some consultations have taken place on both Sides and we have an understanding that we could vary the order of Business and lay some Reports even before we take the *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

Mr Speaker, if you would indulge us, we would want to vary the order of Business and move on to the item numbered 20—Presentation of Papers, that is item 10.

The Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, we have no objection. This is what we have been expecting the Majority Leader to be doing. On that score, we have no objection; he should go ahead and take his Business.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, leave is granted. We vary the order of Business and go straight to item 10 on the *Order Paper* which is at page 5. At the commencement of Public Business, Presentation of Papers.

First Deputy Speaker, please prepare to take the Chair. Yes, Alhaji Habib Iddrisu?

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu): Mr Speaker, with your leave, since you are the Chairperson of the item numbered 10 (a), which Paper is to be laid, as a Member, can I do that on your behalf?

The Speaker: Yes, you have my permission to do so.

PAPERS

By the First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu) on behalf of the Chairperson—

Report of the Committee of Selection on the Re-composition of the Membership of the Standing and Select Committees.

The Speaker: We would take item 10 (b). With your kind permission, all would be laid together and that is from item (i) to (x). It would all be read and captured by the *Hansard*. The Chairperson of the Committee needs to bow once—

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we admire the convenience except to come under Order 97 (3), specific to item 10 (b) (viii), if the Chairperson could give a short explanatory note.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

The Speaker: Please, the First Deputy Speaker is to take the Chair.

Yes, give the explanatory note on those items and then they can be laid.

12:24 p.m. — [HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE CHAIR]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Isaac Adongo?

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, it is a statutory Report filed by the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) on the work of the entity's audit committee.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, still under Order 97(3), if the Chairperson could further give an explanatory note on item (ix).

The First Deputy Speaker: That is on page 6—

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, in 2024, the Government of Ghana (GoG) signed an Agreement to implement the Integrated Tax Administration System which subsequently became a structural benchmark for our International Monetary Fund Programme (IMF).

Unfortunately, that was not carried through. The IMF was consistent with its earlier pronouncement that, this is very important to the success of the Programme and graduated it to become a prior action for the next Board meeting. As a result, the Minister has come to seek the approval of this House under Article 181 (5) for the approval to proceed to sign and implement the Agreement.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

12:26 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): I appreciate the response of the Chairperson. Consequentially,

would he also want to do item numbered x in addition to ix?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, what are the items that you would want him to explain? Because I intend that we take all the items together.

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, towards the latter part of 2024, the Government caused an addendum to the original master agreement for that same consultancy. In the addendum, the Government committed to providing tax exemption for the implementation of the master agreement.

Therefore, the Minister for Finance has come here to seek the approval of the House to enable him implement the *Addendum* that was signed to the agreement.

Mr Speaker, I so submit.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, so can we take all items numbered 10 (b) together?

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, can you get the Minority Chief Whip to get up and bow and demonstrate to us how the bowing should be done? —*[Laughter]*— we want him to get up and bow and demonstrate to us how bowing should be done, so that we will have the standard of bowing in this Chamber.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, in the circumstances, I would not do that because when he gets up to bow, it would look like he is the one laying the Papers— *[Laughter]*

Yes, Table Office?

By the Chairman of the Committee—

- (i) Report of the Finance Committee on the Annual Report on the Management of the Energy Sector Levies and Accounts for the Year 2024.
- (ii) Report of the Finance Committee on the Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Finance for the Period January to December, 2024.
- (iii) Report of the Finance Committee on the Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Securities and Exchange Commission for the year 2024.
- (iv) Report of the Finance Committee on the Annual Report on Public Private Partnership Projects for the year 2024.
- (v) Report of the Finance Committee on the Annual Report on the Collection and Utilisation of the African Union Import Levy for the 2025 Fiscal Year.
- (vi) Report of the Finance Committee on the Annual Report on the Petroleum Funds for the 2025 Fiscal Year.
- (vii) Report of the Finance Committee on the Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Lottery Authority for the year 2024.

- (viii) Report of the Finance Committee on the Contract Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Finance/ Ghana Revenue Authority) and Truedare Investment Limited for the provision of Publican Digital Inspection Solution to modernise customs administration and enhance revenue mobilisation.
- (ix) Report of the Finance Committee on the Master Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Finance/ Ghana Revenue Authority) and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd for Professional Services.
- (x) Report of the Finance Committee on the Request for Waiver of 20 percent Withholding Tax on the Income of Tata Consultancy Service Limited (as Service Provider) and Value Added Tax (VAT) amounting to the Ghana cedi equivalent of ten million, four hundred and sixty thousand United States dollars (US\$10,460,000.00) on Imported Services under the implementation of the Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS) Project.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, all the Reports numbered item 10(b), I to x are all duly presented and they are for distribution to Hon Members.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we can go back to the *Votes and Proceedings* now.

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, item numbered six, Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Reports*. I hold in my hand the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 14th November, 2025 for your corrections.

Page 1...16—

Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, thank you. I wonder why Hon Kwame Governs Agbodza was marked absent, because he is one of the Ministers that is always here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Table Office, kindly take note.

Yes, Hon Kwame Governs Agbodza?

Mr Kwame Governs Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I agree with her saying that I am regularly here, but I was not here on Friday, so I was absent.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, Thank you very much.

Page 17...18—

Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you. On page 18, item numbered xx, I plead that we replace the words “His Lordship” with “Her Ladyship”, before Lovelace Johnson.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, take note.

Page 19...25—

Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, item numbered 3 (iv), “Director Atlantic Life Sciences”, I propose that we add the word “Limited”, as has been done before.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, take note.

Page 26—

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah: Mr Speaker, thank you. Page 25, item numbered 3 (i), my name is Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah and the same applies to page 26, item numbered 3(i)

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, take note.

Page 27... 30.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 14th, November, 2025 as corrected, is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

12:36 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have the *Official Report* of Thursday, 6th November 2025, for correction.

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Thursday, 6th November, 2025.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we want to take the Motion numbered 12, which is a procedural Motion. Mr Speaker, the Rt Hon Speaker is the Chairman of the Committee, and before he took a short break, he granted the Hon First Deputy Minority Whip the authority to handle the Business on his behalf. So, by extension, if you would allow the Hon First Deputy Minority Whip to take the Motion Numbered 12.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Members, before coming to that, let me crave your indulgence to acknowledge the presence of visitors in our midst. First on the list is the Council of African Youth Advocacy. They are led by Ms Matilda Anabila. They are from Nkwanta and they are 36 in number.

The second group is the Christ Ambassadors, led by Ms Angela Amorkor. They are from Ablekuma and they are 42 in number. We also have Pentecost Preparatory School which is led by Ms Hannah Nai. They are from Madina and they are 64 in number. We

have West African Senior High School which is led by Mr Isaac Yaw Mensah. They are also from Madina and are 37 in number.

[Members of the Council of African Youth Advocacy were acknowledged.]

[Members of the Christ Ambassadors group were acknowledged.]

[Pupils of the Pentecost Preparatory School were acknowledged.]

[Pupils of the West African Senior High School were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, on your behalf, I welcome them to the Parliament of the Republic of Ghana and urge them to have a very fruitful visit to Parliament. Once again, you are welcome.

All right, the item numbered 12, let me hear the Hon First Deputy Minority Whip.

MOTIONS

Suspension of Standing Order 104(1)

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu) *on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee:* Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the adoption

of the Report of the Committee of Selection on the re-composition of the membership of the Standing and Select Committees may be *moved* today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved any seconder?

Deputy Minority Leader (Ms Patricia Appiagyei): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, on the consequential Motion?

Re-Composition of the Membership of the Standing and Select Committees

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu) *on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee:* Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee of Selection on the re-composition of the membership of the Standing and Select Committees.

Mr Speaker, in doing so, I present the Report of the Committee. Mr Speaker, the Committee observed that upon initial composition of the Committee —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Kennedy Nyarko Osei, are you on a point of order?

Mr Kennedy Nyarko Osei: Yes.

Mr Speaker, my Colleague just moved a Motion and Hon Members in the House do not have copies of the Motion moved.

Mr Speaker, it is a Report, so they should make sure that sufficient copies are made.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, are you talking about the Report or the Motion?

Mr Osei: Mr Speaker, the Report.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I heard you say you did not have sufficient copies of the Motion.

Mr Osei: Mr Speaker, I meant to say the Report. So, they should make sure Hon Members have sufficient copies. We need to see whatever it is that is in the Report.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think as at the time they were sharing the Report, my Colleague was not seated. *[Interruption]*—Mr Speaker, the Hon Majority Leader is holding a copy, and I can see that other Colleagues have copies. I have a copy too. So, Mr Speaker, I think they will put it—*[Interruption]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources?

Alhaji Yusif Sulemana: Mr Speaker, we always say that this is a House of records, and we are here to represent our constituents. Whatever happens here, it is for us to also tell our constituents. We come here and certain things happen and yet we do not know what exactly is happening. We are saying that that particular document has to be shared with every Hon Member of Parliament before we proceed. We leave here, and the media asks us questions that we cannot answer. Meanwhile, we were in the Chamber. We should move away from this “Kangaroo” kind of laying things —*[Laughter]*—So, I ask that, Mr Speaker, you ensure that we get copies before we proceed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let me hear the Hon Minority Chief Whip, then I will come to the Hon Majority Leader.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, you can gauge the mood of the House. I am sure it is inadvertent; I am not sure it is intentional that copies are not made available. The Hon First Deputy Minority Whip has spoken to the Clerk, and I know copies are being run, but we do not have the copies yet. I even struggled to get a copy.

So, with that, if the Hon Majority Leader will agree, may I suggest that we take the item numbered 9, and then intermittently, when we have a break or when we find it prudent, we could take that Motion.

But in the meantime, because the reports are not ready, may we suspend that Motion and go and take item 9 instead? Mr Speaker, I humbly suggest.

12:46 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, this small Business that the Rt Hon Speaker assigned Alhaji Habib Iddrisu to perform, Members are up in arms against him. At least, they should allow Alhaji Habib Iddrisu to also “chop some small post”. This is the Rt Hon Speaker’s Committee; it is not Alhaji Habib’s Committee. Alhaji Habib is only trying to help the Speaker out because the Speaker is the Chairman of the Committee of Selection. But given that we do not have enough copies for Hon Member, we will not belabour the point. We will go to item 9(a) so we can commence the commentary on the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Speaker, I believe the ground rules have been agreed on. The number of speakers per day has been agreed on, and the sectoral focus of the debate has been agreed on. I urge Hon Members that even as we had agreed to allow the free flow of debate, let us also be factual in the debate. This is because when we are not factual in the debate, it becomes difficult to allow us to proceed for the purposes of the records. This is the House of records. When Hon Members churn out wrong figures in a debate, in as much as we want the debate to flow freely, we will find Hon Colleagues wanting to stop them so that they can correct the records. So, I urge Hon

Colleagues, that in the debate, let us keep to the records. If Hon Members are clear on the accuracy of their records, I can assure them that Hon Colleagues will not heckle them.

Mr Speaker, we can take item 9(a).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I want the Hon Majority Leader to be relaxed, especially when he is referencing records. We have copies of the Budget and we are going to play back their records to them. That is what we will be seeking to do from today till Friday. Therefore, he should not be livid about records. Their records look beautiful on the face value and we will play those beautiful records to them. However, they should allow the debate to flow. Let us allow the debate to flow. On our Side, we have a beautiful blend. We have wonderful Members of Parliament; first-time Members, who are eager to speak after perusing the Budget. We have a wonderful blend, and one cannot help it but just admire our Side. Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader should not be afraid. We will reference his records and we will play back his record to—Happily, the Hon Minister for Finance is seated here. We want him to be in the House. We will point the inaccuracies to him. Where we have to correct him, we will correct him, so do not be afraid, “Mr Majority Leader”. The Majority Leader should sit, relax in his seat and enjoy the flight.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I am sure everyone knows who is likely to be afraid in this debate. I am sure that, when it comes to records, everybody knows who will be running away from their records. I am just indicating that all Sides—We want the debate to flow, so Members should make sure that they keep to the records. The records are known; they are in the various Budget Statements, Government documents, *et cetera*. We want the debate to flow, but at the same time, we want accuracy, so that we do not find a situation where we want to heckle each other.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we will now commence the commentary on the Statement made by the Hon Minister for Finance on the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Majority Leader and the Minority Leader have given me an indication regarding those nominated to commence today. Hon Members, let me indicate that time has also been accordingly allocated. When I mention the Hon Member's name, I will indicate the time, and I hope the time keepers are up there to do all of us a favour. Hon Members, once your time is up, automatically, your microphone will go off. I am not the one controlling the time.

Let me hear the Hon Member for Asokwa, Ms Patricia Appiagyeyi.

Ms Patricia Appiagyeyi: Mr Speaker, I am happy that you have mentioned the issue of time. I want to

crave your indulgence that once you are seated and moderating the debate, a smooth debate will occur on this floor of Parliament. We require that there would not be unnecessary interruptions when speakers are making the—Because each person will be given the opportunity to make their point at the appropriate time. As much as possible, we must limit our interjections. This is the appeal I want to make to all.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. That is why I believe the Hon Majority Leader is admonishing all of us to keep to the rules.

So, I will start with the Majority Side by giving the floor to the Chairman of the Finance Committee, Mr Isaac Adongo. You have 15 minutes. [*Hear! Hear!*]

STATEMENT

Government's Financial Policy, 2026

Chairman of the Finance Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, it was refreshing to hear my Hon Minority Chief Whip indicate that they will point out any inaccuracies. But what he did not say is that they will praise the President and the Minister for Finance where they feel that the Budget provides better hope than they have seen for many years in this House.

Mr Speaker, I want to thank the Minister for Finance for delivering such an inspiring Statement for the people of Ghana and for the people of Ghana to

have given the mandate to H. E. John Dramani Mahama to refix the mess that this country has been known for, for eight years.

Mr Speaker, we started 2025 with a Budget that was saddled with a number of challenges to the economy. Just to recap, we were running an economy that nobody was willing to give us money because our predecessors have run this economy into a bankruptcy, and all the rating agencies had agreed that we were running a junk economy, and no investor gives money to a junk economy. So, we had to navigate this problem and find a way to finance the development of our country without recourse to those who have given us US\$3 billion a year, and we still could not make use of it. Mr Speaker, in addition to that, we inherited an International Monetary Fund (IMF) programme that had derailed. We had missed most of the benchmarks that we needed to implement and this Government even in the face of the lack of funding had to work very assiduously to ensure that we brought the IMF programme back on track. The country was faced with significant fiscal and external vulnerabilities. We had an economy where for so many years, we were running this economy as if there was free money from people so we were not cutting our coat according to cloth. We were very reckless, to say the least, in borrowing and managing the fiscal space.

Externally, we experienced serious heightened external vulnerabilities. What that meant was that at some point in time, this country had reserves that

could last for 0.8 months, less than two weeks of reserves to manage this economy.

So, we just did not even have the external reserves to import critical essential drugs just to keep us alive. This Government had to deal with such a situation.

12:56 p.m.

Mr Speaker, we were also facing serious monetary crisis. Inflation was all over the place. At some point, inflation in Ghana was 54 per cent. To put that in perspective, if anybody was to give a person money, he needed to get a return that is slightly above inflation. So, if inflation is 54 per cent, it means that for a person to give somebody money, he must give the person 54 per cent plus the margin to cater for a real return. So, a person could not borrow for less than 60 per cent under the Government that we inherited.

Mr Speaker, we also knew that the exchange rate was all over the place. For almost eight years, we had borrowed over US\$60 billion on the market, yet we could not manage the cedi. An amount of US\$60 billion was thrown at the cedi but we ended up with the dollar selling at GH¢17.00. That was the situation we inherited. Mr Speaker, today, some people are complaining that we pumped US\$1.4 billion into this economy and they have never heard it before but they were comfortable to pump US\$60 billion into that economy and they never complained. But Mr Speaker, it is a fact that we never pumped US\$1.4 billion

into the economy. What we put into the economy was forex that was generated by the economy.

Mr Speaker, I have a very simple question. If one sets up a GoldBod and our importers in the country go to the banks and they say that they need, let us say, US\$250 million in one week to import goods into this country, they take that money and they say "GoldBod, can you buy gold with money? Bring us the forex so that we give them the US\$250 million that they need to import", is that money not emanating from the economy? Or is the gold not for Ghana? So, if we decide to use GoldBod to buy gold and make it available to meet their auction in the market, that is not injection of funding into the economy; that is pure intermediation of forex and people who mention intervention do not know that there is what we call "intermediation" in the forex market.

So, on the average, the GoldBod was delivering US\$1billion into the economy to fund forex and people cannot understand why we were able to hold the cedi because we were getting US\$1billion to do that. So, my Hon Brothers who are all over the place talking about injections and interventions, should please revise their notes. We were simply intermediating with resources that were generated by the economy.

Mr Speaker, when we inherited this economy, cocoa, for six months, gave us only US\$500 million. Under the leadership of H.E. John Dramani Mahama, cocoa delivered US\$1.8 billion

in just the same period of six months. I asked the question that what do they want us to do with the US\$1.3 billion extra that we made. So, if we give that money back to the economy, they will say we have injected money. What were they expecting? That we put those monies in our houses? Obviously, we do not need them in our houses; we need them to enable people get forex to import. It is the reason we have been able to manage the forex such that today, one can actually get a dollar for less than GH¢11.

Mr Speaker, having turned the corner and addressed these vulnerabilities, we are now moving to the next phase of the economy under the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana, 2026. In the next phase, we are intending that we would continue to hold the macro-economic variable that we have worked so hard to improve. So, Mr Speaker, in 2026, the inflation that we are seeing would begin to behave again, interest rates and exchange rates will behave, because the people who are managing them are behaving themselves. When one behaves, the economic variables cannot misbehave. *[Hear! Hear!]*

We were in a country where, for eight years, because of recklessness and lack of good behaviour on the part of those managing the economy, all that the variables knew was to misbehave. So, inflation was misbehaving at 54 per cent, but today, inflation is behaving because we are asking inflation to stay within the medium-term bank of eight per cent plus or minus two and they would continue to behave in 2026. Interest rates are

behaving. Now we are able to lend and borrow at 14 per cent. We would continue to ensure that interest rates behave around that figure.

Mr Speaker, the exchange rate has behaved and everybody knows that today, the exchange rates fear to go anywhere near GH¢12 not to talk of GH¢17. It will continue to behave under the new arrangement that we are putting together in 2026. In 2026 we are going to see a drastic transformation of the Ghanaian economy. The Big-Push is to create an enabling environment to renew our infrastructure and transform our economy.

The energy sector is going to see an improvement and transformation. We are going to build new power plants. We are intending to solve the problem of fuel in the generation of energy. As a result, the Hon Minister for Energy and Green Transition and the Hon Minister for Finance are working to ensure that we add another processing plant which should be able to create not less than 150 million standard cubic feet of gas. That will be the transformation that the people of Ghana know.

There will be transformation in aviation. Today, we know that Terminal 2 is not working, so we want to make sure that it works. We will build a concord from Terminal 2 to 3. So, a person can actually come to Ghana through Terminal 2 and if the person needs to transit through Terminal 3, he would just board the concord and be in Terminal 3. We want to build a multi-storey car park for those of us who miss

our flights. This is because any time we get there in the evening, we cannot get to the car park, we want to build multi-storey car parks to ensure that when we are travelling, we have places to park our cars and we would not miss our flights again. Hon Kojo will not miss his flight like he did the last time.

Mr Speaker, in addition to that, we want to make sure that we transform domestic aviation. So, we will expand the Wa and Sunyani Airports, and we will build a new airport in Bolgatanga. *[Hear! Hear!]* That is the work that the President is bringing to Ghana. Again, when our people arrive and they need to rest, we want to put up a state-of-the-art hotel at the heart of Terminal 3, so that people can sleep there, take their flight and go away like we do when we get to Ethiopia and we are able to sleep in Addis Ababa. Today we want to do that here and it takes H. E. John Dramani Mahama to do that for the people of Ghana.

Mr Speaker, we want to spend on social services. We want to improve education. Free Senior High School (S.H.S.) education is good, but what we have forgotten is that if we were having student enrolment of 200,000 and they were using the same infrastructure, and school enrolment increases by three-fold to 600,000 we must provide more schools, educational infrastructure, dormitories and we must be able to improve teaching and learning to accommodate the expanding numbers.

As we speak today, the President has declared that by the time he leaves office,

there would be no grade A, B or C schools. All of them would be schools of Ghana and we would upgrade all of them to a level that we are proud to send our children to. So, if a child goes to a grade C school, there would be no difference between a grade C, B and A school. By doing that, we are expanding the funding to Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund). In this country, they were using GETFund to borrow money called “*Daakye Bonds*”. So, when we give GETFund GH¢3.4 billion, they would take GH¢1.2 billion to service debt and be left with only GH¢2.4 billion. As a result, we were not able to build more basic schools. Today we are giving GETFund GH¢9.9 billion. That is a transformation that would lead to improvement in the provision of quality schools in our communities.

Mr Speaker, we are also aware that there are children with learning difficulties and we want to make sure that those children get free education. So, kids that are learners with disabilities, and kids that are in special schools will be given a special place and funding.

But Mr Speaker, again, on social spending, we have decided that we would provide funding to support the Ghana Medical Trust Fund “*MahamaCares*”. “*MahamaCares*” is the game changer in making sure that communicable diseases are addressed in our country. GH¢3 billion is provided in this Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government of Ghana to ensure that we are able to support the work of “*MahamaCares*”.

1:06 p.m.

Mr Speaker, we are improving the funding of the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) with the objective of making sure that NHIA and the Ministry of Health can retool most of our hospitals. If you go to most of our hospitals today, most of our diagnostic equipment is dead; Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRIs) are not functioning, and there is a difficulty in getting a medical doctor for a prescription because he does not know what is wrong. We need to improve our diagnostic systems. The Government of Ghana, under H. E. John Dramani Mahama, is going to retool all those facilities and provide enhanced capacity to do diagnostics in our hospitals.

Mr Speaker, our security services are going to be retooled. Part of the transformation is that, we want to ensure that our Fire Service, which is almost moribund—when you go there, you would see fire tenders not functioning. When there is a fire outbreak, it is better to look for a bucket than to call the Fire Service. Because when you call them, they would come and join you to watch the fire burn. They do not have capacity. We are procuring more fire tenders so that our firefighters would fight fire instead of watching fire. That is what we are doing for our firefighters.

Mr Speaker, we are collaborating with the private sector to ensure that in 2026 we put together a framework that allows the Fire Service, together with the private sector develop for capacity for our high-rise buildings that are coming

up. Imagine somebody is on the 18th floor of the Bank of Ghana building and there is a fire outbreak, what would happen to that person? We want to provide that capacity so that we can fight fire in our high-rise buildings that are emerging in the Airport City and all over the place. That is the work that we are going to do.

Mr Speaker, again on our security services, we want to retool the Army, provide them with capacity and the resources to be able to protect the external aggression that we may face in the future. Anytime we do not have any external aggression, we tend to forget that the people who can save us is the Army. We want to be ready to fight any aggression that we would get to make sure that our navy and waters are safe—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, conclude.

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, I thank you so much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is now the turn of Mrs Abena Osei-Asare [*Hear! Hear!*]. You have 15 minutes.

Mrs Abena Osei-Asare (NPP — Atiwa East): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to add my comments on the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy. Before I go on, I would just like to correct some mistruth that my Colleague on the other Side just made. He mentioned that we borrowed to the tune of US\$60 billion, unless their 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy is wrong.

Mr Speaker, if we go to paragraph 143, it says US\$49.4 billion, not US\$60 billion. Unless their 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy was wrong. This is the total debt of the country from independence to date. Again, he said he inherited an economy that was in a mess. An economy that was in a mess left GHC1trillion of GDP as against GHC219 billion in 2016. An economy that was in a mess left four months of import cover close to US\$9 billion.

Again, he mentioned that the IMF Programme was derailed. That is not correct and true. We were here when the Minister for Finance mentioned that when he came, he inherited an arrears to the tune of GHC68.7 billion, and based on that, he used it to calculate the deficit. Just last week, he came to correct himself, and I was expecting that he would go back to the numbers and correct them. He said they have validated the arrears of GHC68 billion and it is only GHC47.4 billion that is recognised as arrears. So, if it is GHC47.4 billion that is recognised as arrears, how then does he consistently use GHC6.8 billion to prove a point? They would have to check their data; there is a problem. This boils down to the credibility of the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, and that should be checked. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Speaker, we left a growth of 5.7 per cent. Today, I am happy that their 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, which they claim is on “Resetting for Growth, Jobs and Economic Transformation”—Mr Speaker, what do

you see? Half-year, they have 6.3 per cent of GDP growth, and yet they are claiming that growth at the end of the year would be 4.8 per cent. How is that possible? Half-year, they have a growth rate of 6.3 per cent, and the end of the year, they are saying the growth rate would be 4.8 per cent. I was hoping that when the Minister was reading the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, based on the improvement that they claimed they had seen in the economy, they would adjust that figure to reflect reality. But here we are, he is saying growth rate would still be 4.8 per cent when the half-year is 6.3 per cent.

Mr Speaker, this 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, we are told is transformative. What is transformational about this budget? They are adding close to 50 billion in expenditure to the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy from the 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy. What do we see in the growth numbers? A paltry 0.1 per cent growth. They are forecasting that growth would increase to 4.9 per cent from 4.8 per cent after the *Nkokɔ Nketenket*e Initiative, and after the 200 schools and machinery, and all the things that they are saying they are going to do. Mr Speaker, it is not reflecting in the growth.

I would take you to paragraph 41, table 4 of the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy. Mr Speaker, look at the ECOWAS sub-region growth rate and look at the growth rate of Ghana. These are countries that are on the same level. Benin would grow at 7 per cent in 2025 and in 2026 grow at 6.7 per cent,

Burkina Faso grew at 4 per cent in 2025 and in 2026 4.8 per cent. La Côte d'Ivoire which is very close to us and on the same level, would grow at 6.4 per cent. Here we are in Ghana, 4.8 per cent, and adding 50 billion in expenditure, we are growing at 4.9 per cent when half-year they claimed they are doing 6.3 per cent. The numbers are not telling that story. It is not adding up.

So, if they tell Ghanaians that the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy is focused on growth, and yet the growth numbers they are hoping to achieve with all the inputs they are making, then clearly there is something wrong, and they ought to recheck the numbers.

Mr Speaker, we must ask ourselves why we do see a dip in industry numbers. Industry fell from 7.1 per cent to 3.2 per cent. Do we know why? It is because of the 1D1F that has been cancelled and other growth opportunities that have been taken away from the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy that needed to be continued to make sure that we propel the growth that has begun. Because we closed growth at 5.7 per cent in 2024. Mr Speaker, it is the numbers that they have churned out that I am speaking to, and so the Majority Leader should note that it is the numbers in the book that we are speaking to.

Mr Speaker, let us look at infrastructure. The reason we are not seeing that growth is because of infrastructure. Every infrastructure is infrastructure. So, they cannot tell us the Accra-Kumasi Road would be constructed

in 2027, and that they have funds to construct other equally important roads that they have not begun. Here we are, on the Accra-Kumasi Road, people spend eight good hours. This is a loss of economic time.

We have the Accra-Kumasi Road constructed to a certain rate, and we are asking why they would not complete that one? Yet, they are telling us they would do so in 2027. If the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy is a budget of growth, then they should look at this because it is also very important.

Mr Speaker, one other thing that the teaming youth keep asking is where is the 24-Hour Economy they promised? They promised Ghanaians one job, three people, three shifts. Where is it?

1:16 p.m.

Mr Speaker, when one looks at the funding in the Budget, on one page, he said GH¢90 million, on another page, he said GH¢110 million. So, this is what I am speaking to. Even the numbers in the Budget are not adding up. If this is dear to their heart, and the theme of their Budget is “Growth, Jobs and Economic Transformation”, and the 24-Hour Economy which says, one job, three people, three shifts, and they allocate just GH¢110 million, then clearly, they are just speaking to it and not making sure that it happens.

Mr Speaker, here we are claiming we all see the menace of *galamsey*, but it also has to do with the joblessness. In as much as we try to reduce the menace of

galamsey, the youth were promised jobs, so I expect us to do more. If the theme of the Budget is “Growth, Jobs and Economic Transformation”, then the numbers here are not telling that story because after all is said and done, it the numbers, the money and the allocations that are put into it that would see to the implementation of the policies. So, that has also been found wanting.

Mr Speaker, there is another important thing that I believe that we should all avert our minds to. It has to do with illegal mining, popularly known as *galamsey*. In paragraph 1009 of the Budget, the Hon Minister said that “The devastation cost by illegal mining has gone far beyond economics; it threatens our survival”. That is what the Hon Minister said: “it threatens our survival”. So, if something threatens one's survival, what is the person supposed to do? They are supposed to fight and ensure that they survive. How can one fight it when with the Budget of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources is GH¢2.1 billion, they only allocated the Agency GH¢150 million to fight *galamsey*. Comparing it to the total budgetary allocation minus compensations, the contribution is 0.003 per cent. So, how can they say with such an amount that it goes beyond economics and threatens our survival. Are they telling Ghanaians that they are fighting it or they are just putting out words and playing with Ghanaians?

Mr Speaker, like I said, the *galamsey* issue also has to do with jobs, so I was thinking that beyond that, Government was going to put some moneys into the

alternative livelihoods so that they can take them off the *galamsey* and find some jobs for them to do. In this same Budget, the money that was allocated to the alternative livelihoods is just GH¢35 million which is 1 per cent of the GH¢2.1 billion allocation to the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources. But we all know that the Hon Minister has quoted that this: “threatens our survival.”

Our major rivers are recording very high turbidity levels which is far above the guidelines of the World Health Organization (WHO) for safe drinking water. Our rivers are polluted and they are poisoned. Mr Speaker, the media reports that there is rising stillbirths, there is increased cancer and chronic diseases, our farmlands rendered sterile, and fish stock shrinking and malformed. If they say that it threatens our survival, I do not expect that they will allocate 0.003 per cent of the total Budget allocation to the Ministry into something that threatens our survival.

Mr Speaker, the *galamsey* menace is a war and if it is a war, then this Budget is telling us that it is like we are in the battle field with plastic chairs instead of arms to fight and make sure win the fight. This is because if they spend GH¢150 million which is 7 per cent and 0.003 per cent of the total budget of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources to the fight against *galamsey*, then clearly, it is not a matter of survival; it is just a matter of fluffy words that do not have any meaning. We need to rise above that. This is hurting us; this is killing us; this is poisoning our food so we need to do

something more than that. I expect that before we approve this Budget and pass the Appropriation Bill, the Hon Minister would have amended the moneys allocated to the fight against *galamsey* and also to improve on the alternative livelihood of people who are weaned off *galamsey*. That is when they can tell me that this is really threatening our survival and so they are doing something about it.

Mr Speaker, when all is said and done, I believe that we should have a *galamsey* emergency programme with real financing. Mr Speaker, permit to quote one thing H.E. President John Mahama said on 3rd October, 2025. He said that:

“Ghana needs a substantially bigger budget than what is available if the country is to win the fight against illegal mining.”

This was on 3rd October, 2025. The Budget was taken to Cabinet and President Mahama had the opportunity to view the Budget and he knew how much was going to be allocated to the fight against *galamsey* and because of what he said that we needed a substantially bigger budget, I expected that he would advise the Minister for Finance to allocate more than he has allocated to the fight against *galamsey* in the Budget.

Mr Speaker, I am proposing, and I believe that it is the heart desire of our citizens that we can up with a *galamsey* emergency programme with real financing so that we would be able to address this menace. It is killing us; it is

hurting us and that will come back to hurt the economy. It will move beyond the economy to threaten our survival. So, I would ask of you, Mr Speaker, that the House agrees with me that it is something we should do.

Mr Speaker, the last thing that I want to put on record is that I am happy with the Value for Money Office the Minister wants to establish. But I want to advise him that the Public Procurement Authority already has that mandate and is doing that, so why establish another office to incur more cost? The whole idea is good, but there is already an office set up for this. Transformation does not mean new offices. Transformation also means building capacity, giving them what they ought to be given so that they can fight some of these things. I understand the Minister—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, conclude.

Mrs Osei-Asare: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is now the turn of Hon Richard Acheampong. Hon Member, you have 15 minutes.

Mr Richard Acheampong (NDC — Bia East): Thank you, Mr Speaker for the opportunity to comment on the Budget Statement presented by the Hon Minister for Finance.

Mr Speaker, when *galamsey* is mentioned in this country, the only community that readily comes to mind is

Atiwa—[*Laughter*—]so if the Member of Parliament for Atiwa East is admonishing us to fight *galamsey*, I understand her because she is a living witness of *galamsey* activities. So, Government will take action so that we protect our forest and water bodies and at the end of the day, we would all become winners.

Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister requested this House to approve the Budget for him with a projection of GH¢269 billion against an expenditure of GH¢302 billion. I heard my Friends on the other Side say that they are going to tell us our records. When Covid-19 struck, we were comparing numbers within the sub-region but they told us we should not compare numbers within the sub-region. Today, they found it convenient to relate to the numbers within the sub-region.

1:26 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the former Minister is aware; we used to attend these West African Monetary Agency (WAMA) meetings where we discussed the convergence criteria so that we would use a single currency in the sub-region. Many countries are unable to meet the criteria. If the economy is not doing well, how can Ghana alone achieve about 99 per cent of the criteria?

I refer the House to table 5 of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy. The first item is the budget deficit, and the target is 3 per cent, but we have achieved 2.3 per cent. The second is inflation, and the target is 5 per cent. At

the time of preparing this Budget, we were doing 18.7 per cent. Mr Speaker, the target for the Central Bank financing is 10 per cent, but we are doing zero financing, whereas our Brothers took about GH¢60 billion from the Central Bank to finance Government's activities. That was why they ran at a loss. So, if the Government has been able to achieve these criteria, are they saying that the Government is not doing well?

Mr Speaker, let us look at the performance against what was left in 2024. The annual inflation for end of year 2024 was 23.8 per cent. By the end of October, we had recorded 8 per cent. The New Patriotic Party (NPP) left us with -7.9 per cent of fiscal balance percentage of GDP on a commitment basis, but we are reporting 1.5 per cent. The primary balance as a percentage was a -3 per cent and we are doing 1.6 per cent. [**Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah:** Is that cash or commitment?]
—It is commitment; I am coming to the cash.

Mr Speaker, Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah is not comfortable with the numbers but *book no lie*. The next item, which is the primary balance on a cash basis, was -1.2 per cent, and we are doing a 0.7 per cent. The public debt as a percentage of the GDP was 61.8 per cent. Today, we are reporting 45 per cent. Current account balance as a percentage of the GDP, the NPP left us with 2 per cent, and we have done 4.3 per cent. [*Hear! Hear!*] Hon Abena should sit and listen to the numbers.

Mr Speaker, the trade balance was left with 3.8 per cent, but we are doing 7.4 per cent. For gross reserve, they did

US\$9 billion, but we are doing US\$11.4 billion. Lastly, for gross international reserve, we were left with 4 months, but we are doing 4.8 months. And they say they have a record to compare to this?

They just exited power. They should sit back and reflect on their bad performance. They left us in a mess, and now, we have a Minister for Finance who is fixing this mess. Instead of coming together to support the Hon Minister to achieve all the said targets, they are confused, uncomfortable and do not want to support the Government. There must be a paradigm shift. They should forget about this style of opposing the Government. We have been there before, but we were not behaving like they are.

Mr Speaker, so with the revenue the Minister spoke of, where are we going to get the money from? He has put in place revenue measures to rake in more resources for national development. The Minister spoke of tax reforms, which are going to put GH¢5.7 billion into the pockets of individuals and businesses. The zero rating the Minister spoke of regarding the textile industry is going to protect about 2000 jobs, and if these jobs are protected, we are going to create wealth for the people to enable them to support their families, who would in turn pay taxes to the state. These are positive measures put in place in this Budget Statement and Economic Policy.

What we would need from our Brothers is to support the Budget Statement and Economic Policy. So that at the end of the day, if they decide to buy fuel or go to the market, they would not

be asked for their political party cards [**Some Hon Members:** Fuel prices have gone up, are you aware?] But where did his Government leave it?

Mr Speaker, the VAT registration threshold have been increased from GH¢200,000 to GH¢750,000. This means that the Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs), petty traders can also operate by going through that process. So that burden has been taken from their shoulders. This will allow them to gain more resources to put back into their business, increase productivity, and create more jobs. At the end of the day, the economy will expand. So, these are the measures the Minister has put in place to help all of us.

Mr Speaker, the Minister made a statement, and I want to refer the House to paragraph 53 of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy. These are some of the things we want to hear so that all of us will support the Minister to succeed.

Mr Speaker, with your indulgence, I would want to read what the Minister said in paragraph 53 on page 10. It says:

“Mr Speaker, these targets were not mere statistics. They were a solemn pledge to the Ghanaian people that this Government would transform stability into progress, and prudence into prosperity. They represented our shared belief that disciplined management and social protection can go hand in hand.”

Mr Speaker, we cannot give what we do not have. I hear people say that the

Minister is not spending, but all statutory payments have been made. We must cut our coat according to our cloth. So, unlike our Friends who went to the Eurobond market to borrow US\$3 billion and came to organise a kenkey party, after which the former Minister for Finance, after presenting the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, paraded all the staff of the Ministry of Finance to cheer him on—Is that a prudent way of managing such resources?

Yet, we now have a Minister who is so prudent and discipline. We have put our money where our mouth is, and the Minister is spending it on prioritised areas such as education, health and other social interventions. I was happy to hear the Minister was to deploy digital solution for cross-border transactions and trade.

Mr Speaker, a lot of under-invoicing and smuggling are ongoing. Yesterday, I sat in a meeting, and some under-declarations and misclassifications they made amounted to about US\$31 billion. Let us say that the exchange rate is GH¢12; let us multiply that by US\$31 billion. And we go to the IMF to borrow US\$3 billion, and these leakages are going on. So, we have a Minister who has taken the trouble upon himself to do this to ensure that we rake in more revenue. This is something we need to support in the Budget.

I was happy to hear Hon Abena say that she is in love with the value for money office that the Minister is setting up. Mr Speaker, I remember the Finance Committee approved a facility for the

Takoradi market. We requested the value for money report. They said that after the approval, they will bring the report because they had given instructions to the consultant to work on it. It took us more than one year, and we did not receive the report. So, we had to go to the site and inspect the progress of work. After asking them, they said they have received a report and made savings of US\$3 million.

We asked them what we were using the money for, and they said they were going to expand the scope of the project. The question is whether they expanded the scope or not? We cannot tell. But now we are putting up an office which would do all the necessary vetting before approval is given, so that all of us will be clear in our minds on the amount of money to be used to construct 30 stores, if one is going to construct 30 stores. This would be to avoid a situation where they appear before Committees, and after the money is approved, they go and the report never comes back to the House for Members to see if we are getting value for money for the project we are doing.

Mr Speaker, if we can plug all these loopholes, there will be no need to go to the IMF to borrow money. We have a lot of resources, but corruption and wastage are what is killing this country. So, it is about time we came together as a people to fight all these things.

1:36 p.m.

When corruption is mentioned, everyone would be pointing fingers to a politician and Members of Parliament. Meanwhile, we do not have a budget and

we do not sign contracts. The very people who are indulging in corrupt practices are out there, but we are here fighting one another, instead of bringing our fine ideas together to deal with the situation. Because they are in opposition, they do not want the Government to succeed.

At the end of the day, we are all benefiting from all these success stories that are being told. The good administration and management of the economy—now that the US\$1 is equivalent to GH¢12, are we not benefitting?

Last year, in November, when we were going into the elections, a friend borrowed US\$10,000 from somebody in the United States of America (USA) and when the money was transferred, he got GH¢170,000. Today, when the US\$1 came to GH¢10.8, the guy needed only GH¢110,000 to pay the debt. Look at the saving he has made on it without doing any work. Because of the prudent management of the economy, this guy has saved about GH¢70,000. If you do not like this, what do you want again?

They are saying, we have pumped more money into the economy. They did it and it did not yield any results. Now someone is doing it in a refined way and we are seeing the benefits and we do not want to accept it. The Ghanaian people have endorsed it and this Budget has gotten an 82 per cent approval from the public.

Mr Speaker, this is a Budget and a living document that would stand the test

of time and it would benefit all of us. So, the question is, what is the result of all these put together in this Budget?

The Minister is saying that the results are strong economic growth, foreign inflation, a stronger Ghanaian Cedi, improved external buffers, fiscal discipline restored, investor confidence restored, low borrowing, debt reduction from 61 per cent to 41 per cent, social protection expansion and the 24-Hour Economy Policy launched.

I heard Mrs Abena Osei-Asare ask where the 24-Hour Economy is? The 24-Hour Economy is not a stand-alone project. It is not an office; it is ongoing. The Policy has been launched—*[Hear! Hear!]*—They should go the Passport Office, Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA), it is ongoing. So, nobody should expect the 24-Hour Economy as a stand-alone project. No, it is a policy.

The First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, conclude.

Mr Richard Acheampong: It is not a caricature.

Mr Speaker, in concluding—I would call on our Colleagues—they are happy within themselves but it is difficult for them to voice it because they have been whipped in line. Look at how handsome Alhaji Habib Iddrisu is looking this morning. *[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, this is a Budget of hope. It is a Budget that is giving us an inspiration and so we need to support the

Minister to succeed. If he succeeds—*[Hear! Hear!]*

The First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is the turn of Dr Gideon Boako.

Dr Gideon Boako (NPP — Tano North): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity given me to contribute to the debate on the Budget Estimates, 2026, as presented by the Minister for Finance in line with the Constitution.

At a glance, the Budget provides clarity in some aspects with prospects for growth. However, there are grey areas that need serious consideration.

I can see that the 2026 Budget is trying to do something different from the 2025 Budget, by introducing some efficiency measures in the administration of tax in the country with the introduction of Artificial Intelligence (AI) powered systems at the ports. This is a good thing and it reinforces the fact that digitalisation is indeed the way to go as a country.

Mr Speaker, an efficient tax system is not the one with the highest incidence but the one with the most effective systems. We should just make sure that the deployment of AI technology, does not become another profiteering opportunity for nation wreckers through procurement loopholes and corruption.

Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance in the presentation of the 2025 Budget, assume a certain posturing to impugn and make mockery of his predecessors.

Because they missed some targets during their Budget presentation. Today, barely a year down the line, how does Dr Ato Forson feel, when he has also significantly, missed most of his micro fiscal targets as they were the projections in the 2025 Budget. At least, it is estimated that about 50 per cent of the 2025 Budget were missed.

Mr Speaker, even in areas where the Government was able to meet the set targets, there are significant foundational errors that ought to be probed. Take for instance, the area of inflation, by April, 2014, in line with the extended Credit Facility Agreement between the Government of Ghana and the IMF—Certain micro fiscal programmes had been put in place for inflation to peter out and end 2025 with a single digit. This was widely published and communicated by both the IMF and the Bank of Ghana (BoG).

Mr Speaker, I must say that it is refreshing that this Government has stayed put with that arrangement by the previous Government and today we have single digit inflation. I am sure the former Minister for Finance and the former Deputy Minister for Finance, Dr Mohammed Amin Adam and Mrs Abena Osei-Asare respectively, would be happy that the seeds they sowed and watered, have germinated into this single inflation that we are witnessing today. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Despite this development, I have some worries about some of the tools deployed by the current Government to

enhance the single digit inflation and this holds serious consequences for the economy and individuals. I dare say that per the arrangements that were put in place by the previous Government, we were still going to achieve single digit inflation, if this Government had not deployed these tools—*[Interruption]*

Mr Speaker, what tools am I talking about? The Government deployed two main tools in 2025 to enhance the attainment of the single digit inflation. The first is, the sterilisation mechanism from the monetary policy side by the BoG and two, is the excessive fiscal consolidation by the Ministry of Finance anchored on delayed payment and arrears just to let the books look good.

Mr Speaker, what do we say when we mention sterilisation? Sterilisation means that this Government assumed that there was so much money in the pockets of the Ghanaian people and therefore decided to syphon all these monies back into the BoG, depriving households of potential disposable income and increase consumption. That was what the Minister did.

Mr Speaker, if you read paragraph 248 of the Budget Statement, the Minister states,

“To contain monetary expansion, the Bank of Ghana intensified Open Market Operations (OMO) in alignment with its disinflation objectives. Growth in NDA was curtailed through enhanced sterilisation and reductions in Net Claims on Government (NCG).”

Mr Speaker, this is so interesting. The Minister states;

“A total of GH¢62.00 billion was sterilised year-on-year through OMO and forward foreign exchange auctions, helping to stabilise liquidity and maintain monetary discipline”

Mr Speaker, what this effectively means is that GH¢62 billion that should have been available in the pockets of the ordinary Ghanaian for spending, has been syphoned back to the Central Bank by depriving the people that opportunity. *[Interruption]*

Mr Speaker, the interesting thing is that, by December, which is next month, Christmas would be here and I can bet you that, with this activity by the Central Bank, traders would just be sitting by their produce in the scorching sun at the Okaishie Market, Kumasi Central Market, Makola Market and elsewhere—people would just pass by without purchasing anything. Why? This is going to happen because GH¢62 billion that should have gone into the markets and the pockets of people have been siphoned by this Government back into the Central Bank because of sterilisation.

1:46 p.m.

Mr Speaker, traders would be worse off this Christmas and that would have serious consequences on the economy. Has anyone thought of the reason we have single digit inflation yet there is food glut on the market with many other

commodities that people are not buying meanwhile most of these goods which are normal goods have income elasticity of demand in the positive and therefore as income increases, people would buy? We are having single digit inflation and yet people are not buying because there is no money in their pockets. All of these monies have been siphoned through sterilisation to the Central Bank. *[Hear! Hear!]*.

Mr Speaker, the other thing that this Government has done which is also so dangerous is the excessive fiscal consolidation, this is what the Minister calls fiscal discipline.

Mr Speaker, with all due respect, when your incompetencies, combined with poor revenue measures and you are unable to execute your budget, it is not called fiscal discipline rather fiscal indiscipline. Whatever was presented to Parliament and approved must be spent as such if not, it is not discipline but indiscipline and the Minister should know that.

Mr Speaker, what the Minister for Finance has ultimately done, is reduce the fiscal burden by cutting the fiscal expenditure. So, today, if we read from the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, 2026, the goods and services budget was cut by 44 per cent from GH¢5.1 billion to GH¢3.8 billion between quarter 1 and 3.

Capital expenditure was cut by 66 per cent. Approved capital expenditure was 1.5 per cent of GDP, the Minister did only 0.5 per cent. Total expenditure on

commitment basis reduced from GH¢207 billion to GH¢175 billion. A sum of GH¢50 million was promised for the Women's Development Bank but it never materialised; they promised GH¢100 million for CODA's program, it never materialised.

Mr Speaker, from these significant shortfalls and the outturn in the program expenditure for 2025, all that it means is that resources were not delivered to the intended priority areas for the growth of this economy and by so doing, we are impoverishing the people of this country and that is why people are suffering and are unable to buy.

Mr Speaker, it is therefore not surprising that as the Minister was reading the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, 2026, as we looked in the Chamber, his fellow ministers were not happy with him because he is not spending. How can his fellow ministers be happy when they were promised a release of GH¢13 billion for the Big Push Programme and they ended up doing less than that although the Minister had stated falsely in one of the paragraphs that he used GH¢63 billion for Big Push Programme. How can he do that when the Appropriation Act, 2025 (Act 1126) granted them only GH¢13 billion and he came to this Chamber to tell us that he spent more than the Appropriation Law authorised them to. This is wholly untrue.

Mr Speaker, it is important that as I conclude, I would want to remind the Minister for Finance that the best ship is not the one that is designed and anchored

at the port but rather the one that has been set for sail. As it is said in Latin, *vela damus*—We want the Minister for Finance to set this country on sail for proper development and proper economic emancipation and not the *galamsey* budget and *galamsey* economy that we are delivering—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is now the turn of Hon Eric Afful, 15 minutes.

Dr Eric Afful (NDC — Amenfi West): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government.

Mr Speaker, this is the second Budget Statement and Economic Policy of our Government and for that matter, let me commend H.E. John Dramani Mahama for giving us the 2024 Manifesto, “the People's Manifesto” in which we have expressions of some of the provisions, almost all, in the medium-term expenditure framework, which is being expressed in various Budget Statements and Economic Policy, that is the 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy and the pending 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, and future Budget Statements.

Mr Speaker, this is to say that H.E. John Dramani Mahama is not only a truthful President but also a reliable and trustworthy President. The Manifesto gave the National Democratic Congress (NDC) a vote difference of 1.7 million people in favour of the NDC. So, we are going to use the Manifesto within our regime.

Mr Speaker, going to the theme for the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, 2026. I read, “Resetting for Growth, Jobs and Economic Transformation.”

Mr Speaker, it is true that with the 10-month journey in 2025, there has been a transformation in economic recovery in this country and everyone is attesting to this fact. When we go through the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, 2026, it tells us that all the macroeconomic indicators that we set were not only met but they overperformed. They over performed—*[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Speaker, the entire economy grew by 6.3 per cent. It is a fact. These figures are not from the NDC's headquarters. It is from the Ministry of Finance, the nation's ministry.

Mr Speaker, the GDP as I have said, the non-oil GDP grew by 7.8 per cent. In the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, 2026, it was 4.8 billion per cent in 2025. So, it overperformed.

Mr Speaker, as said by most of the previous speakers, we set a target of 11.9 per cent for the inflation rate. That was the target and what do we have today? As at October it was 8 per cent. This is remarkable and this Government should be applauded.

Mr Speaker, going to the food inflation in 2017 or 2024 was 27.8 per cent, it has dropped down to 9.5 per cent. Food inflation in this country—and we know what food inflation does in this

country. So, we are going forward. Non-food inflation also dropped from 20.3 per cent in 2024 fiscal year to only 6.9 per cent as at last month. So, what are we talking about?

Mr Speaker, let me go to gross international reserves. This is very necessary in assessing an economy. As we speak today, the Gross International Reserves stand at US\$11.12 billion and it is about 4.8 months of import cover. Compared to what the New Patriotic Party (NPP) left, it was around US\$8.98 billion and it was about 4.0 import cover. So, you see the vast difference; the vast positive variation that the NDC is bringing on board?

Mr Speaker, the Real Sector performance was also remarkable. The Agricultural sector grew by 6 per cent while the industries also grew by 8.8 per cent. So, these are certain facts that we can come up with to say that the economy is going through a better transformation and recovery.

1:56 p.m.

Mr Speaker, let me lay more emphasis on the Public Debt Development; it is very necessary. They left a debt overhang, even under rebase, it was about GH¢726.7 billion, as of December 2024, which gave us a debt to GDP of 61.8 per cent. What do we see today? Today, the debt overhang of Ghana within only 10 months is GH¢63.2 billion, giving us a debt to GDP ratio of 45 per cent.

Now, let us talk about the net worth of Ghana. When you take the debt from the GDP that we have, what does Ghana have left? Let me put it on record that during their time, the debt to GDP ratio when converted into the net worth of our country, was about 38.2 per cent; that was the worth of Ghana at that time. What do we see today? It is about 55 per cent within only 10 months. So, we are going through an economic recovery within the entire 10 months.

Mr Speaker, let me say that it is only the regime of the National Democratic Congress (NDC) that we have had a negative rate of debt accumulation. In 2024, their debt accumulation was 19.1 per cent; currently, the negative debt accumulation is about -13.3 per cent. We are going back. So, they should learn a lot from the developments that the NDC is bringing on board.

Mr Speaker, this economy is going through what we call diversification. The traditional exports registered a surplus of US\$2.1 billion in the year under review. These are remarkable economic achievements.

Mr Speaker, let us take a look at our currency. What is happening? When we say that in their regime, it was GH¢17 to a dollar, they contest. But today, the cedi to a dollar, is about GH¢10.92. This is a remarkable achievement. Mr Speaker, what this means is that it helps people for proper economic planning. They plan their investment very well. It gives importers and businessmen a stable capital because the cedi is stable.

Mr Speaker, these economic achievements have not only been seen by Ghanaians, but the international world. Fitch rated the Ghanaian economy from a restricted default to a B minus. Moody's upgraded the Ghanaian economy to CA1 (Credit Assessment 1). Standard and Poor's (S&P) rated the Ghanaian economy B minus/ B. These are the economic achievements in this country.

Mr Speaker, International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank have also rated the Ghanaian economy. They just ended an annual programme they had in Washington, and they applauded the Ghanaian economy as one of the fastest-growing economies in the world.

Mr Speaker, let me switch to appropriation and expenditure, it is on record that the Government in the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy has appropriated GH¢357.1 billion for the entire expenditure. In 2025, it was GH¢293.1 billion; this is an achievement. We are increasing it to about GH¢64 billion to seek the welfare of Ghanaians so that we can improve the standard of living of Ghanaians in this country.

Mr Speaker, the capital expenditure within the appropriation will be about GH¢57.5 billion from GH¢ 32.6 billion in 2025, with GH¢ 4.3 billion allocations for road construction, GH¢3.0 billion for the construction of 10 kilometres each in the selected 166 constituencies, which are in dire need of roads.

Mr Speaker, we want to say that when we are able to spend this within the economy of Ghana, it would expand our economy so that there will be a free flow of goods and services in the country. The road construction is going to boost our economy very well because the GH¢30 billion that will be used for the road construction, for Big Push, will connect all regional capitals in this country. Assuming all regional capitals are connected in this country, what will happen? It would increase the way and manner goods and services are transported within the country, therefore boosting the economy of the country.

Mr Speaker, there is something I want to correct. There is an issue in this country, which is a misconception from the Other Side, that the proposal of the Government to increase the remuneration of public workers by 9 per cent, which is abysmal. Please, they should stop this. It would not help. The reason I say this is that, in determining the rate at which salaries are increased in the country, we take a lot of factors into consideration.

The first one is inflation, and what is inflation in this country? It is 8 per cent. We also consider the exchange rate. What is the exchange rate, especially the dollar to Cedi relationship in this country? How much is it today?

Mr Speaker, let me be frank and put it on record that, under the watch of President John Dramani Mahama, we will not sit down for this economy to crash again. We will not sit down for unwarranted liquidity to be put into this

economy, to crash this economy; we would not do that. We would not go back to the previous years; the last 10 years, 2017 to 2024, where there was mismanagement, proper planning which was not in place, which gave an inflation of 54.3 per cent. We would not go there again. We would not go to a situation where the public debt rose to GH¢726.7 billion; we would not go there again.

Mr Speaker, to put on record, when you subtract GH¢122 billion—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, kindly conclude.

Dr Eric Afful: Mr Speaker, when we subtract GH¢726.7 billion from GH¢122 billion we left in 2016, what they added alone was GH¢ 604.7 billion within only 8 years—

2:06 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I am moving to my left. It is now the turn of the Hon Member for Walewale. Hon Member you are speaking for 10 minutes.

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama (NPP — Walewale): Mr Speaker, I listened with rapt attention and with bated breath when the Minister for Finance came before the House to present the state of the economy. I was hoping that the Minister for Finance will fondle my heart, but he rather broke my heart. The Minister for Finance failed to give hope to the people of Ghana. The Minister for Finance failed to speak to the needs of the people of Ghana. The

Minister for Finance failed to address the everyday concerns of the people of Ghana.

Mr Speaker, before I delve into the Budget by the Hon Minister, this is a House of records and people have churned out some figures and some issues which they claim to be facts but are not the facts. They claimed that the Government has done well and they pride themselves in Gross Domestic Product (GDP) growth. They say that the half-year GDP is 6 per cent, but they are not reminding this House that half year in 2024, we grew by 7 per cent. An economy that was badly managed in 2024 half year was growing 7 per cent, and the turnaround is growing at 6.7 per cent. Mr Speaker, that is the record they are saying we should compare. They are saying that they have projected to end the year around 5 per cent, yet we ended the year at 5.7 per cent. That is the record. So, when they are talking about their achievements in respect of GDP growth, I will want them to hasten slowly because the data of this House and the records of this House do not support their claim.

Mr Speaker, they mentioned gross reserve ratio, and the last speaker before me was very emphatic that they were able to improve the gross international reserves. Mr Speaker, we left them with 4 months of import cover in terms of the gross international reserves. They have only done about 0.8 months of import cover, less than one-month addition to the import cover in 10 months. They are not able to even do one month of import cover and they want us to praise them.

Mr Speaker, they talk about net debt accumulation, and that the debt to GDP was around 61 per cent even with rebasing. They have failed to tell this House that they have done virtually nothing about our debt situation. The Government has not done anything about the debt situation. What has culminated into the lower debt to GDP ratio is that we went into a Domestic Debt Exchange Programme (DDEP); we had a debt standstill; we had bilateral and multilateral debt forgiveness, and we were able to renegotiate and send most of our obligation into the future. That is what caused the debt to GDP ratio to fall.

They talked about the fact that they are not borrowing, and that this is the only year we have net debt accumulation. Read pages 185 to 197 in their own Budget. In 2027, they will borrow 8 billion; they are going to borrow 8 billion in 2026, and another 9 billion in 2029 in that Budget for their projects alone. Do they want us to praise them?

Mr Speaker, let me now come to the Minister for Finance. The Minister for Finance in 2025 came to this House and told us that they were going to implement the Big Push programme. They allocated an amount of GH¢13 billion to the Big Push programme. Mr Speaker, in half a year, they have done only GH¢ 7 billion, about 54 per cent of what they promised the people of Ghana. By the end of the year, they are saying they are going to do GH¢10 billion in their Budget. This is far short of the glory of God. The good people of Ghana have been blessed with resources, and we expect the resources to be used for the benefit of the people.

They call that fiscal discipline, Mr Speaker. That is fiscal indiscipline. Why do I say fiscal indiscipline? When a Budget is approved for them, it is our expectation that they have thought through the Budget, and that whatever they proposed in the Budget is supposed to help in developing the country. They cannot come back to tell me that what they budgeted for is not relevant, and that they are not spending on that. It speaks to their incompetence if they come with a budget telling me that they are going to do A-B-C, and then turn around to say that they are not going to spend on that. That is incompetence.

Mr Mahama Ayariga — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we agreed not to interrupt debate, and so far, it has been going well. I urge my Hon Member for Walewale, that as much as he has a right to be passionate, he should be careful with some words. [*Uproar*]

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I know you are paying rapt attention to the submissions of Members. Mr Speaker, knowing who you are, you will not allow what is wrong to pass. Granted that it was wrong, and the Majority Leader was actually drawing your attention— There is nothing wrong with describing the current Government's reign as incompetent. The Hon Member is on all fours. Majority Leader, let me appeal to you. Our Colleagues are eager to speak. This is your point of order. With the greatest of respect, please allow Dr

Mahama to flow, and especially when the man is in full flight. The man was in full flight, and the Hon Majority Leader is clearly pouring cold water on the steam the Member is flowing with. Let me plead with the Hon Majority Leader.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, I hope you know and you can remember the former Minister for Agriculture, Dr Akoto Afriyie. Once you can do that, let us make progress. Dr Mahama, you have the floor.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Thank you, Mr Speaker. May you live long.

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I am happy that I am reminded, but for the lack of a better word, I think “incompetence” describes adequately the conduct before this House and the Budget presented by the Minister for Finance. I have no other word to romanticise the word “incompetence”. I will need a word for that, and if I am guided, I will use that.

Mr Speaker, let me continue. In the 2025 Budget, they told us about what they call the Teacher Dabre Initiative. In 2026, we have not found that initiative, and they did nothing about it in 2025. Is it not deception? They told us that they were doing a 100 Million Coders Programme. In that particular Budget, they failed to deliver. This year, they are repeating that promise. Mr Speaker, they told us that they are doing what they call e-Okada. Mr Speaker, do you remember? *Okada eeh!* [*Laughter*] That promise was found in their Budget. They

did nothing about it. This year, they have said nothing about it in their Budget. Mr Speaker, they told us that they are allocating US\$279 million to Ghana Gold Board. They did nothing about that, and that they are resorting to the printing of money by the Central Bank to finance Ghana Gold Board which they spoke against when they were in power.

Mr Speaker, they are saying that they were going to do what we call Agriculture for Economic Transformation Programme with an allocation of GH¢1.5 billion. They did nothing about that. This year, they have even reduced it to GH¢800 million. This is the record, and this is what they want us to talk to.

Mr Speaker, I will continue. They are allocating US\$100 million to the Adwumawura Programme for 10,000 jobs to be supported.

2:16 p.m.

They did nothing about that, and they allocated an additional GH¢100 million again for this year.

Mr Speaker, they said that they were going to do what they call the Women's Development Bank. The verdict on the Women's Development Bank is out there; GH¢51 billion, they could not do that. They are now promising GH¢401 million for Women's Development Bank. This is the record they wanted to speak of. There is even more.

They are telling us that they want to spend some GH¢270 million to rebase this economy. This Government seems to know where the mouth is, but they do not

know where the pocket is. If they do not know where their pocket is — knowing where one's pocket is, is called saving, and knowing where one's mouth is, is consumption. We want this Government to reorient itself to know where the pocket is and where the mouth is. This is because their own data shows that they spend more on consumption and less on goods and services. They are increasing the wages and salaries of people for them to go and sit in the office and do nothing because they have not provided them with goods and services. That is the verdict of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana.

Mr Speaker, this Government has also budgeted an amount of GH¢150 million to fight *galamsey*. The National Anti-Illegal Mining Operations Secretariat (NAIMOS) has been spending our money. They are yet to even come and account to us that despite the millions they have spent, our water bodies are still polluted and people have stillbirths. They are beating people anyhow across the country. We need this Government to account for the GH¢150 million.

Mr Speaker, this year, they are allocating GH¢110 million for something they said they were not going to budget for, and that the 24-Hour Economy is part of the normal operation and we should not expect a budget line for the 24-Hour Economy. They told us this before this House. The Leader of the House said it. They want us to believe that, that money is not going to be used for consumption. They go on and on with their expenditure and promises. Even at a point, I wondered whether the Minister

for Finance was actually speaking to this House. How would he mention agriculture implements and mention diggers? He mentioned the number of diggers that they are going to acquire, meanwhile they are part of the plan. This is what we call padding of records. We do not pad records to look good; the record must speak for itself and not the use of any scheme to inflate records.

Mr Speaker, there is this thing I would like to run on. The youth of Ghana have been promised jobs, which they have failed to deliver. In this Budget Statement and Economic Policy, they are saying they are going to create 940,000 jobs due to construction work. Is that the work the good people of Ghana are looking for? To get our people recruited as labourers? That is not the work they are looking for.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, conclude.

Dr Mahama: Mr Speaker, with these few words, I would want to remind the Government that promises are promises. When they promise, they should deliver. When they state this in their Budget Statement and Economic Policy, they should deliver, so that we can have hope that in 2026, they will deliver more. With these few words, I thank you, Mr Speaker. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, this would be a convenient time to take the report of the Committee of Selection and get back to the debate. The Motion numbered 13.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, the Motion numbered 13?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Earlier, the challenge had to do with the availability of the report. I am reliably informed that there are copies on the console. I would have opposed this Motion because our Side is really energised to deliver and play back their report to them. So, we will suspend temporarily and revert to take the Motion numbered 13, after which, we will come back to the debate.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, at our pre-Sitting meeting, we agreed on certain modalities.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, there is no issue.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes, the

Motion numbered 13?

MOTIONS

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu) *on behalf of Chairman of the Committee:* Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee of Selection on the re-composition of the membership of the Standing and Select Committees.

Introduction

Pursuant to Orders 205 (3) and 211 of the Standing Orders, the Committee of Selection met and recomposed the Committees of the House

The re-composition was done in order to ensure that the Committees are constituted in accordance with Article 103 of the 1992 Constitution, Orders 204, 209 and 211 of the Standing Orders, and the conventions and practices of the House.

Deliberations

The Committee was guided by the proposed composition of the Majority and Minority Caucuses and the ratio adopted for the composition of Committees and delegations of the House.

The Committee was also guided by Article 103 (5) of the 1992 Constitution and Order 209 of the Standing Orders of the House which require that the composition of the Committees shall, as much as possible, reflect the different shades of opinion in Parliament. The Committee also considered inputs from the Leadership of the two Caucuses.

Observations

Appointment of some Members as Deputy Ministers

The Committee observed that since the submission of its report to the House on 7th March, 2025, some Members have been appointed to positions of Deputy

Ministers of State, particularly Members appointed to serve on the subject matter Committees of which they superintend. In line with the practices of the House, these members cannot serve on the same committees that they superintend, hence the need to recompose such Committees.

Omissions in the Composition of some Committees

The Committee's attention was drawn to omissions in the composition of some Committees. Leadership of the two Caucuses indicated that membership of some of the Committees did not conform to the conventions and practices of the House. They raised issues relating to gender and regional balance in some of the Committees.

Election of New Members of Parliament

The Committee took note of the election of three new Members of Parliament namely:

- Hon Ewurabena Aubynn - MP for Ablekuma North
- Hon Bernard Bediako Baidoo - MP for Akwatia
- Prof Seidu Mahama Alidu - MP for Tamale Central

Whereas Hon Aubynn's election and swearing-in arose from the delayed collation and declaration of election results in the Ablekuma North Constituency, the election of Hon Bernard Bediako Baidoo and Prof Alidu Seidu were a result of bye-elections. The

bye-elections became necessary following the passing away of Hon Ernest Yaw Kumi and Hon Dr Murtala Muhammed Ibrahim.

Streamlining the Membership of some Committees

The Committee observed that the composition of some of the Committees did not conform to the agreed maximum total for the membership of some Committees. The re-composition would help to realign the membership with the maximum number of Members for the respective Committees as provided in the Standing Orders.

Rotation of Hon Members across Committees

The Committee recognised the importance of periodic rotation of

Members across the Committees of the House to ensure a more balanced and a learning experience for Members of Parliament.

In order to support this, the Committee has decided that the membership of the Committees should be recomposed every two years, with the goal of improving the overall effectiveness of the House.

Recommendations and Conclusion

The Committee accordingly submits for the consideration of the House the reconstituted Committees of Parliament as per the attached Appendix I and II.

Respectfully submitted.

APPENDIX 1
STANDING COMMITTEES

COMMITTEE OF SELECTION

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	RT HON ALBAN SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN	CHAIRMAN
3	HON MAHAMA AYARIGA	MEMBER
4	HON ROCKSON-NELSON KWAMI ETSE DAFEAMEKPOR	MEMBER
5	HON COMFORT DOYOE CUDJOE	MEMBER
6	HON EBENEZER OKLETEY TERLABI	MEMBER
7	HON ISAAC ASHAI ODAMTTEN	MEMBER
8	HON KWAME DZUDZORLI GAKPEY	MEMBER
9	HON JEAN-MARIE FORMADI	MEMBER
10	HON WILLIAM AYO NTEBE	MEMBER
11	HON RACHEL OWUSUAA AMMA	MEMBER
12	HON RICHARD KUUIRE	MEMBER
13	HON KWAKU ASANTE-BOATENG	MEMBER
14	HON KOFI AMANKWA-MANU	MEMBER
15	HON HABIB IDDRISU	MEMBER
16	HON NANA ASAFO-ADJEI AYEYEH	MEMBER
17	HON MUSTAPHA USSIF	MEMBER

*Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees***BUSINESS COMMITTEE**

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON MAHAMA AYARIGA	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON KWEKU RICKETTS-HAGAN	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON ROCKSON-NELSON KWAMI ETSE DAFEAMEKPOR	MEMBER
4.	HON COMFORT DOYOE CUDJOE	MEMBER
5.	HON RICHARD ACHEAMPONG	MEMBER
6.	HON MOHAMMED ADAMU RAMADAN	MEMBER
7.	HON THOMAS WINSUM ANABAH (DR)	MEMBER
8.	HON KOFI BENTEH AFFUL	MEMBER
9.	HON HAMZA ADAM (PROF)	MEMBER
10.	HON FRED KWESI AGBENYO	MEMBER
11.	HON BATAGLIA MOHAMMED ISSAH	MEMBER
12.	HON BENJAMIN AYIKU NARTEH	MEMBER
13.	HON ALEXANDER AFENYO-MARKIN	RANKING
14.	HON FRANK ANNOH-DOMPREEH	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON HABIB IDDRISU	MEMBER
16.	HON MAVIS NKANSAH-BOADU	MEMBER
17.	HON NANA OSEI-ADJEI	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

APPOINTMENTS COMMITTEE

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON BERNARD AHIAFOR	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON KWEKU RICKETTS-HAGAN	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON ROCKSON-NELSON KWAMI ETSE DAFEAMEKPOR	MEMBER
4.	HON LAADI AYII AYAMBA	MEMBER
5.	HON FAUSTINA ELIKPLIM AKURUGU	MEMBER
6.	HON SHAIBU MAHAMA	MEMBER
7.	HON ALHASSAN UMAR	MEMBER
8.	HON ALEXANDER AFENYO-MARKIN	RANKING
9.	HON PATRICIA APPIAGYEI	DEPUTY RANKING
10.	HON FRANK ANNOH-DOMPREEH	MEMBER
11.	HON PATRICK YAW BOAMAH	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE OF PRIVILEGES AND IMMUNITIES

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1	HON BERNARD AHIAFOR	CHAIRMAN
2	HON BEDE ANWATAAZUMO ZIEDENG	VICE CHAIRMAN
3	HON AGNES NAA MOMO LARTEY	MEMBER
4	HON MOHAMMED-MUBARAK MUNTAKA (ALHAJI)	MEMBER
5	HON SAMPSON AHI	MEMBER
6	HON HELEN ADJOA NTOSO	MEMBER
7	HON ABLA DZIFA GOMASHIE	MEMBER
8	HON RICHARD GYAN-MENSAH	MEMBER
9	HON GIZELLA TETTEH-AGBOTUI	MEMBER
10	HON JOHN DUMELO	MEMBER
11	HON ALFRED NII KOTEY ASHIE	MEMBER
12	HON RITA ODOLEY SOWAH	MEMBER
13	HON KWABENA OKYERE DARKO-MENSAH	RANKING
14	HON KWADWO DAMOAH	DEPUTY RANKING
15	HON EMMANUEL TOBBIN	MEMBER
16	HON BRYAN ACHEAMPONG	MEMBER
17	HON SAMUEL ABDULAI JINAPOR	MEMBER

STANDING ORDERS COMMITTEE

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	RT HON ALBAN SUMANA K. BAGBIN	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON MAHAMA AYARIGA	MEMBER
3.	HON ERIC OPOKU	MEMBER
4.	HON LYDIA LAMISI AKANVARIBA	MEMBER
5.	HON KWAME OHENE FRIMPONG	MEMBER
6.	HON NELSON KOFI DJABAB	MEMBER
7.	HON DANIEL MAHAMA DUNG	MEMBER
8.	HON EMELIA ARTHUR	MEMBER
9.	HON KWAME GOVERNS AGBODZA	MEMBER
10.	HON FRANK AFRIYIE	MEMBER
11.	HON AHMED IBRAHIM	MEMBER
12.	HON RICHARD KUUIRE	MEMBER
13.	HON ANDREW ASIAMAH-AMOAKO	MEMBER
14.	HON ANTHONY MMIEH	MEMBER
15.	HON CHARLES ASUAKO OWIREDU	MEMBER
16.	HON GEORGE KWAME ABOAGYE	MEMBER
17.	HON FRANCIS KWABENA B. OWUSU- AKYAW	MEMBER

COMMITTEE ON SUBSIDIARY LEGISLATION

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON PATRICK YAW BOAMAH	CHAIRPERSON
2.	HON NANA AGYEI BAFFOUR AWUAH	VICE CHAIRPERSON
3.	HON KENNEDY NYARKO OSEI	MEMBER
4.	HON JOHN DARKO	MEMBER
5.	HON ISAAC YAW OPOKU	MEMBER
6.	HON FRANCIS-XAVIER SOSU	RANKING
7.	HON SEBASTIAN NGMENENSO SANDAARE (DR)	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON JAMES ENU	MEMBER
9.	HON PETER KWASI NORTSU-KOTOE	MEMBER
10.	HON SANJA NANJA	MEMBER
11.	HON MARK KURT NAWAANE (DR)	MEMBER
12.	HON JOYCELYN TETTEH QUARSHIE	MEMBER
13.	HON NICHOLAS AMANKWAH	MEMBER
14.	HON BANDIM ABED-NEGO AZUMAH	MEMBER
15.	HON PROF DR DR(MED) TITUS KOFI BEYUO	MEMBER
16.	HON BATAGLIA MOHAMMED ISSAH	MEMBER
17.	HON EMELIA ANKOMAH	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

HOUSE COMMITTEE

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1	HON ROCKSON-NELSON KWAMI ETSE DAFEAMEKPOR	CHAIRMAN
2	HON FRANK ANNOH-DOMPREH	VICE CHAIRMAN
3	HON CASSIEL ATO BAAH FORSON	MEMBER
4	HON NASER TOURE MAHAMA	MEMBER
5	HON ALHASSAN SAYIBU SUHUYINI	MEMBER
6	HON SULEMANA YUSSIF	MEMBER
7	HON OWEN KWAME FRIMPONG	MEMBER
8	HON GODWIN ANIMLI DORGBADZI-DORANI	MEMBER
9	HON NIKYEMA BILLA ALAMZY	MEMBER
10	HON ISAAC BOMAH NYARKO	MEMBER
11	HON BERNARD BEDIAKO BAIDOO	MEMBER
12	HON ABDUL RAUF TUBAZU	MEMBER
13	HON YAW FRIMPONG ADDO	MEMBER
14	HON ERIC NANA AGYEMANG-PREMPEH	MEMBER
15	HON MUMUNI MUHAMMED NURIDEEN	MEMBER
16	HON YAW OSEI ADUTWUM	MEMBER
17	HON NICHOLAS AMANKWAH	MEMBER

COMMITTEE OF PETITIONS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON KWAME APPIAH KODUA	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON KOFI OBIRI YEBOAH	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON MARTIN KWAKU ADJEI-MENSAH KORSAH	MEMBER
4.	HON DR. NANA AYEW AFRIYIE	MEMBER
5.	HON MATTHEW NYINDAM	MEMBER
6.	HON HARUNA SEIDU	RANKING
7.	HON ARMAH BLAY NYAMEKE	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON ABDUL-RASHID PELPUO	MEMBER
9.	HON JOSEPH BUKARI NIKPE	MEMBER
10.	HON VINCENT OPPONG ASAMOAH	MEMBER
11.	HON CHARLES AGBEVE	MEMBER
12.	HON JOYCELYN QUARSHIE	MEMBER
13.	HON ZANETOR AGYEMAN-RAWLINGS	MEMBER
14.	HON ELIZABETH OFOSU-ADJARE	MEMBER
15.	HON EBENEZER KWAKU ADDO	MEMBER
16.	HON FELIX KWAKYE OFOSU	MEMBER
17.	HON EMMANUEL K. NTEKUNI	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE OF OFFICE OF PROFIT

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ANDREW ASIAMAH AMOAKO	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON JOSEPH FREMPONG	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON RALPH POKU-ADUSEI	MEMBER
4.	HON KWABENA BOATENG	MEMBER
5.	HON ALEXANDER AKWASI ACQUAH	MEMBER
6.	HON ALHASSAN MUMUNI	RANKING MEMBER
7.	HON SOLOMON KUYON	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON YAO GOMADO	MEMBER
9.	HON EMMANUEL KWADWO AGYEKUM	MEMBER
10.	HON ZUWERA IBRAHIMAH MUHAMMED	MEMBER
11.	HON EBENEZER PRINCE ARHIN (DR)	MEMBER
12.	HON SEID MUBARAK	MEMBER
13.	HON JOSEPH AZUMAH	MEMBER
14.	HON JOSEPH KWASI MENSAH	MEMBER
15.	HON EMMANUEL KWASI BEDZRAH	MEMBER

COMMITTEE OF ASSURANCES

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON DOMINIC BINGAB ADUNA NITIWUL	CHAIRPERSON
2.	HON NANA AMPAW KWAME ADDO FREMPONG	VICE CHAIRPERSON
3.	HON JERRY AHMED SHAIB	MEMBER
4.	HON KOFI AHENKORAH MARFO	MEMBER
5.	HON ALHASSAN TAMPULI SULEMANA	MEMBER
6.	HON MUHAMMAD BAWAH BRAIMAH	RANKING
7.	HON ANDREW DARI CHIWITEY	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON QUEENSTAR POKUA SAWYER	MEMBER
9.	HON JOSEPH APPIAH BOATENG	MEMBER
10.	HON MAVIS KUUKUA BISSUE	MEMBER
11.	HON JOSEPH TETTEY AKUERTEH	MEMBER
12.	HON MAXWELL KWAME LUKUTOR	MEMBER
13.	HON MUSTAPHA TANKO AMADU	MEMBER
14.	HON EWURABENA AUBYNN	MEMBER
15.	HON SIMON AMPAABENG KYEREMEH	MEMBER
16.	HON DORCAS AFO TOFFEY	MEMBER
17.	HON MIGYIMAH SHAIBU NUREIN	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

FINANCE COMMITTEE

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ISAAC ADONGO	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON RICHARD ACHEAMPONG	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON KWEKU RICKETTS-HAGAN	MEMBER
4.	HON ERNEST HENRY NORGBEY	MEMBER
5.	HON BISMARCK TETTEH NYARKO	MEMBER
6.	HON RICHARD KWAMI SEFE	MEMBER
7.	HON ADAMS ABDUL-SALAM	MEMBER
8.	HON NASIRA AFRAH GYEKYE	MEMBER
9.	HON ATTA ISSAH	MEMBER
10.	HON ISSA SALIFU TAYLOR	MEMBER
11.	HON LAADI AYII AYAMBA	MEMBER
12.	HON THOMAS WORLANYO TSEKPO	MEMBER
13.	HON SEIDU MAHAMA ALIDU (PROF)	MEMBER
14.	HON MOHAMMED AMIN ADAM	RANKING
15.	HON STEPHEN AMOAH	DEPUTY RANKING
16.	HON GIDEON BOAKO	MEMBER
17.	HON LAURETTE KORKOR ASANTE	MEMBER
18.	HON ISAAC BOAMAH NYARKO	MEMBER
19.	HON TIAH ABDUL KABIRU (DR)	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

PUBLIC ACCOUNTS COMMITTEE

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ABENA OSEI-ASARE	CHAIRPERSON
2.	HON DAVIS OPOKU ANSAH	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON SAMUEL AWUKU	MEMBER
4.	HON AKWASI KONADU	MEMBER
5.	HON ANIM ERNEST YAW	MEMBER
6.	HON DUKE WILLIAM ALLEN KWAME AMOAKO-ATTA OFORI-ATTA	MEMBER
7.	HON SHIRLEY KYEI	MEMBER
8.	HON FRANK YEBOAH	MEMBER
9.	HON SAMUEL ATTA MILLS	RANKING
10.	HON KWAME DZUDZORLI GAKPEY	DEPUTY RANKING
11.	HON QUEENSTAR POKUA SAWYERR	MEMBER
12.	HON MUHAMMAD BAWAH BRAIMAH	MEMBER
13.	HON ALEXANDER ROOSEVELT HOTTORDZE	MEMBER
14.	HON GEOFFREY KINI	MEMBER
15.	HON CLEMENT ABAS APAAK (DR)	MEMBER
16.	HON FREDERICK YAW AHENKWAH	MEMBER
17.	HON GODFRED SEIDU JASAW (DR)	MEMBER
18.	HON MOHAMMED ADAMS SUKPARU	MEMBER
19.	HON DESMOND DE-GRAFT PAITOO	MEMBER
20.	HON PHILLIS NAA KORYOR OKUNOR	MEMBER
21.	HON SIMON AKIBANGE AWORIGO	MEMBER
22.	HON ERIC EDEM AGBANA	MEMBER
23.	HON FAUSTINA ELIKPLIM AKURUGU	MEMBER
24.	HON SEBASTIAN FRED DEH	MEMBER
25.	HON CLETUS SEIDU DAPILAH	MEMBER

COMMITTEE ECONOMY AND DEVELOPMENT

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ERIC AFFUL	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON KOFI ARKO NOKOE	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON ISAAC ADJEI MENSAH	MEMBER
4.	HON JAMES GYAKYE QUAYSON	MEMBER
5.	HON BENJAMIN AYIKU NARTEH	MEMBER
6.	HON ROBERT WISDOM CUDJOE	MEMBER
7.	HON CHARLES ASIEDU	MEMBER
8.	HON EDEM RICHMOND KOFI KPOTOSU	MEMBER
9.	HON EMMANUEL DRAH	MEMBER
10.	HON DANIEL BESSEY	MEMBER
11.	HON ERNESTINA OFORI DANGBEY	MEMBER
12.	HON ERNEST ADOMAKO	MEMBER
13.	HON KOJO OPPONG NKRUMAH	RANKING
14.	HON TWENEBOA KODUA FOKUO	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON FRED KYEI ASAMOAH	MEMBER
16.	HON VINCENT EKOW ASSAFUAH	MEMBER
17.	HON MICHAEL OKYERE BAAFI	MEMBER

COMMITTEE ON ETHICS AND STANDARDS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ANDREW ASIAMAH-AMOAKO	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON KWEKU RICKETTS-HAGAN	VICE CHAIRPERSON
3.	COMFORT DOYOE CUDJOE	MEMBER
4.	HON HARUNA IDDRISU	MEMBER
5.	HON FRANK AFRIYIE	MEMBER
6.	HON SAMUEL NARTEY GEORGE	MEMBER
7.	HON FELIX OKLE AKWETEEY	MEMBER
8.	HON ISAAC AWUKU YIBOR	MEMBER
9.	HON JOHN ADU JACK KWAME	MEMBER
10.	HON REV. KWAKU ADDO	MEMBER
11.	HON EBENEZER ALUMIRE NDEBILLA	MEMBER
12.	HON STANLEY YAW NANDAYA	MEMBER
13.	HON PATRICIA APPIAGYEI	MEMBER
14.	HON PATRICK BOAKYE-YIADOM	MEMBER
15.	HON ABDUL AZIZ FATAHIYA	MEMBER
16.	HON KWAME ANYIMADU ANTWI	MEMBER
17.	HON HABIB IDDRISU	

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON WAYS AND MEANS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON KWEKU RICKETTS-HAGAN	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON PATRICIA APPIAGYEI	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON. ROCKSON-NELSON KWAMI ETSE DAFEAMEKPOR	MEMBER
4.	HON DOMINIC NAPARE	MEMBER
5.	HON SAMUEL OKUDJETO ABLAKWA	MEMBER
6.	HON ANDREW DARI CHIWITEY	MEMBER
7.	HON FELICIA ADJEI	MEMBER
8.	HON DICKSON KYERE-DUAH	MEMBER
9.	HON ALHASSAN SULEMANA	MEMBER
10.	HON KWAMENA MINTA NYARKU (DR)	MEMBER
11.	HON STANLEY YAW NANDAYA	MEMBER
12.	HON FRANK ANNOH-DOMPREEH	MEMBER
13.	HON FREDERICK ADDY	MEMBER
14.	HON ELVIS OSEI MENSAH DAPAAH	MEMBER
15.	HON KWAKU AMPRATWUM-SARPONG	MEMBER
16.	HON COLLINS DAUDA (ALHAJI)	MEMBER
17.	HON HELEN ADJOA NTOSO	MEMBER

COMMITTEE PRIVATE MEMBER'S BILL AND PRIVATE MEMBERS MOTION

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON BENARD AHIAFOR	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON CHARLES BAWADUAH	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON KWABENA MINTAH AKANDOH	MEMBER
4.	HON DOMINIC AKURITINGA AYINE	MEMBER
5.	HON NASSER TOURE MAHAMA	MEMBER
6.	HON JOSEPH KWAME KUMAH	MEMBER
7.	HON ALHASSAN MUMUNI	MEMBER
8.	HON KWAME ASARE OBENG	MEMBER
9.	HON MAHMOUD ISSIFU	MEMBER
10.	HON WORLASI KPELI	MEMBER
11.	HON MOHAMMED-MUBARAK MUNTAKA (ALHAJI)	MEMBER
12.	HON ELIZABETH OFOSU-ADJARE	MEMBER
13.	HON KINGSLEY NYARKO	RANKING
14.	HON DANIEL NANA ADDO-KENNETH	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON COLLINS ADOMAKO MENSAH	MEMBER
16.	HON SETH OSEI-AKOTO	MEMBER
17.	HON ADELAIDE NTIM	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON HUMAN RIGHTS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ERNEST YAW ANIM	CHAIRPERSON
2.	HON KINGSLEY AGYEMANG	VICE-CHAIRMAN
3.	HON JOHN NTIM FORDJOUR	MEMBER
4.	HON FRANCIS ASENSO BOAKYE	MEMBER
5.	HON IDA ADJOA ASIEDU	MEMBER
6.	HON JAMES AGALGA	RANKING
7.	HON ANTHONY MWINKAARA SUMAH	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON MOHAMMED SHERIF ABDUL-KHALIQ (DR)	MEMBER
9.	HON ALBERT TETTEH NYAKOTEY	MEMBER
10.	HON EMMANUEL ARMAH-KOFI BUAH	MEMBER
11.	HON JOHN ABDULAI JINAPOR	MEMBER
12.	HON JOHN KWABENA BLESS OTI	MEMBER
13.	HON LINDA OBENEWAA AKWELEY OCLOO	MEMBER
14.	HON THOMAS AMPEM NYARKO	MEMBER
15.	HON PETER LANCHENE TOOBU	MEMBER
16.	HON KOFI IDDIE ADAMS	MEMBER
17.	HON LAWRENCIA DZIWORNU	MEMBER

BUDGET COMMITTEE

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON KWAKU AGYEMANG KWARTENG	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON AGYARE ALEXANDER	VICE CHAIRPERSON
3.	HON AMA APPIANIMAA SALAM DAMATA	MEMBER
4.	HON FRANK ASIEDU BEKOE	MEMBER
5.	HON AKWASI GYAMFI ONYINA- ACHEAMPONG	MEMBER
6.	HON RICHARD ACHEAMPONG	RANKING
7.	HON SULEMAN ADAMA	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON ALFRED OKOE VANDERPUIJE	MEMBER
9.	HON ISAAC ADONGO	MEMBER
10.	HON KWAME TWUMASI AMPOFO	MEMBER
11.	HON ISSAKA JAJAH	MEMBER
12.	HON OSCAR OFORI LARBI	MEMBER
13.	HON THERESA LARDI AWUNI	MEMBER
14.	HON ALHASSAN KOBINA GHANSAH	MEMBER
15.	HON BRIGHT ASAMOAH BREFO	MEMBER
16.	HON MILLICENT YEBOAH AMANKWAH	MEMBER
17.	HON YAKUBU MOHAMMED	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON BACKBENCHERS' BUSINESS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON CHARLES FORSON	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON GLORIA OWUSU	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON RUDOLF AMOAKO-GYAMPAH	MEMBER
4.	HON LAWRENCE AGYINSAM	MEMBER
5.	HON MICHAEL KWASI AIDOO	MEMBER
6.	HON DAN ABDUL LATIF	RANKING
7.	HON DAVID T. D. VONDEE	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON PIOUS KWAME NKUAH	MEMBER
9.	HON SEDEM KWEKU AFENYO	MEMBER
10.	HON EKOW KWAINOE OTHNIEL	MEMBER
11.	HON EMMANUEL KWAKU BOAM	MEMBER
12.	HON SEIDU ALAJOR	MEMBER
13.	HON MOHAMMED HARUNA	MEMBER
14.	HON ABDUL-FATAWU ALHASSAN	MEMBER
15.	HON MISBAHU MAHAMA ADAMS	MEMBER
16.	HON HENRY GODFRED BENTIL	MEMBER
17.	HON JOANA GYAN CUDJOE	MEMBER

SPECIAL COMMITTEE
(WINNOWER COMMITTEE)

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON MAHAMA AYARIGA	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON ROCKSON-NELSON ETSE KWAMI DAFEAMEKPOR	MEMBER
3.	HON JAMES AGALGA	MEMBER
4.	HON FRANCIS-XAVIER SOSU	MEMBER
5.	HON SHAIBU MAHAMA	MEMBER
6.	HON BISMARCK TETTEH NYARKO	MEMBER
7.	HON PHILIP FIIFI BUCKMAN	MEMBER
8.	HON CHARLES BAWADUAH	MEMBER
9.	HON FRANK ANNOH-DOMPREEH	MEMBER
10.	HON KINGSLEY NYARKO	MEMBER
11.	HON ISAAC BOAMAH NYARKO	MEMBER

APPENDIX 2**SELECT COMMITTEES****COMMITTEE ON GENDER, CHILDREN AND SOCIAL WELFARE**

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON HELEN ADJOA NTOSO	CHAIRPERSON
2.	HON ZUWERA IBRAHIMAH MUHAMMED	VICE CHAIRPERSON
3.	HON COMFORT DOYOE CUDJOE	MEMBER
4.	HON DOMINIC AKURITINGA AYINE	MEMBER
5.	HON RITA NAA ODOLEY SOWAH	MEMBER
6.	HON ABLA DZIFA GOMASHIE	MEMBER
7.	HON FELICIA ADJEI	MEMBER
8.	HON PROF. GRACE AYENSU-DANQUAH	MEMBER
9.	HON RACHEL OWUSUAA AMMA	MEMBER
10.	HON SIMON KYEREMEH AMPAABENG	MEMBER
11.	HON JOHN SETOR DUMELO	MEMBER
12.	HON ANTHONY MWINKAARA SUMAH	MEMBER
13.	HON ADELAIDE NTIM	RANKING
14.	HON ABDUL AZIZ FATAHIYA	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON FREDERICK ADDY	MEMBER
16.	HON NANA OSEI-ADJEI	MEMBER
17.	HON LAURETTE KORKOR ASANTE	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON CONSTITUTIONAL AND LEGAL AFFAIRS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON SHAIBU MAHAMA	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON JAMES ENU	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON JAMES AGALGA	MEMBER
4.	HON SANJA NANJA	MEMBER
5.	HON HAMZA ADAM (PROF)	MEMBER
6.	HON FRANCIS-XAVIER SOSU	MEMBER
7.	HON SAMUEL NARTEY GEORGE	MEMBER
8.	HON BISMARCK TETTEH NYARKO	MEMBER
9.	HON PHILIP FIIFI BUCKMAN	MEMBER
10.	HON KWAME DZUDZORLI GAKPEY	MEMBER
11.	HON JOSEPH APPIAH BOATENG	MEMBER
12.	HON KWAME ANYIMADU-ANTWI	RANKING
13.	HON ALHASSAN TAMPULI SULEMANA	DEPUTY RANKING
14.	HON NANA AGYEI BAFFOUR AWUAH	MEMBER
15.	HON KWAKU ASANTE-BOATENG	MEMBER
16.	HON KOFI OBIRI YEBOAH	MEMBER
17.	HON ANTHONY MMIEH	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON FOOD, AGRICULTURE AND COCOA AFFAIRS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON DR GODFRED SEIDU JASAW (DR)	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON KWAME DZUDZORLI GAKPEY	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON GEOFREY KINI	MEMBER
4.	HON ALHASSAN SULEMANA	MEMBER
5.	HON KWABENA MINTAH AKANDOH	MEMBER
6.	HON ISAAC ASHAI ODAMTTEN	MEMBER
7.	HON BENJAMIN AYIKU NARTEH	MEMBER
8.	HON LINDA OBENEWAA AKWELEY OCLOO	MEMBER
9.	HON JOANA GYAN CUDJOE	MEMBER
10.	HON EBENEZER ALUMIRE NDEBILLA	MEMBER
11.	HON FAUSTINA ELIKPLIM AKURUGU	MEMBER
12.	HON ALHASSAN MUMUNI	MEMBER
13.	HON ISAAC YAW OPOKU	RANKING
14.	HON SETH OSEI-AKOTO	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON YAW FRIMPONG ADDO	MEMBER
16.	HON BRYAN ACHEAMPONG	MEMBER
17.	HON DOMINIC BINGAB ADUNA NITIWUL	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON LANDS AND NATURAL RESOURCES

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON COLLINS DAUDA (ALHAJI)	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON SANJA NANJA	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON JOSEPH TETTEH AKUERTEH	MEMBER
4.	HON SAMUEL ATTA MILLS	MEMBER
5.	HON RICHARD ACHEAMPONG	MEMBER
6.	HON ALHASSAN KOBINA GHANSAH	MEMBER
7.	HON BERNARD BEDIAKO BAIDOO	MEMBER
8.	HON FREDERICK YAW AHENKWAH	MEMBER
9.	HON ALHASSAN SAYIBU SUHUYINI	MEMBER
10.	HON DAVID T.D VONDEE	MEMBER
11.	HON MAXWELL LUKUTOR	MEMBER
12.	HON ARMAH BLAY NYAMEKE	MEMBER
13.	HON KWAKU AMPRATWUM-SARPONG	RANKING
14.	HON AKWASI KONADU	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON MUSTAPHA USSIF	MEMBER
16.	HON FRANCIS KWABENA B. OWUSU-AKYAW	MEMBER
17.	HON KOFI OBIRI YEBOAH	

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON HEALTH

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON MARK KURT NAWAANE (DR)	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON SEBASTIAN NGMENENSO SANDAARE (DR)	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON CHARLES AGBEVE	MEMBER
4.	HON ALEXANDER ROOSEVELT HOTTORDZE	MEMBER
5.	HON MOHAMMED ADAMU RAMADAN	MEMBER
6.	HON MOHAMMED-MUBARAK MUNTAKA (ALHAJI)	MEMBER
7.	HON PHILLIS NAA KORYOO OKUNOR	MEMBER
8.	HON THOMAS WINSUM ANABAH (DR)	MEMBER
9.	HON PROF. DR. DR.(MED) TITUS KOFI BEYUO	MEMBER
10.	HON EBENEZER PRINCE ARHIN (DR)	MEMBER
11.	HON ELIZABETH OFOSU-ADJARE	MEMBER
12.	HON MOHAMMED SHERIF ABDUL-KHALIQ (DR)	MEMBER
13.	HON DR. NANA AYEW AFRIYIE	RANKING
14.	HON PATRICK BOAKYE-YIADOM	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON FRANK YEBOAH	MEMBER
16.	HON KINGSLEY AGYEMANG	MEMBER
17.	HON ALEXANDER AKWASI ACQUAH	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON WORKS AND HOUSING

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON VINCENT OPPONG ASAMOAH	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON MOHAMMED ADAMU RAMADAN	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON EMMANUEL KWASI BEDZRAH	MEMBER
4.	HON HARUNA SEIDU	MEMBER
5.	HON RICHARD GYAN-MENSAH	MEMBER
6.	HON ISAAC ADJEI MENSAH	MEMBER
7.	HON SEIDU MAHAMA ALIDU (PROF)	MEMBER
8.	HON ERNEST ADOMAKO	MEMBER
9.	HON EMELIA ANKOMAH	MEMBER
10.	HON PETER LANCHENE TOOBU	MEMBER
11.	HON MOHAMMED HARUNA	MEMBER
12.	HON EMMANUEL DRAH	MEMBER
13.	HON MARTIN KWAKU ADJEI-MENSAH KORSAH	RANKING
14.	HON SHIRLEY KYEI	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON FREDERICK ADDY	MEMBER
16.	HON ALEXANDER AGYARE	MEMBER
17.	HON JOSEPH FREMPONG	MEMBER

COMMITTEE ON LOCAL GOVERNMENT AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON QUEENSTAR POKUA SAWYER	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON CHARLES AGBEVE	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON DOMINIC NAPARE	MEMBER
4.	HON SEBASTIAN NGMENENSO SANDAARE (DR)	MEMBER
5.	HON JOSEPH APPIAH BOATENG	MEMBER
6.	HON GIZELLA TETTEH-AGBOTUI	MEMBER
7.	HON THERESA LARDI AWUNI	MEMBER
8.	HON HARUNA SEIDU	MEMBER
9.	HON ADAMS ABDUL-SALAM	MEMBER
10.	HON ALFRED NII KOTEY ASHIE	MEMBER
11.	HON FRED KWESI AGBENYO	MEMBER
12.	HON FRANK AFRIYIE	MEMBER
13.	HON FRANCIS ASENSO BOAKYE	RANKING
14.	HON ALEXANDER AKWASI ACQUAH	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON ELVIS OSEI MENSAH DAPAAH	MEMBER
16.	HON JERRY AHMED SHAIB	MEMBER
17.	HON JOHN DARKO	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON BANDIM ABED-NEGO AZUMAH	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON DAN ABDUL-LATIF	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON SULEMANA ADAMA	MEMBER
4.	HON ANTHONY MWINKAARA SUMAH	MEMBER
5.	HON DAVID T. D VONDEE	MEMBER
6.	HON ALHASSAN UMAR	MEMBER
7.	HON NELSON KOFI DJABAB	MEMBER
8.	HON FELIX OKLE AKWETAY	MEMBER
9.	HON THOMAS WORLANYO TSEKPO	MEMBER
10.	HON MISBAHU MAHAMA ADAMS	MEMBER
11.	HON SIMON AKIBANGE AWORIGO	MEMBER
12.	HON WORLASI KPELI	MEMBER
13.	HON MATTHEW NYINDAM	RANKING
14.	HON CHARLES ASUAKO OWIREDU	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON MAHAMA TIAH ABDUL KABIRU	MEMBER
16.	HON CHARLES FORSON	MEMBER
17.	HON DAVIS OPOKU ANSAH	MEMBER

COMMITTEE ON FOREIGN AFFAIRS AND REGIONAL INTEGRATION

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ALFRED OKOE VANDERPUIJE	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON CLETUS SEIDU DAPILAH	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON JOYCELYN TETTEH QUARSHIE	MEMBER
4.	HON KWAME GOVERNS AGBODZA	MEMBER
5.	HON OWEN KWAME FRIMPONG	MEMBER
6.	HON ZUWERA MOHAMMED IBRAHIMAH	MEMBER
7.	HON FRANCIS-XAVIER SOSU	MEMBER
8.	HON FELICIA ADJEI	MEMBER
9.	HON OSCAR OFORI LARBI	MEMBER
10.	HON JOSEPH KWAME KUMAH	MEMBER
11.	HON KWAME ASARE OBENG	MEMBER
12.	HON EWURABENA AUBYNN	MEMBER
13.	HON. SAMUEL ABDULAI JINAPOR	RANKING
14.	HON NANA ASAFO-ADJEI AYEYEH	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON LAURETTE KORKOR ASANTE	MEMBER
16.	HON PATRICK YAW BOAMAH	MEMBER
17.	HON DANIEL NANA ADDO-KENNETH	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON EMPLOYMENT, LABOUR RELATIONS AND PENSIONS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON JOSEPH APPIAH BOATENG	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON ISAAC ASHAI ODAMTTEN	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON RICHARD ACHEAMPONG	MEMBER
4.	HON ALHASSAN UMAR	MEMBER
5.	HON PETER KWASI NORTSU-KOTOE	MEMBER
6.	HON ALFRED OKOE VANDERPUIJE	MEMBER
7.	HON ZANETOR AGYEMAN-RAWLINGS	MEMBER
8.	HON BERNARD AHIAFOR	MEMBER
9.	HON EMMANUEL BOAM	MEMBER
10.	HON DESMOND DE-GRAFT PAITOO	MEMBER
11.	HON ROBERT WISDOM CUDJOE	MEMBER
12.	HON MILLICENT YEBOAH AMANKWAH	MEMBER
13.	HON MAVIS NKANSAH-BOADU	RANKING
14.	HON FRANK ASIEDU BEKOE	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON TWENEBOA KODUA FOKUO	MEMBER
16.	HON CHARLES FORSON	MEMBER
17.	HON KWAKU AGYEMANG KWARTENG	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON DEFENCE AND INTERIOR

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON JAMES AGALGA	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON PETER LANCHENE TOOBU	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON KWEKU RICKETTS-HAGAN	MEMBER
4.	HON MUHAMMED BAWAH BRAIMAH	MEMBER
5.	HON HELEN ADJOA NTOSO	MEMBER
6.	HON ERNEST HENRY NORGBEY	MEMBER
7.	HON ZANETOR AGYEMANG RAWLINGS (DR)	MEMBER
8.	HON KWAMENA MINTA NYARKU (DR)	MEMBER
9.	HON MAVIS KUUKUA BISSUE	MEMBER
10.	HON MAHMOUD ISSIFU	MEMBER
11.	HON PIOUS KWAME NKUAH	MEMBER
12.	HON NICHOLAS AMANKWAH	MEMBER
13.	HON JOHN NTIM FORDJOUR	RANKING
14.	HON KOFI AMANKWA-MANU	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON ERIC NANA AGYEMANG-PREMPEH	MEMBER
16.	HON IDA ADJOA ASIEDU	MEMBER
17.	HON MUMUNI MUHAMMED NURIDEEN	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON TRADE, INDUSTRY AND TOURISM

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ALEXANDER ROOSEVELT HOTTORDZE	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON FREDERICK YAW AHENKWAH	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON CHARLES AGBEVE	MEMBER
4.	HON EKOW KWAINOE OTHNIEL	MEMBER
5.	HON EMMANUEL K. NTEKUNI	MEMBER
6.	HON SEIDU ALAJOR	MEMBER
7.	HON BRIGHT ASAMOAH BREFO	MEMBER
8.	HON WILLIAM AYO NTEBE	MEMBER
9.	HON BATAGLIA MOHAMMED ISSAH	MEMBER
10.	HON ATTA ISSAH	MEMBER
11.	HON DANIEL MAHAMA DUNG	MEMBER
12.	HON SEBASTIAN FRED DEH	MEMBER
13.	HON MICHAEL OKYERE BAAFI	RANKING
14.	HON RUDOLF AMOAKO-GYAMPAH	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON GIDEON BOAKO	MEMBER
16.	HON LAWRENCE AGYINSAM	MEMBER
17.	HON ADELAIDE NTIM	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON ENVIRONMENT, SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON YAW FRIMPONG ADDO	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON JOHN DARKO	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON DUKE WILLIAM ALLEN KWAME AMOAKO-ATTA OFORI-ATTA	MEMBER
4.	HON ISAAC BOAMAH NYARKO	MEMBER
5.	HON EMMANUEL TOBBIN	MEMBER
6.	HON HAMZA ADAM (PROF)	RANKING
7.	HON YAO GOMADO	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON GODFRED SEIDU JASAW (DR)	MEMBER
9.	HON EBENEZER OKLETEY TERLABI	MEMBER
10.	HON KWAMENA MINTA NYARKU (DR)	MEMBER
11.	HON KOFI BENTEH AFFUL	MEMBER
12.	HON JOSEPH APPIAH BOATENG	MEMBER
13.	HON DICKSON KYERE-DUAH	MEMBER
14.	HON STANLEY YAW NANDAYA	MEMBER
15.	HON REV. KWAKU ADDO	MEMBER
16.	HON MIGYIMAH SHAIKU NUREIN	MEMBER
17.	HON HENRY GODFRED BENTIL	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON EDUCATION

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON PETER KWASI NORTSU-KOTOE	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON JOSEPH KWAME KUMAH	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON COMFORT DOYOE CUDJOE	MEMBER
4.	HON SOLOMON KUYON	MEMBER
5.	HON ABDUL-FATAWU ALHASSAN	MEMBER
6.	HON EDEM RICHMOND KOFI KPOTOSU	MEMBER
7.	HON ERIC EDEM AGBANA	MEMBER
8.	HON NASIRA AFRAH GYEKYE	MEMBER
9.	HON NIKYEMA BILLA ALAMZY	MEMBER
10.	HON DOMINIC NAPARE	MEMBER
11.	HON ERNESTINA OFORI DANGBEY	MEMBER
12.	HON MUHAMMAD BAWAH BRAIMAH	MEMBER
13.	HON YAW OSEI ADUTWUM	RANKING
14.	HON MUSTAPHA USSIF	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON KWADWO DAMOAH	MEMBER
16.	HON KINGSLEY AGYEMANG	MEMBER
17.	HON FRED KYEI ASAMOAH	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON YOUTH AND SPORTS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ERNEST HENRY NORGBEY	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON SOLOMON KUYON	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON SAMUEL ATTA MILLS	MEMBER
4.	HON ADAMS ABDUL-SALAM	MEMBER
5.	HON SHAIBU MAHAMA	MEMBER
6.	HON JOHN ADU JACK KWAME	MEMBER
7.	HON MUSTAPHA TANKO AMADU	MEMBER
8.	HON EBENEZER KWAKU ADDO	MEMBER
9.	HON ISSA SALIFU TAYLOR	MEMBER
10.	HON DANIEL BESSEY	MEMBER
11.	HON SULEMANA ADAMA	MEMBER
12.	HON LAWRENCIA DZIWORNU	MEMBER
13.	HON VINCENT EKOW ASSAFUAH	RANKING
14.	HON MICHAEL KWASI AIDOO	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON ANTHONY MMIEH	MEMBER
16.	HON DAMATA AMA APPIANIMAA SALAM	MEMBER
17.	HON NANA OSEI-ADJEI	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON ENERGY

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON EMMANUEL KWASI BEDZRAH	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON NASER TOURE MAHAMA	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON KWAME TWUMASI AMPOFO	MEMBER
4.	HON RICHARD KWAME SEFE	MEMBER
5.	HON QUEENSTAR POKUA SAWYER	MEMBER
6.	HON DESMOND DE-GRAFT PAITOO	MEMBER
7.	HON YAO GOMADO	MEMBER
8.	HON KOFI ARKO NOKOE	MEMBER
9.	HON ALBERT TETTEH NYAKOTEY	MEMBER
10.	HON CHARLES ASIEDU	MEMBER
11.	HON AHMED IBRAHIM	MEMBER
12.	HON PHILLIS NAA KORYOO OKUNOR	MEMBER
13.	HON GEORGE KWAME ABOAGYE	RANKING
14.	HON COLLINS ADOMAKO MENSAH	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON KWAME APPIAH KODUA	MEMBER
16.	HON KINGSLEY NYARKO	MEMBER
17.	HON MICHAEL KWASI AIDOO	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON ROADS AND TRANSPORTATION

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON ISAAC ADJEI MENSAH	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON ANDREW DARI CHIWITEY	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON JOHN KWABENA BLESS OTI	MEMBER
4.	HON LAADI AYII AYAMBA	MEMBER
5.	HON VINCENT OPPONG ASAMOAH	MEMBER
6.	HON JEAN-MARIE FORMADI	MEMBER
7.	HON ISAAC AWUKU YIBOR	MEMBER
8.	HON KWAME OHENE FRIMPONG	MEMBER
9.	HON SAMPSON AHI	MEMBER
10.	HON NASER TOURE MAHAMA	MEMBER
11.	HON SEID MUBARAK	MEMBER
12.	HON BEDE ANWATAAZUMO ZIEDENG	MEMBER
13.	HON OSEI KENNEDY NYARKO	RANKING
14.	HON ALHASSAN TAMPULI SULEMANA	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON FRANCIS ASENSO BOAKYE	MEMBER
16.	HON NANA AMPAW KWAME ADDO FREMPONG	MEMBER
17.	HON KOFI AHENKORAH MARFO	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON INDEPENDENT CONSTITUTIONAL BODIES

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON MAHAMA AYARIGA	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON. ALEXANDER AFENYO MARKIN	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON BERNARD AHIAFOR	MEMBER
4.	HON HARUNA IDDRISU	MEMBER
5.	HON ERIC OPOKU	MEMBER
6.	HON ANDREW DARI CHIWITEY	MEMBER
7.	HON SAMUEL OKUDJETO ABLAKWA	MEMBER
8.	HON NASIRA AFRAH GYEKYE	MEMBER
9.	HON ALBERT TETTEH NYAKOTEY	MEMBER
10.	HON PETER KWASI NORTSU-KOTOE	MEMBER
11.	HON DAN ABDUL-LATIF	MEMBER
12.	HON ISAAC ASHAI ODAMTTEN	MEMBER
13.	HON AKWASI GYAMFI ONYINA- ACHEAMPONG	MEMBER
14.	HON ABENA OSEI-ASARE	MEMBER
15.	HON ERNEST YAW ANIM	MEMBER
16.	HON IDA ADJOA ASIEDU	MEMBER
17.	HON LAWRENCIA DZIWORNU	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON PARLIAMENTARY AFFAIRS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON KWABENA OKYERE DARKO-MENSAH	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON MUMUNI MUHAMMED NURIDEEN	VICE CHAIRPERSON
3.	HON DOMINIC BINGAB ADUNA NITIWUL	MEMBER
4.	HON MAVIS NKANSAH-BOADU	MEMBER
5.	HON STEPHEN AMOAH	MEMBER
6.	HON DOMINIC NAPARE	RANKING
7.	HON OSCAR OFORI LARBI	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON JOSEPH BUKARI NIKPE	MEMBER
9.	HON CASSIEL ATO BAAH FORSON (DR)	MEMBER
10.	HON EMMANUEL ARMAH-KOFI BUAH	MEMBER
11.	HON COMFORT DOYOE CUDJOE	MEMBER
12.	HON HELEN ADJOA NTOSO	MEMBER
13.	HON YUSSIF ISSAKA JAJAH	MEMBER
14.	HON AGNES NAA MOMO LARTEY	MEMBER
15.	HON DORCAS AFO TOFFEY	MEMBER
16.	HON FELIX KWAKYE OFOSU	MEMBER
17.	HON ISAAC ADJEI MENSAH	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON JUDICIARY

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1	HON JOSEPH FREMPONG	CHAIRMAN
2	HON KWAME APPIAH KODUA	VICE CHAIRMAN
3	HON KWAME ANYIMADU-ANTWI	MEMBER
4	HON ANDREW ASIAMAH-AMOAKO	MEMBER
5	HON MOHAMMED AMIN ADAM	MEMBER
6	HON BEDE ANWATAAZUMO ZIEDENG	RANKING
7	HON ALHASSAN UMAR	DEPUTY RANKING
8	HON ABDUL RASHID PELPUO	MEMBER
9	HON THOMAS AMPEM NYARKO	MEMBER
10	HON HARUNA IDDRISU	MEMBER
11	HON ALFRED OKOE VANDERPUIJE	MEMBER
12	HON GEOFFREY KINI	MEMBER
13	HON SAMUEL ATTA-MILLS	MEMBER
14	HON YAO GOMADO	MEMBER
15	HON KOFI IDDIE ADAMS	MEMBER
16	HON SOLOMON KUYON	MEMBER
17	HON RICHARD KWAME SEFE	MEMBER

COMMITTEE ON CHIEFTAINCY, CULTURE AND RELIGIOUS AFFAIRS (12)

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON FRED KYEI ASAMOAH	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON ELVIS OSEI MENSAH DAPAAH	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON KWABENA OKYERE DARKO-MENSAH	MEMBER
4.	HON KOFI OBIRI YEBOAH	MEMBER
5.	HON MICHAEL OKYERE BAAFI	MEMBER
6.	HON LAADI AYII AYAMBA	RANKING
7.	HON RICHARD KWAME SEFE	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON JOHN ABDULAI JINAPOR	MEMBER
9.	HON CLEMENT ABAS APAAK (DR)	MEMBER
10.	HON KWAME TWUMASI AMPOFO	MEMBER
11.	HON SULEMANA YUSSIF	MEMBER
12.	HON VINCENT OPPONG ASAMOAH	MEMBER
13.	HON LYDIA LAMISI AKANVARIBA	MEMBER
14.	HON DAN ABDUL-LATIF	MEMBER
15.	HON EMMANUEL KWADWO AGYEKUM	MEMBER
16.	HON EMELIA ARTHUR	MEMBER
17.	HON HAMZA ADAM (PROF)	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON SECURITY AND INTELLIGENCE

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1	HON ZANETOR AGYEMAN RAWLINGS (DR)	CHAIRMAN
2	HON OSCAR OFORI LARBI	VICE CHAIRMAN
3	HON MAHAMA AYARIGA	MEMBER
4	HON ERNEST HENRY NORGBEY	MEMBER
5	HON RICHARD KUUIRE	MEMBER
6	HON BEDE ANWATAAZUMO ZIEDENG	MEMBER
7	HON JAMES GYAKYE QUAYSON	MEMBER
8	HON BENJAMIN NARTEH AYIKU	MEMBER
9	HON ALHASSAN KOBINA GHANSAH	MEMBER
10	HON NICHOLAS AMANKWAH	MEMBER
11	HON JOSEPH TETTEH AKUERTEH	MEMBER
12	HON EMELIA ARTHUR	MEMBER
13	HON BRYAN ACHEAMPONG	RANKING
14	HON KWABENA BOATENG	DEPUTY RANKING
15	HON KOFI AMANKWA-MANU	MEMBER
16	HON CHARLES ASUAKO OWIREDU	MEMBER
17	HON IDDRISU HABIB	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON SANITATION AND WATER RESOURCES

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON JOHN KWABENA OTI BLESS	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON JOYCELYN QUARSHIE	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON SAMPSON AHI	MEMBER
4.	HON SANJA NANJA	MEMBER
5.	HON ZUWERA IBRAHIMAH MUHAMMED	MEMBER
6.	HON ROBERT WISDOM CUDJOE	MEMBER
7.	HON CLETUS SEIDU DAPILAH	MEMBER
8.	HON CHARLES BAWADUAH	MEMBER
9.	HON ABDUL RAUF TUBAZU	MEMBER
10.	HON YAKUBU MOHAMMED	MEMBER
11.	HON BISMARCK TETTEH NYARKO	MEMBER
12.	HON JOSEPH AZUMAH	MEMBER
13.	HON KOFI AHENKORAH MARFO	RANKING
14.	HON RALPH POKU-ADUSEI	DEPUTY RANKING
15.	HON KOJO OPPONG NKRUMAH	MEMBER
16.	HON KWAKU AMPRATWUM-SARPONG	MEMBER
17.	HON ABDUL AZIZ FATAHIYA	MEMBER

Re-Composition of Membership of Standing and Select Committees

COMMITTEE ON PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION AND STATE INTERESTS

NO	NAME	DESIGNATION
1.	HON KWAKU ASANTE-BOATENG	CHAIRMAN
2.	HON SAMUEL AWUKU	VICE CHAIRMAN
3.	HON GLORIA OWUSU	MEMBER
4.	HON NANA ASAFO-ADJEI AYEH	MEMBER
5.	HON LAWRENCE AGYINSAM	MEMBER
6.	HON KWAME TWUMASI AMPOFO	RANKING
7.	HON THERESA LARDI AWUNI	DEPUTY RANKING
8.	HON ISAAC ADONGO	MEMBER
9.	HON MAVIS KUUKUA BISSUE	MEMBER
10.	HON ERIC AFFUL	MEMBER
11.	HON BENJAMIN AYIKU NARTEH	MEMBER
12.	HON JOSEPH KWASI MENSAH	MEMBER
13.	HON EMMANUEL BOAM	MEMBER
14.	HON KOFI ARKO NOKOE	MEMBER
15.	HON BANDIM ABED-NEGO AZUMAH	MEMBER
16.	HON GODWIN ANIMLI DORGBADZI-DORANI	MEMBER
17.	HON SEDEM KWEKU AFENYO	MEMBER

Mr Speaker, the Committee, which is ably chaired by the Rt Hon Speaker, met to re-compose the Committees of Parliament that was done and adopted by this House on 7th March, 2025. Mr Speaker, this was necessary because after the composition on 7th March, 2025, some Hon Members were subsequently appointed as Deputy Ministers of Ministries that the Committees that they belong to are supposed to supervise. As a practise of the House, we needed to re-compose the Committees so that Members who are either sector Ministers

or Deputy Ministers do not get to chair or be in Committees that have direct supervision of their Ministry.

Mr Speaker, also, two by-elections were held and one outstanding election. So, the Committee took into consideration the three new Members of Parliament, namely Hon Ewurabena Aubynn, Member of Parliament for Ablekuma North, Hon Bernard Bediako Baidoo, the Member of Parliament for Akwatia and Prof Seidu Alidu, Member of Parliament for Tamale Central. Mr Speaker, the

Committee also observed that in every two years, the membership of Committees in Parliament should rotate so that Members will not say that they do not belong to a good Committee or someone belongs to a good Committee and they do not belong to that Committee. So, the Committee took into consideration and observed keenly that every two years we should be able to rotate Members in various Committees. So, if a person is in the Finance Committee in two years, they will be moved to another Committee. If a person is in the Committee on Health, in two years the person will be moved to the other Committee.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, the Committee submits for the consideration of this House, the reconstituted Committees of Parliament as attached Appendix 1 and Appendix 2.

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion ably moved by the First Deputy Minority Chief Whip, and to add that the House adopts the Report presently before us.

Mr Speaker, like the Hon Member who moved the Motion indicated, it has become imperative that membership on Committees become rotational, because some Members have raised concerns and the assurance, we want to give them is that within the life of a Parliament, they will get the opportunity to serve on other Committees. So, the pressure on the Whips and the Committee on Selection that some particular Committees be featured will reduce.

Mr Speaker, also because when we took the original Report, it was detected

that, inadvertently, a couple of Members were not placed on a minimum of two Committees. So, this present work is to correct that as well. As the Hon Member who moved the Motion said, it is also to accommodate freshmen and women who have entered the House, so that they can effectively participate in the present consideration of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana and its passage. Mr Speaker, with these words, I second the Motion ably moved by the First Deputy Minority Chief Whip.

Question proposed.

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompheh): Mr Speaker, may I commend Leadership, particularly the Majority Leader, for his steadfastness, and the Rt Hon Speaker himself. This matter has been lingering on for far too long. I recall on many occasions I had cause to raise it when the Business Statement is presented.

2:26 p.m.

Particularly, on the grounds that we stood in defiance of Order 208 and so, it was important that this matter is put to rest. I am happy with the leadership the Majority Leader has shown and the blessings of the Speaker himself. I am particularly happy about the need for a rotation in the Membership as time progresses. Ever since we adopted the new Standing Orders, these lingering concerns have become a matter that we have to deal with. And I think that we have done well so far.

The appointment of some of our Colleagues to the Executive is also a ground for these amendments. Even though

it is not the main reason; it is a ground for these amendments to Committees. I am sure that going forward, Colleagues would relate more with the Whips and other concerns and considerations could be ironed out in the best interest of this House.

On that score, I commend the Speaker and Leadership for bringing this matter to rest once and for all. I am grateful. I guess on Friday, when the Majority Leader presents the Business Statement, I will not have a reason to ask him when and how the composition of our Committee membership will be done.

Mr Speaker, I thank you and I am grateful.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we would also take Motion numbered 22.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion numbered 22, Chairman of the Committee?

MOTIONS

Suspension of Standing Order 104(1)

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the motion is

given, the motion for the adoption of the Report of the Finance Committee on the Contract Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Truedare Investment Limited for the provision of Publican Digital Inspection Solution to modernise customs administration and enhance revenue mobilisation may be *moved* today.

Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion numbered 23.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, you earlier reminded me of an engagement, and I intend to go by that engagement. Mr Speaker, Motion numbered 23 becomes consequential. However, we do not have copies of the Report. The other Business we have.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The copies of the Report are loaded on the console.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Are they on the console?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Well, the practice has been that at least those of us in Leadership will have some hard copies to complement what is on the console.

So, can the Table Office quickly get us copies.

Contract Agreement between GoG and Truedare Investment Ltd for the Provision of Publican Digital Inspection Solution

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Finance Committee on the Contract Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Truedare Investment Limited for the provision of Publican Digital Inspection Solution to modernise customs administration and enhance revenue mobilisation.

Introduction

The Contract Agreement Between the Government of the Republic of Ghana, represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority, and Truedare Investment Limited for the Provision of Publican Digital Inspection Solution to Modernise Customs Administration and Enhance Revenue Mobilisation was presented to the House on Thursday, 13th November, 2025, by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson.

Pursuant to article 181 of the 1992 Constitution and Orders 226 of the Standing Orders of the House, the Agreement was referred to the Finance Committee for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Agreement, met with the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, Hon Deputy Minister of Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem, Commissioner-General of the Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA), Mr Anthony Sarpong and the technical teams from the Ministry of Finance and GRA. Representatives of Truedare Investment Limited were also in attendance.

References

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

- i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana
- ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana
- iii. Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921)

Background to the Agreement

Ghana, in June 2020, through the Customs Division of the Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA), introduced the Integrated Customs Management System (ICUMS) to coordinate cross-border trade activities, reduce transaction cost to stakeholders and increase government revenue mobilisation. The change was driven by delays in clearance of goods due to the use of multiple electronic platforms for valuation, classification, risk management and tax payment. Even

though the introduction of ICUMS solved most of the complexities of trade, there is still the challenge of under declaration, mis-invoicing and trade data falsification that officers are unable to identify, leading to revenue loss.

In 2024, total import CIF was about GH¢204.31 billion, out of which total taxable CIF was GH¢129.64 billion. Import duty collected based on the taxable CIF was GH¢15.38 billion. The differential between the total import CIF and the taxable CIF cannot be fully explained by exemptions granted for the importation of petroleum products and other legally approved exemptions by Parliament. The situation is further worsened by the fact that out of the total taxable CIF, only GHs15.38 billion was collected as import duty, given an effective duty rate of 12 per cent in 2024 and the analysis clearly indicates that there is smuggling under-invoicing, and misclassification of goods.

Ghana needs a digital Artificial Intelligence system which will inspect every shipment documentation and cross-check it with unique, relevant, and reliable global sources to determine its authenticity. Upon document verification, the System will correlate all entities involved in the transaction to detect and highlight fraudulent shipments to enhance trade facilitation and revenue mobilisation. The System will also review domestically collected data, like transfers, advance payments and domestic tax payments, relating them to declarations for imported goods.

Consequently, an AI-Powered Trade Data Analytics System (Publican System), which has been introduced in over 20

countries worldwide, is being proposed to help modernise Customs administration and enhance revenue mobilisation.

Objective of the Agreement

The Publican AI System is an innovative platform built on AI and Machine Learning (ML) technologies, purposely designed to enhance fiscal oversight, trade verification, shipment screening, classification, inspection and compliance monitoring. The System is designed to support customs decision-making processes by identifying patterns, highlighting anomalies, and organising operational intelligence in real time based on thousands of public data sources, some of which are uniquely collected, analysed, organised, and smartly prioritised.

Additionally, the System can also identify in real time imported cargo which poses health, security, and safety concerns. The architecture of the System supports automated document vetting, entity correlation & risk profiling, end-to-end digital vetting, and global intelligence integration.

The Publican AI System is also a data collection mechanism encrypted with Cloud performance monitoring tools. The System provides robust backup options, both local and cloud-based, ensuring maximum security and uninterrupted operation. Strict data governance, encryption, access control, and compliance are all incorporated into the platform's architecture and maintained throughout the data lifecycle, certified by ISO 27001 / 27017 / 27018/ SOC2.

Observations**Rationale for the Introduction of the Publican AI System**

The Committee observed that the Integrated Customs Management System (ICUMS) cannot detect under invoicing and trade misclassification which result from the doctrine of data. It has also got evaluation problems all leading to revenue losses. The Hon Minister for Finance informed the Committee that from April, 2020 to 2025, out of the total of US\$81 billion transferred from Ghana in the name of imports, US\$31 billion was without any corresponding information. The Minister also informed the Committee that ICUMS lack the capacity to track misclassification and also prevent contraband goods or items from entering the Country.

The Committee noted that the implementation of the System will support ongoing government efforts to address the underperformance of customs revenue resulting from smuggling, under-invoicing and misclassification of goods. The System will complement the existing ICUMS to provide maximum economic and social benefit with minimum trade disruptions. The System will also provide the following additional benefits:

- i. Leveraging big data and Artificial Intelligence for customs enforcement. innovation and transformation.
- ii. Providing access to previously unobtainable data for use within Customs enforcement processes.

- iii. Providing seamless workflows and adoption for highly streamlined processing.
- iv. User-friendly, intuitive, automated, and streamlined interface.
- v. Comprehensive screening, vetting, inspection, investigation, and reporting.
- vi. Constantly evolving & updated fraud disruption mechanism.

The Committee also observed that the System can also be adjusted to combat the abuse of the Import Declaration Form (IDF) and the Letters of Commitment (LOC). The System is able to read attached documents using OCR technology and map the information with declared information, check for international information of the exporter/importer (for exports and imports respectively) and alert government agencies accordingly if there is evidence of attempted illegality. This will save the Country the loss of billions of dollars each year through the illegal transfer of funds outside using IDF and LOC Systems. The Committee was informed that the System has been implemented in over 20 countries, Togo, Japan, United States of America, Singapore, United Arab Emirates, Hungary, and Ecuador, just to mention a few.

Revenue Impact

The Committee noted that the implementation of the System will enable the Government to eradicate

fraudulent trade thereby reducing the direct loss of customs revenues. The Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA) will therefore benefit from significantly reduced cost of operational overheads, need for space to store huge trade tax information, misplaced tax assessment and loss of historical liability. There is also the benefit of being able to submit documentations and grant approvals at any time of the day with comprehensive researched information thereby reducing interest payments, ground rent, demurrages and delay cost.

The Committee further noted that the implementation of the System is estimated to increase customs duties collection by more than US\$133 million annually, with additional VAT Collection on flagged shipments at US\$104 million. This is equivalent to GH¢2.8 billion.

Stakeholder Consultations

The Committee also noted that since the System is a revenue-centred project that aims at digitising customs and trade revenue mobilisation through collaboration and teamwork, there have been stakeholder consultations among relevant stakeholders. They include the Shipping lines and Custom House Agents.

Local Content

The Hon Minister for Finance, in responding to issues of local content in the Agreement, explained that Ghanaians will be afforded the opportunity to work with the Truedare Investment Limited as technicians even though there is no

legislation that will compel the Company to do so. He asserted that in future, a local content bill will be put before Parliament for passage to compel such companies to engage the services of Ghanaians in their day-to-day operations or activities.

Recommendation/Conclusion

Ghana's journey toward fiscal stability and economic prosperity hinges on its capacity to effectively harness domestic resources. Consequently, the implementation of the System will fully digitise and automate domestic revenue collection while integrating it for effective and efficient revenue collection, pushing Ghana to over 20 per cent Revenue-to-GDP ratio by 2027.

The Committee therefore recommends by consensus that a resolution be passed by the House to ratify the Contract Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Truedare Investment Limited for the Provision of Publican Digital Inspection Solution to Modernise Customs Administration and Enhance Revenue Mobilisation.

Respectfully submitted.

2:36 p.m.

Yes, Hon Richard Acheampong?

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to speak to the Reports on the Floor.

Mr Speaker, this very agreement was signed on the 28th of May 2024 at a cost of US\$53.4 million. But when this Government took over, they went for a renegotiation of the figure, and it was reduced to US\$44.24 million, making a savings of US\$9.16 million. This is an enhanced form of tax administration, if one compares this to what Integrated Customs Management System (ICUMS) is doing at the port. And this has the modern technology, which will help us to improve revenue mobilisation, and then—it is not by revenue alone, like the Chairman just said, sometimes even the content of the container, one must know what actually is being imported into the country.

Today, we are complaining that people are selling ‘red’ and other stuff in the market, and we do not know where we are getting all these things. They come through our borders, but because of misclassifications—they will tell you this is rice, meanwhile if you go into it, it is not rice. So, if we have a technology which can help us identify the content of containers that are imported into the country, it will save our youth and also generate more revenue. Like the Chairman pointed out, if a cargo is from Mexico and one from Egypt, looking at the nautical miles, the freight will be different, and by the end of the day, the State will lose out. So, the world is evolving, new technologies are coming up, so we need to take advantage and get this solution to help us generate more revenue. Governance is a continuum. The past administration signed on to this agreement, but we are lucky to revise the numbers to get a better deal. And with this, we are not going to pay any money

to them. A percentage will be ceded from ICUMS to the new contractor. So, by the end of the day, it becomes expenditure neutral. We are not going to incur additional costs to it.

I think this is a very positive solution, which will help us generate the projected revenue that the Hon Minister talked about in the Budget. If we do not pass this, every single day, we are losing. So, this is something we need to come together and get it passed, so that we can get the needed revenue for national development.

I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved and seconded. It is for the consideration of the House.

Yes, Hon Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The indication is that the Chairman concluded by saying that the Committee report was by consensus. Mr Speaker, that part needs to be amended, because it was a Majority decision from the Committee. So, the Chairman needs to make that amendment, because it was never by consensus. I have related with our Ranking Member, and the Members on the Finance Committee, so he should make that amendment, and then we would be able to proceed.

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, the Report accordingly amended.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Since this Report is a Majority decision, the contention of the Minority is of the view that the job that ICUMS is doing could have been enhanced; their capacity could be built, so that they will be able to do exactly what the new company is coming to do.

Mr Speaker, we agree with them that the Hon Minister for Finance ought to chalk some kind of revenue, but with the leakage that is going on, it is worrying. Yesterday, listening to the Hon Minister for Finance, in five years, about some US\$31 billion leaked through the port system, yet we go to IMF asking for some US\$3 billion. If actually the Hon Minister wants to make sure that the leakages are stopped. It is not just about introducing new companies; it is about increasing the capacity of ICUMS. It is about giving them policy directives. It is about encouraging them and making sure that we close the gaps to be able to stop the leakage.

Also, what is the track record the new company that is being brought on board? What have they shown to us that they have been able to achieve? Yesterday, I listened to them, and they were saying that they have operated in some 20 countries. But what is their success stories of the countries in which they claim they have operated? What have they been able to achieve in those countries? Yes, they might be operating

in a country and might have been as bad as we are presuming that ICUMS is not doing much in Ghana.

So, I think, Mr Speaker, that is why we in the Minority are not in support of this, because we think that the intention of the Ministry of Finance to introduce a new company—I do not know how the introduction of a new company will be able to get this revenue for us without a cost to the country. Definitely, the Chairman of the Finance Committee is of the view that it will come at no cost. I do not think that it will come at no cost. And even the way it will operate, we would use digital technology to make sure that these leakages are taken care of.

So, Mr Speaker, as the Chairman has amended it to a Majority decision, we think that ICUMS can be strengthened, and we are not in agreement with this report; we are opposed to it.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, the concerns raised by our Colleagues are valid, except that the Hon Minister took pains to explain some of the things that informed his decision. The Hon Minister said that in developing the proof of concept, they engaged extensively with ICUMS and the new service provider to come to a conclusion that the best way to go was to go for a service provider to augment and complement the work of ICUMS. ICUMS has several models, but the model that we are looking at is not present in the ICUMS model. The Hon Minister said they engaged them. So, it is not as if all of a sudden, they are going to

see a third party come there to work without their consent. They have had some extensive engagement.

But, Mr Speaker, with the issue about the leakages, when one imports goods into this country and they pay through their banks or other means, they first have to fill out what is called an import declaration form. That import declaration form is where one informs the Government of Ghana what they are importing into the country and how much forex they need to pay for those goods. Out of over US\$81 billion of such requests for which our banks transferred hard-earned foreign currency abroad, US\$31 billion worth of goods did not come into the country. So, what we are seeing is that while we are struggling to find dollars here, we have shipped US\$31 billion which has not been supported by any import at all. And ICUMS does not have the capacity to track this and to help us manage it. So, this new system is intended to complement the work of ICUMS but not to take away the work of ICUMS so that together they can help us to mobilise our resources.

Mr Speaker, I just wanted to make that clarification to my Colleague.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Chairman of the Committee. Hon Members, at the conclusion of the debate, I will put the Question.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will then move to the consequential Resolution numbered 24 on the *Order Paper*.

Yes, Deputy Minister for Finance?

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Ampem Nyarko): Mr Speaker, I beg—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance was here just a while ago. I believe he has stepped out. So, Mr Speaker, I crave your indulgence if we can allow his Deputy to move the consequential Resolution. I have already had discussions with my Colleagues on the other Side, and they have no opposition to the Deputy Minister moving the consequential Resolution.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Hon Majority Leader knows we are not obstructionists and we will not obstruct government Business, that we will not do. But today I saw the Hon Minister in the House, and we engaged him. When it gets to Resolution and the Hon Minister vanishes—Resolution is a very important Business, as he knows.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you know that for a stated reason, we have to commence the commentary on the Budget out of turn, you understand?

Yes, Hon Patrick Boamah?

2.46 p.m.

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah: Mr Speaker, today is Hon Ampem's turn. If we recall, Hon Ampem used to sit where Hon Addo-Kenneth used to sit. And every day, his main objection was to a Deputy Minister moving a Motion for the adoption of a Report or Resolution being carried through. You see, Hon Ampem, time changes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, leave is hereby granted. Deputy Minister for Finance, you have the floor.

RESOLUTION

Contract Agreement between the GoG and Truedare Investment Limited for the Provision of Publican Digital Inspection Solution

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP) *on behalf of the Minister for Finance:* Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

WHEREAS by the provisions of article 181(5) of the Constitution the terms and conditions of any international business or economic transaction to which the Government of Ghana is a party shall not come into operation unless the said terms and conditions have been laid before Parliament and approved by Parliament by a Resolution supported by the votes of a majority of all Members of Parliament.

PURSUANT to the provisions of the said article 181(5) of the Constitution, and at the request of the Government of Ghana acting through the Minister responsible for Finance, there has been laid before Parliament the terms and conditions of a Contract Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Truedare Investment Limited for the provision of Publican Digital Inspection Solution to modernise customs administration and enhance revenue mobilisation.

THIS HONOURABLE HOUSE HEREBY RESOLVE AS FOLLOWS:

IN ACCORDANCE with the provisions of the said article 181(5) of the Constitution, this House approves, by resolution, the Contract Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Truedare Investment Limited for the provision of Publican Digital Inspection Solution to modernise customs administration and enhance revenue mobilisation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any seconder?

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Majority Leader.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will go back to the commentary on the Budget Statement and Economic Policy.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. It is now the turn of Mr Felix Kwakye Ofosu.

STATEMENT

Government's Financial Policy, 2026

[Resumption of Debate from column 63]

Minister for Government Communication (Mr Felix Kwakye Ofosu) (MP): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to comment on the presentation of the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of President John Dramani Mahama.

Mr Speaker, let me start by commending highly the Minister for Finance for presenting what, by every account, is an inspiring Budget that sets us on the path to rapid economic recovery and socio-economic development. Before I delve into specifics in the Budget, there is a need to correct some misimpressions that were created in the course of the contributions by our Friends on the other Side.

Mr Speaker, they have sought to contest the absolutely indubitable fact that the economy that they superintended was in shambles. That the economy we inherited from them was in shambles is a matter of public record. It is not

debatable. As has often been said, economic analysis is carried out on the basis of specific indices. There are metrics. There are things we use to measure economic performance, which are not subject to interpretation or opinion.

Mr Speaker, the economy they handed over to us was in the throes of deep economic defaults. For the first time in the history of Ghana, a Government defaulted on its debts. For the first time in the history of Ghana, our credit ratings were at junk status. In local parlance, we call it *borla*. That was the state of our ratings. Mr Speaker, the Ghana cedi suffered a catastrophic collapse under the watch of our Colleagues on the other Side. By the time they left office, one could buy the dollar for GH¢17 in some forex bureaus in Ghana. This is not a disputable fact.

Mr Speaker, inflation at a point reached 54 per cent, hyperinflation. One would go to the market to buy an item at one price, only to return in the afternoon to find that the price had gone up. By the time they left, it was at 23 per cent, which was exceptionally high for an economy like ours. Mr Speaker, when they went into the IMF programme, albeit in an ambulance, they committed to leaving a primary surplus of 0.5 per cent at the end of the 2024 financial year.

Mr Speaker, we came into government and discovered that far from leaving a surplus of 0.5 per cent, they had in fact done a primary balance of negative 3.5 per cent. The budget deficit was hovering around 5.7 per cent. So,

there is absolutely no doubt that the economy that we inherited was in shambles and that it had been mismanaged. Our public debt had reached levels that made it impossible for them to repay. Mr Speaker, they gave 1.3 million Ghanaian bondholders excruciating haircuts that plunged them into severe economic hardships. This is not in dispute. So, it is settled beyond debate that the economy was in shambles under them.

Mr Speaker, the next issue that is not up for debate is that there has been a remarkable turnaround in the fortunes of the Ghanaian economy. The same indices that I recited, when we look at them under us, we see remarkable recovery. Mr Speaker, contrary to the junk status of our credit ratings, today we have come back to B. Today, the Ghana cedi on the interbank market sells at GH¢10.9. That is what the Bank of Ghana has reported. Even at the forex bureaux, it hovers between GH¢11 to 11.5. Under them, it was GH¢17.

Mr Speaker, inflation is at eight per cent, and the Minister has given an indication that they expect it to reach 6.5 per cent by the end of this year. The primary balance and the reason why I stress the primary balance is that they made it the main anchor of the IMF programme. In other words, it was the most important indicator for them. They chose it. Mr Speaker, from the -3.5 per cent primary balance, the Minister for Finance set a target of a surplus of 1.5 per cent. He went 0.1 per cent better and achieved 1.6 per cent by the third quarter of this year, which has never happened in recent memory.

Mr Speaker, today, Ghanaians are seeing relief from the economic management of the John Dramani Mahama Administration—[*Hear! Hear!*]—because we have been able to control the exchange rates. For 10 consecutive times, the price of fuel has dropped. Mr Speaker, there is a record before the Committee on Economy and Development of this House that up to 4,500 different items saw price reductions because of the appreciation of the Ghana cedi. And this is relief brought to the pockets of the people of Ghana.

Mr Speaker, the transport companies will say that since the Government began to engage them about a decade ago in the fixing of transport prices twice a year, it is under this Government that the single biggest reduction in transport fares has occurred, of 15 per cent. And that is because fuel prices, which are a key determinant of transport fares, have reduced substantially. That is also not in debate.

Mr Speaker, even as I go on to correct some misimpressions, my respected Friend, Dr Gideon Boako, sought to assail the fiscal consolidation measures of the Minister for Finance. He decried the effort of the Minister for Finance to hold the line and ensure that the same fiscal indiscipline which led us to the crisis that the superintendent does not recant. He accused the Minister of excessive fiscal consolidation. Mr Speaker, all that the Minister did was to adjust his expenditure patterns to meet unexpected shortfalls in revenue. It is common knowledge that if, for some reason, one's revenue sources suffer a

hit, one adjusts their expenditure. It is because they were unable to do that that, for three consecutive years under them, we recorded double-digit deficits. When revenue suffered under them, they decided to spend more.

But this Minister for Finance says no. We must turn away from that kind of reckless expenditure. So, if we take page 18 of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, at paragraph 112, the Minister makes the point that revenue underperformed by about 4.7 per cent.

2:56 p.m.

That meant that the projections he had made had come short and therefore there was a need to change strategy to ensure that we do not overspend. So, he also adjusted expenditure and cut goods and services, which is discretionary, while ensuring that important disbursements to statutory funds are met.

Mr Speaker, I, by virtue of being a Member of Parliament (MP) for Abura-Asebu-Kwamankese (AAK), as it is the case for all my Colleagues, I am an ex-officio member of the Abura-Asebu-Kwamankese District Assembly. So, I know that this Government has done a yeoman's job in terms of spending in the right places.

Mr Speaker, the whole of last year, the AAK District Assembly received only GH¢298,000 in the Common Fund. By the middle of this year, the same Assembly had received GH¢ 6.5 million in Common Fund disbursements—*[Hear! Hear!]*—Because of that, as I

speak to you, the AAK District Assembly has almost completed eight different projects, which they could not do the whole of last year. So, it is not true that this Minister for Finance is not spending. He is spending in the right places.

Mr Speaker, for the first time, the National Health Insurance Scheme reports that they have a healthy balance in their accounts, unlike the past, when a minuscule of what was due them was reimbursed by governments.

Mr Speaker, today, we do not hear noises about the Free Senior High School, because this Minister for Finance is remitting adequate resources to them through Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund). Between the beginning of this year and now, about GH¢1.3 billion has been paid to senior high schools to feed Ghanaian school children. It is the reason the noises that used to emerge over the poor quality of food or unavailability of food has subsided. So, the Minister is engaging in fiscal consolidation as a way to prevent the fiscal slippages that we have suffered from in the past, that he is spending in the right places.

Mr Speaker, there was also an attempt to distort what has been done under the Big Push Agenda. It is true that the Minister budgeted GH¢13.9 billion in the 2025 Budget, which is roughly equivalent at the time to about a billion dollars. Since then, 33 different projects have either gone far in terms of their execution—these projects include some of the big road projects that they did not have specific dedicated funds for when

they were in Government and therefore left in the lurch.

As I speak to you, those projects have begun and they are ongoing. There are many more that are ongoing. But the Minister has said that unlike in their time when they used to pay mobilisation to contractors before they went on site, some of whom actually squandered the money, he was not going to give anybody mobilisation.

As I speak to you, the Minister has in excess of US\$900 million in his account. He has said that any contractor who presents a certificate will be paid in 30 days, one month. The Deputy Minister for Roads and Highways is right here behind me and he can corroborate what I am saying. So, it is not true that the Minister is not spending under the Big Push Agenda. The Minister is ensuring that there is value for money and that people who actually do work are the ones that we are going to pay.

Mr Speaker, they also keep on claiming that the Bank of Ghana has printed money to finance the activities of the GoldBod. For the avoidance of doubt, the Bank of Ghana has not printed a dime to give to the GoldBod. Indeed, our Friends on the other Side must make up their minds on exactly what they think this Government has done or not done. In one breath, they claim that the Ghana cedi is stable or the Ghana cedi has appreciated because of some gold accumulation policy that they implemented.

Mr Speaker, they forget that by the time they left office, they had accumulated close to 30 tonnes of gold and yet our currency suffered its most catastrophic depreciation in recent memory. What the Bank of Ghana has done, is that they take money from commercial banks who are interested in forex, give it to GoldBod to purchase gold, export it and remit the funds thereof in hard currency, which the Bank of Ghana gives back to the very people they took money from. That is what my Colleague, Mr Isaac Adongo, referred to as intermediation and that is what has happened.

Mr Speaker, even as they criticise and falsely accuse the Bank of Ghana of intervening in the markets, the records show that in 2024 alone, by the end of October, they had pumped US\$3.15 billion onto the forex markets in a bid to save the Ghana cedis and yet the it suffered its most catastrophic decline under them. So, if merely pumping dollars onto the forex markets is what causes the currency to achieve stability, they would have achieved it. We have innovated and introduced a measure that is ensuring that there is liquidity on the forex markets, so that when they need it for transactions, they get some to do. That is what they are failing to recognise and are peddling all manner of misleading claims against this Government.

Mr Speaker, but, let me make the point, that if you put all the macroeconomic indices aside, the economic management of this Government is touching real lives. They

were the ones who used to argue that parents could not pay between GH¢800 to GH¢ 1,500 as fees at senior high school level and therefore they needed to introduce the Free Senior High School Policy. Yet the same people are opposed to the fact that when senior high school graduates leave school, they have to go to tertiary institutions and that tertiary school fees are even more expensive than senior high school fees. If parents cannot pay GH¢800 and GH¢1,500, can they be expected to pay in excess of GH¢3,000 at tertiary level?

So, this Government introduced a No-Fees-Stress Policy. I can report that as of the end of the last academic year, 151,000 Ghanaian first-year university or tertiary students had received reimbursements under the No-Fees-Stress-Policy—*[Hear! Hear!]*—This is how prudent—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is now the turn of Mr Alexander Akwasi Acquah. *[Hear! Hear!]* You have 15 minutes.

Mr Alexander Akwasi Acquah (NPP — Akim Oda): I want to thank you for the opportunity to give some feedback of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy that have been delivered to this House by the Mr Ato Forson.

Mr Speaker, I must say that the Budget Statement and Economic Policy was actually delivered with a lot of confidence and it actually gave us the opportunity to also analyse the Budget. For the last weekend that I was in the

Constituency, I met a group of young men, we went through the Budget and one suggested that the Budget would be better assessed if we look at how specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and realistic it is and then we looked at the time bound nature of the provisions in the Budget. So, at the end of the day, we want to see whether it is a 'SMART' Budget or not.

Mr Speaker, I am sad to report to this House that, when we went through some of the topics in the Budget, we realised that this is not a 'SMART' Budget. This is not a 'SMART' Budget because, as a former Deputy Minister for Health, we realised that last year, the Budget made allocation for the National Health Insurance to the tune of GH¢10.5 billion. Everybody was happy, including the private health providers, because the Health Insurance had not been capped like it used to be in the past. So, people were expecting that, this is going to improve health care. The private health care people were going to receive their monies, and it was actually going generally help health care delivery. This year, this figure has reduced to GH¢8 billion. Then we are looking at a shortfall for GH¢2.5 billion.

So, one would want to ask this question, that, what is going to happen to the primary health care projects that is also in this Budget? This Budget is asking that the Government should start implementing the free primary health care. It is out of the same GH¢8 billion that we are going to have the MahamaCares, which is 25 percent of it, like it used to happen in the last Budget.

Mr Speaker, a lot of people are wondering whether it is the intention of this Government to collapse the National Health Insurance, just to make sure that the Mahama Care survives and it stands in the name of the President of the Republic?

3:06 p.m.

Mr Speaker, this Budget is asking for free primary health care. What it means is that people who are going to benefit from Free Primary Healthcare would have to use health insurance. One wonders what would happen to the poor who use the free primary health care. The free primary health care ensures that you do not need any health insurance. This would actually demotivate people from renewing their health insurance. So, the very poor people that we say we want to use the free primary healthcare to save are the very people who would suffer under this. When they go for healthcare using the Free Primary Healthcare programme, and their health insurance has expired, they might not even remember to go and renew it, and at the time when they have to be referred to a secondary or a tertiary institution, how do they account for their bills? So, the very poor people that the Free Primary Healthcare would save are the very people to be impoverished.

Mr Speaker, on page 133 of the Budget, paragraph 1059, with your permission, I read;

“Mr Speaker, to bridge the inequality in access to healthcare access across our regions, the Government will

commence the processes towards the construction of six new regional hospitals for the six newly created regions, beginning with three hospitals in 2026 and two district hospitals at Bole and Shama”

Mr Speaker, just look at the wording, “...Government will commence the process towards the construction of six new regional hospitals...”. It is not the same as “the Government is going to construct six new regional hospitals”. We want to ask, which of the regions are we talking about? Because under Agenda 111, the newly created regional hospitals were catered for. It went to PPA, contractors were secured, value for money from the Minister for Finance was done, but for the debt exchange, the contractors would have been working by now. So, is it the same project that they are going to continue, or are they going to abandon that process like it is stated here?

Mr Speaker, this is the same government that promised Women banking, and in the last Budget, it dedicated only 50 million for Women's banking. When questions were asked, it was stated that the GHC50 million was only going to help in putting together the Women's Development Bank. Indeed, in this year, there has been an allocation for it, but if paragraph 1059, states that, “...Government will commence the process towards the construction of six new regional hospitals...”, then it means that we are only going to have paperwork. On the next line, it says they are going to begin with three hospitals in 2026.

So, if they are going to begin with three hospitals in 2026, why not state that but say that the six regional hospitals would have new hospitals? It shows clearly that this Budget is a *Sakawa* Budget. It is a Budget that you cannot trust.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, will you do the needful and withdraw the word *Sakawa*?

Mr Acquah: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please withdraw.

Mr Acquah: Mr Speaker, I withdraw the word *sakawa*, but what I meant is, this is a Budget that says one thing and does another. So, which regions would benefit from the new hospitals?

Mr Speaker, in the same paragraph, it is stated that two district hospitals at Bole and Shama would be constructed. I am aware that Bole has a district hospital, so why build a new hospital in Bole? It is the home of the President, so we can understand. But that is the difference between the ex-President, Nana Addo Dankwa Akuffo-Addo, and the current President, His Excellency John Mahama. The Kyebi Hospital is one of the oldest hospitals in Ghana, but the former President, Nana Addo Dankwa Akuffo-Addo, did not build a new hospital. He only rehabilitated it. So, we think that the Bole District Hospital can be rehabilitated so that funding can be sent to Akim Oda Government Hospital. During the campaign of the President, he

came to Akim Oda and promised the people that he would give us a new hospital, befitting of our municipality, because our hospital is over a hundred years. I am using this opportunity to remind the President that his promise to the people of Akim Oda still sits in their heads. So, with the funding that would go to Bole, we ask that it goes to the Akim Oda Government Hospital.

Mr Speaker, I am also looking at the issue of district assemblies. As a Deputy Ranking Member for the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development, last year a lot of money was said to have been sent to the various district assemblies, but during the audit report hearing, where all the district assemblies came, we realised that the money was still sitting in the accounts. We questioned them and they told us there are a lot of bottlenecks. Apparently, these monies have been locked, and there is a lot of inactivity in the districts. What has been happening there is just clean-ups or sanitation; every day, clean-ups and the money have been sitting in the accounts. Currently, we are told in this Budget that the guidelines given to the various MMDAs for last year's budget—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, are you talking about the audit report of 2024 or 2025?

Mr Acquah: Mr Speaker, the audit report of 2024. However, we took the opportunity to find out how they had utilised the monies that had been sent to them, and the majority of them confessed that their monies were sitting in their accounts. Some are waiting for

drawings; there are no plans for it. But apparently, that was a very smart way of keeping those monies for the implementation of projects for this year. So, currently we have some of them inaugurating projects and getting ready for development. What it means is that monies allocated from last year were not utilised, and they are going to be pushed to this year. It means that we have had a lot of inactivity in the assemblies.

For a whole year, there has been nothing happening in the various assemblies; there is no project. My very good Friend said that his constituency has had so much money. He should go and check how much money has been expended. The monies are still sitting in the accounts.

Mr Speaker, on Financial fiscal autonomy, there is a letter circulating on social media, from the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs that is directing MMDAs to contract specific companies, to award them the construction of some furniture. What decentralisation means is that we have to capacitate the assemblies. Why would they not find their own people? Why would they not find their own companies to empower the local entrepreneurs? But this letter is making rounds and is asking the assemblies to contact them for the construction of furniture.

Mr Speaker, I want to congratulate this Government. I am told that the MMDCEs have had their salaries increased to about GH¢35,000. If that is true, we have to congratulate this

Government because what it means is that the MMDAs would be empowered to work. What it means is that if such huge sums of money are going to them at the end of each month as salaries, against the paltry 9 per cent that was given to public sector workers, we are expecting them to work and take care of our various assemblies.

3:16 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I want to end with *galamsey*. Before I do *galamsey*, Mr Speaker, one of the flagships for this Budget is the express road that is passing through my Constituency, Akim Oda. This weekend, I had some chiefs and people coming to me and they were asking, is it true that there is going to be a road network through our Constituency? I said, yes, that is what the Minister said. I did not want to sound like a prophet of doom, so I said, this is going to make our Constituency very open. But they asked, which area of Akim Oda is that road network going to pass? Clearly, they started doubting that project, especially when they realised that the Government said it is going to do it in three years. This is clearly a budget that cannot be trusted.

Mr Speaker, I would end with *galamsey*. *Galamsey* has been a bane to all of us. I have been one of the people pushing so much against *galamsey*. If you go to my Constituency, you have the MCE boldly opening up, saying that he is taking fines—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, conclude.

Mr Acquah: Mr Speaker, he takes fines from people involved in *galamsey*. What it means is that Government *hia sika*. People who have been engaged in *galamsey* and have been arrested, how do you take money from them? For a Government that has put so much money into the various Assemblies, why would you be charging people—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, your time is up. I will proceed to give the floor to Mr Sulemana Adama. You have 10 minutes.

Mr Sulemana Adama (NDC — Tain): Mr Speaker, the Budget Statement has only one conclusion. The conclusion is that Ghana's economy is breathing again. The conclusion is that the economy is stronger, steadier and it is now full of promise. Mr Speaker, the effect of this is the restoration of fiscal discipline. Our cedi is stabilised. Inflation is under control, and rating agencies are now convinced with our economy now. Overall, GDP is 6.3 per cent. Primary balance of surplus is 1.6 per cent. It means that we are managing expenditure *vis-à-vis* the revenue that we have. Public debt compared to the total economy has reduced. As a percentage of GDP, it has reduced from 69 per cent to 45 per cent. This is the most significant decrease in almost ten years.

Mr Speaker, when we were in school, when one has a policy, or a programme with a constant and a variable in it, if there are changes in the output, it could only be as a result of the variable. What are the variables that we have, and what is the constant that we have?

Consistently for almost four years, our economy pre-2025 had been characterised by currency depreciation, and high interest rates. Mr Speaker, the only variable that we had for the last year has been a change in government. There is a new President, a new Economic Management Team, and a new Minister for Finance. I wonder when people say, the changes that we are seeing now are as a result of things that we did previously. This House must be commended for the changes initiated by the Minister for Finance. We were here when the Minister presented the 2025 Budget, as part of the Budget, there were some policy reforms that the Minister presented. The key one was the amendment to the Public Procurement Authority Act to include commitment authorisation. Hitherto, state-owned agencies could commit the State to costs that there was no money for because the Minister for Finance was not aware. When this House passed this amendment and brought in 'commitment authorisation', no State agency could do any commitment without the approval of the Minister. When our public debts reduce from 69 per cent of our GDP to 45 per cent of GDP, it did not come from the skies. It is as a result of the pulse, the hands and the eyes that the Minister has.

Now, when you watch the Public Accounts Committee and you see expenditures by State-Owned Enterprises and you ask, for instance, a State agency like Electricity Company of Ghana, why they spent beyond their appropriation, it was because, at the time, there were no eyes on them. Now, we have a Minister who has introduced an innovation to hold

these agencies accountable. Even when appropriation is authorised, they still need commitment authorisation. So, for those seeking to know why the debt to GDP is now 45 per cent, they need to thank the Minister and this Government.

Exchange rates is a function of the demand and supply of forex. If you have a lot of a particular resource, prices will go down. If you have less of those resources and there is demand for it, prices will rise up. If you do not have the forex, you would not be able to manage the economy. This House enacted the Gold Board Act, 2025 (Act 1140). Hitherto, individuals were responsible for purchasing gold and exporting them. After the passage of the Act, it has become the sole responsibility of the GoldBod. It brings foreign exchange into the markets. When forex flows in, the GoldBod working together with the Central Bank, will manage this foreign exchange resources that is in the economy. When there is adequate supply of foreign currency, then the measures the Minister spoke about in managing the forex efficiently in order to stabilize the cedi, comes in. What we are witnessing are the results of direct policies led by the Minister for Finance and the Government of Ghana. I have highlighted the GoldBod as well as the other policies introduced by the Minister.

Mr Speaker, the economy is in safe hands. We are no longer under autopilot. There is a pilot responsible for directing the affairs of the economy. The captain is also being anchored by the Minister for Finance. We have a sector like the Agricultural Sector that is growing

steadily. When the agricultural sector grows at this pace, the 6.3 per cent cannot be credited to work done previously by someone else. Let us pay attention to the 2026 Budget. Next year, we should not return here claiming we do not understand why the economy is growing the way it is.

3:26 p.m.

In Paragraph 836, the Minister for Finance states, “Mr Speaker, to further strengthen expenditure discipline and improve value for money, the following operational structural reforms will be pursued:” It is going to integrate Ghana Electronic Procurement System (GHANEPS) with Ghana Integrated Financial Management Information System (GIFMIS) so that procurement will be dealt with.

Mr Speaker, the Minister also states that Sections 96 and 98 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 will be enforced so that breaches relating to arrears accumulation and noncompliance with commitment controls will be dealt with. Most importantly, Mr Speaker, I heard a Colleague talk about the fact that if we go to a lot of Assemblies, the money is sitting there, but they are not utilising them. The Minister for Finance has seen this. It is the reason he states in Paragraph 839 that he is going to implement a review of the procurement threshold. These thresholds were established almost 10 years ago. Most of these procurement entities have a threshold. They cannot procure beyond that threshold, but because of inflation, cedi depreciation and the rest, some of

these entities have contract sums exceeding their threshold. So, they cannot do even a basic six-unit classroom block without having a concurrent approval from the Regional Coordinating Council. The Minister for Finance has given us indication that he is going to deal with this.

Mr Speaker, apart from this, there is also a value for money office to be established, so that we go beyond just making sure that we do the right procurement to making sure contracts are finished at the times that they are supposed to be done. These are far-reaching measures, so I want my Friends to avert their minds to the fact that next year, when we come back here to debate and to also explain why the economy is now described as robust, and moving in the right direction, we will know that there are policies and there are deliberate policies —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, your time is up. It is now the turn of Hon Onyina-Acheampong. You have seven minutes.

Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (NPP — Kwabre East): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the ongoing debate on the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana.

Mr Speaker, whilst this Budget Statement and Economic Policy, as presented by the Minister for Finance highlights certain strides in selected sectors, it offers little clarity and

credibility regarding its overall policy direction and, more importantly, the capacity to achieve the targets that it has set for itself. Mr Speaker, the 2025 Budget highlighted that per the end of the third quarter, revenue will be GH¢162.6 billion but we achieved GH¢154.9 billion. That is short of close to GH¢8 billion.

Amidst this shortfall, the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy is projecting an increase in revenue of GH¢42 billion, which is around 18.5 per cent. Mr Speaker, notwithstanding this shortfall, we are witnessing that the Minister for Finance is saying that he would repeal COVID-19 and some revenue handles, which in effect will lead to another revenue shortfall of GH¢5.7 billion. Mr Speaker, if even with all the complements of the revenue handles, they were not able to achieve the revenue target, why do they say that they are going to reduce these tax handles and still be able to achieve an increased budget of an extra GH¢42 billion? That is why we are saying that this Budget Statement and Economic Policy lacks credibility.

Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance, in the 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy promised us that he is not going to introduce any new tax handles. But he came back to this House to introduce some more revenue enhancement budget areas, which included the extra GH¢1 on every gallon of fuel, the increase in the growth and sustainability levy from 1 per cent to 3 per cent, and other tax handles when he told us he was not going to increase any

tax handles. Mr Speaker, would be ambushed like we were ambushed in the 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy going forward in this 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy? Is the Minister for Finance going to come back to this House and introduce further tax handles? This cannot be tolerated.

Mr Speaker, in expenditure, he is saying that we are short by GH¢29 billion, meanwhile, revenue was short by only GH¢8 billion. So, if we are short of revenue by 4.7 per cent and expenditure by 18.5 per cent or 14 per cent, what are they doing?

On the subject, there has been little or no commitment to their flagship policies. Mr Speaker, in the 24-hour economy, they promised formula 1-3-3, one job, three shifts, three people. Now, they have turned around and said that it has been talked through, and that the passport office, the Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA) office, civil service and other institutions were all going to work 24 hours a day, three shifts. This is what the people of Ghana saw and voted massively—the youth voted massively, because they thought that if we employ one million people, it is time that we employ three million people. Now, the Hon Majority Leader has been quoted to have said that the emphasis on the 24-Hour Economy would not be on government but on the private sector. Even with that, there has been very little commitment to this 24-Hour Economy.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, let them stop your time. Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, he is obviously doing very well, and let me commend him for putting up a very good performance. I said that the 24-Hour Economy would happen at all levels, so it is not one project for which we make one budgetary allocation. We have a coordinating centre that facilitates, and then all the sectors will be performing and enable the creation of the jobs; that was what I said.

Mr Onyina-Acheampong: Thank you, Mr Speaker. We all heard what the Majority Leader said, they have been shifting posts to and fro, all the time. This is no news to us.

Mr Speaker, to put this into context, they allocated GH¢110 million to a policy that is supposed to generate 1.7 million jobs, and then they allocate GH¢292 million to sanitary pads; National Apprenticeship Programme (NAP), GH¢170 million; Adwumawura, GH¢160 million; mini-stadiums, GH¢200 million; and rebasing of GDP, GH¢207 million. Does this show commitment to a policy that they promised Ghanaians would generate all this money? This does not show commitment, Mr Speaker.

We are not surprised. They did the same thing in the National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS), when they promised a one-time premium, and when they were given the opportunity, they did nothing about the one-time premium.

Mr Speaker, this Government is having issues in solving *galamsey* because of what they did and said when

they were in opposition. Mr Kwaku Boahen was on video telling people that during the 2020 election, that in January 2021, when they vote NDC into power on January 7, 2021, they can go back to their sites. The President, on July 7th, 2024, in his interaction with the media, told them that he is going to grant amnesty to people who have been jailed or arrested because they have done *galamsey*.

3:36 p.m.

He did not say small-scale mining; he said *galamsey*. He is going to grant amnesty.

Mr Speaker, it is no news that they are struggling to conquer *galamsey* because it is their own words that is trapping them. They are saying that men are trapped by their words and bulls are trapped by their horns. The horns of NDC have trapped them.

Mr Speaker, *galamsey* is affecting us. Our water bodies are being destroyed. Our forests are being depleted. We are dying slowly. It is said that when the last tree dies, the last man dies. Water is life. *Galamsey* is killing us. The Hon Minister for Finance should put more money into tackling *galamsey*. This Government is disappointing Ghanaians and encouraging *galamsey*. The National Anti-Illegal Mining Operations Secretariat (NAIMOS) was running away at Tontokrom. They are emboldening their people to do *galamsey*. Previously, when they see the military, they ran, but now they are up in arms against the military because the Government has promised to embolden them to do *galamsey*.

Mr Speaker, I thank you so much, and I rest my case.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we would take a break from the commentary on the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy and consider item numbered 10 (c) on the *Order Paper*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Presentation of Papers on item numbered 10 (c).

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I thought you would look at your left hand, at least, when the Majority Leader makes a call. But we are trying to catch your attention.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, you have the Floor.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we will not obstruct. We are for it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. Item numbered 10 (c).

PAPER

By the Chairman of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Economy and Development on the Request for the review of the Investment Policy and Management of the Ghana Petroleum Funds in accordance with Section 30(1)(a) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815).

The Report has been duly presented, and it is for distribution to Hon Members.

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, just to bring to your attention that the Report was laid early in the morning by Mr Isaac Adongo— It was not? All right.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, this was not done. It was the Reports in item numbered 10 (b) that were laid. So, we are doing the proper thing now.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I will encourage my Friend—we miss him. I will encourage him to stay in the House. Mr Speaker, you rightly corrected him it was—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Report has been duly laid and it is for distribution to Hon Members.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the procedural Motion 31 for now.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, at page 14. Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

MOTION

Suspension of Order 104(1)

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Eric Afful): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a motion shall not be debated until at least

two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the motion is given, the motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Economy and Development on the Request for the review of the Investment Policy and Management of the Ghana Petroleum Funds in accordance with Section 30(1)(a) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815) may be *moved* today.

Mr Isaac Adongo: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will now take Motion numbered 32.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

MOTION

Report of the Committee on Economy and Development on the Review of the Investment Policy and Management of the Ghana Petroleum Funds

Chairman of the Committee (Dr Eric Afful): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Economy and Development on the

Request for the review of the Investment Policy and Management of the Ghana Petroleum Funds in

accordance with Section 30(1)(a) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815).

1.0. INTRODUCTION

The Request for the review of the Investment Policy and Management of the Ghana Petroleum Funds in accordance with Section 30(1)(a) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815) was presented to the House on Thursday, 13th November, 2025 by the Hon. Minister for Finance, Mr. Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson.

Rt. Hon. Speaker referred the request to the Committee on Economy and Development for consideration and report.

~~The Committee met with the Minister for Finance, Mr. Dr Cassiel Ato Baah~~
Forson, the Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem and officers from the Ministry of Finance to consider the referral.

2.0. REFERENCES

The Committee referred to the following documents to consider the request:

1. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
2. The Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815); and
3. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana

3.0 BACKGROUND

The Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (act 815) was enacted to provide the framework for the collection, allocation and management of petroleum revenue in a responsible, transparent, accountable and sustainable manner for the benefit of the citizens of Ghana. The Act provides a robust governance framework for the efficient and optimal management of petroleum.

Section 29 of the Act established an Investment Advisory Committee to advise the Minister and for the general performance monitoring of the management of the Ghana Petroleum Funds. Section 27(2) of the Act empowers the Minister to review the range of instruments designated as Qualifying Instruments every three (3) years or sooner on the advice of the Investment Advisory Committee.

Section 30 of Act 815 provides for the functions of the Investment Management Committee which, among others is responsible for formulation and proposing to the Minister the investment policy and management of the Ghana Stabilisation

Fund and the Ghana Heritage Fund and such proposals are to be submitted by the Minister to Parliament for approval.

Although implementation of Act 815 has generally been effective, there is nonetheless a need to continuously assess the law and amend where necessary to reflect changing policies and global developments.

Section 61 of Act 815 defined "qualifying instrument" as

- (a) a debt instrument denominated in internationally convertible currency that bears interest or an amount equivalent to interest,
 - (i) that is of an investment grade security, and
 - (ii) that is issued by or guaranteed by the International Monetary Fund, World Bank or by a sovereign State other than the Republic of Ghana, if the issuer or guarantor has investment grade rating; or
- (b) an internationally convertible currency deposit or a debt instrument denominated in any internally convertible currency that bears interest or a fixed amount equivalent to interest issued by
 - (i) the Bank for International Settlements;
 - (ii) the European Central Bank;
 - (iii) the Central Bank of a sovereign State, other than the Republic of Ghana, with a long term investment grade rating; or
- (c) a derivative instrument

(i) that is solely based on an instrument satisfies the requirements of paragraphs (a) and (b); and

(ii) where acquisition reduces the financial exposure to the risks associated with the underlying instruments prescribed by Minister;

A review of the Act especially the performance of the qualifying instruments brought to the fore that the current instruments were restricted to low-risk internationally denominated securities such as debt instruments, convertible currency deposits and derivative instruments issued by entities other than the Republic of Ghana and this had limited the potential to earn higher and more productive risk-adjusted foreign currency returns.

Further, an assessment of the performance of the Ghana Petroleum Funds (GPFs) by the Investment Advisory Committee revealed that the returns on the GPFs have been sub-optimal due to the narrow range of Qualifying Instruments provided for under Section 61 of Act 815. In order to address this sub-optimal returns, the Investment Advisory Committee advised the Minister for Finance to designate additional Qualifying Instruments in which the GPFs and subsequently the Ghana Petroleum Wealth Funds would be invested. The proposed Qualifying Instruments seek to diversify the current investment portfolio, enhance returns and align the GPFs with Ghana's broader transformation agenda while preserving the capital base for intergenerational equity.

In compliance with Section 30 of Act 815, the Minister for Finance has submitted the proposals from the Investment Advisory Committee to Parliament for approval.

4.0 OBJECT OF THE REQUEST

The object of the request is to seek approval to enable the Minister for Finance review of the Investment Policy and Management of the Ghana Petroleum Funds to designate additional Qualifying Instruments pursuant to the advice of the Investment Advisory Committee and in accordance with Section 30(1)(a) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815).

5.0 OBSERVATIONS

5.1 Rationale for the Request

The Committee was informed that Act 815 provided a rigid system for prescribing qualifying instruments limiting them to low-risk internationally denominated securities such as debt instruments, convertible currency deposits and derivative instruments issued by entities other than the Republic of Ghana.

The Technical team explained that while these requirements partially met the diversification objectives and had ensured stability by investing in risk-free, foreign currency-denominated, investment-grade bonds issued by the IMF, World Bank or other highly rated governments, the framework for investing had limited the potential to earn higher and more productive risk-adjusted foreign currency returns.

The Committee noted that currently the Ghana Petroleum Funds (GPFs) were being invested in the following instruments:

- a. Overnight and call deposits
- b. Discount notes
- c. Treasury Bills
- d. Short-Term deposits
- e. Investment grade bonds

f. Certificates of deposits

g. Commercial papers

h. Medium term notes

The Committee's attention was also drawn to the fact that due to the low yields, the GPFs returns were sub-optimal as the GPFs had generated a net provide (investment income) of US\$194.89million since its inception representing 13.39% over the period (equivalent to an average annual return of approximately 1%). Comparatively, the benchmark S&P 500 Index has delivered an average annualized return of approximately 14% over the same period.

In order to realize the purpose for investing the Ghana Petroleum Funds and in accordance with Section 29 and 30 of Act 815, the Investment Advisory Committee advised that the current qualifying instruments be expanded. The expanded qualifying instruments would follow principles of investing only in commercial grade projects that have credible sponsors and are US dollar or other foreign currency denominated. They would also have strong security packages, escrow accounts and partial risk or credit guarantees issued by a local or international financial organization. They would also meet approved minimum thresholds and their performance can be benchmarked against global indices.

The proposed additions will better align the investment instruments under the Ghana Stabilization Fund (GSF) and the Ghana Heritage Funds (GHF) with Ghana's long-term development objectives and improve long term risk-adjusted returns through carefully circumscribed and well-governed investment in domestic and regional infrastructure.

The Minister informed the Committee that he associates himself with the advise of the Investment Advisory Committee and pursuant to Section 30 of Act 815, the advice was submitted to the House for approval. He stated that if approved, an Executive Instrument will be issued and gazette to designate the additional

Qualifying Instruments. He therefore called on Parliament to approve the request to enable the Ghana Petroleum Funds earn much more returns.

5.2 Types of Additional Instruments to be issued

In response to the types of additional Instruments to be issued, the Minister stated that the specific instruments would be decided only after Parliament had approved the request. He however assured the Committee that according to the advice from the Investment Advisory Committee, the proposed Instruments would comply with the following criteria:

- (a) Foreign currency-denominated debt instruments issued under Government-approved frameworks to finance national energy investments in the following areas:
 - a. Electricity generating plants consistent with long term national energy plans and other policy priorities; and
 - b. National gas processing, pipeline transmission and downstream distribution systems;
- (b) Sovereign and multilateral energy instruments which are denominated in international convertible currencies and hold investment-grade or equivalent rating:
 - a. Bonds or notes issued by or fully guaranteed by sovereign states other than the Republic of Ghana or by multilateral or regional development or energy institutions such as ECOWAS bank for Investment and Development, African Development Bank, African Finance Corporation and West Africa Power pool; and
 - b. Participation in pooled African energy transition or infrastructure funds led by the African Continental free trade Area, Economic Community or West African States or African Development bank, among others

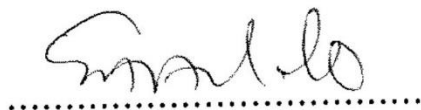
projects with credible sponsors and are US dollar or other foreign currency denominated.

6.0 CONCLUSION

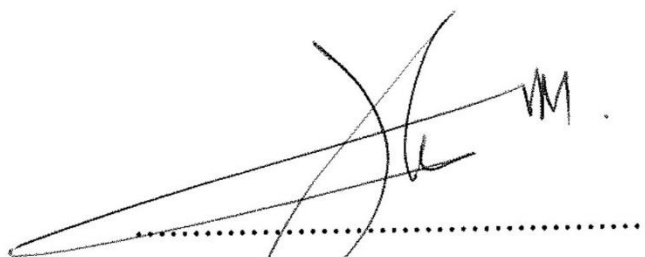
After careful considerations, the Committee is of the opinion that the request was in the right direction as it would enable Government to expand the qualifying instruments to enable the State earn more returns on the Ghana Petroleum Funds in line with Ghana's long term development objectives.

The Committee by consensus recommends to the House to adopt its report and approve the Request for the review of the Investment Policy and Management of the Ghana Petroleum Funds in accordance with Section 30(1)(a) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815).

Respectfully submitted.



SAMUEL ADUAMOAH-ADDO
CLERK, COMMITTEE ON ECONOMY
AND DEVELOPMENT



HON ERIC AFFUL
CHAIRMAN, COMMITTEE ON
ECONOMY AND DEVELOPMENT

NOVEMBER 2025

3:36 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved and the Report has been presented. Any seconder to the Motion?

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, I second the Motion and by so doing, I would like to make a few comments.

Mr Speaker, the Act that established the Petroleum Revenue Management, which is Act 185, envisioned that every three years the qualifying instruments should be reviewed by the Minister for Finance upon the advice of the Investment Advisory Council in order to determine whether the qualifying instruments are adequate, given the circumstances of the time.

It has been almost 11 to 14 years we have never reviewed the qualifying instruments, and it is becoming obvious given the kind of yield that we are getting on those investments.

Mr Speaker, over the last 14 years we are getting a yield of about one per cent a year from the oil revenue that we invest in those qualifying instruments. Yet when we are in trouble, we go back to the very instruments that we are investing in, the World Bank, the IMF, and they give us a loan and charge us five per cent or six per cent.

Meanwhile, it is the same money that we give them for one per cent that they

give to us and we pay for about four per cent to five per cent.

So, it has become imperative that given the requirements to invest in our economy and be able to propel growth, while still keeping and not touching those sovereign funds, the instruments that we are investing in should be modified in order to provide room for some investment that can be designated from certain sources that will come back to support the economy of Ghana.

So, it will achieve the dual purpose of investing in our economy and making sure that we up the yield that we get from one per cent to something else, and the guidance that we are receiving is that something in the region of four per cent plus or minus two is what we are looking at.

So, Mr Speaker, I want to urge my Colleagues to support the Hon Minister by approving this request so that we can make the most out of the oil resources that are invested for basically peanuts outside of our country.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member for Manso Nkwanta, you have the floor.

Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (NDC — Manso Nkwanta): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I rise to support the Motion, and in doing so, I have a few comments.

Mr Speaker, the focus of this amendment is to improve the returns that we have on these investments. That is agreeable. It makes sense that when you have investments you would expect to have good returns.

The flip side, Mr Speaker, is the fact that as one is expecting higher returns, then one must be ready to accept higher risks. So, at the Committee, the assurance that was given was that there is going to be more of guarantees from institutions to back these risks that we are exposing ourselves to. So, our advice as a Committee was that we should be careful as to which institutions we are taking these guarantees from, because if you are shifting the risks to other institutions, then it means you need to assess these institutions well. We advised that in sending these risks to other institutions, we should spread the risk and not load a lot of the risk on individual institutions.

Comments were made about getting guarantees from banks in Ghana and possibly within the sub-region. But then we considered the fact that the capital status of most banks in Ghana and within the sub-region are not that big, therefore, it would be better to spread it across and probably even look beyond the sub-region so that the risk is well spread across. This is so that in case we need to claim there is reliability that the institutions that we are transferring these risks to have the capacity to make good of these claims. But in general, we support this Motion.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Yes, Hon Darko-Mensah?

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP – Takoradi): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I rise in support of the Motion, ably moved by the Chairperson of the Committee, in support of the request of the Hon Minister for changes to Act 815 on the qualifying instruments for the petroleum funds of this country.

Mr Speaker, this is very important because in the Report, we are told that only 1 per cent is what we are earning on these funds. We all know the debate that has gone on about the Heritage Fund in this country, about its use and why we just put it there without it being used. I in particular have been here when I supported that amendment. I believe that it is time we get money from our money, so that we can use the profit to invest.

One area I am very interested in is that, while other people are looking at other qualifying instruments, you would quite remember that all over the world, like the Saudi Arabia Sovereign Fund, they are now investing them in the real economy. And if we take this Report, looking at an average rate of about 8 to 12 per cent in investing in electricity companies and projects and transmission lines, I am clear that that is the best way to go. At least, if we are not even investing all in the new agenda we are setting for ourselves with this Report, I

believe that we can taper it with the standard ones we have been doing and start consistently investing over time, we will be making a lot of money to support the growth of the youth in this country.

Mr Speaker, I am very happy because when you put your money in the banks, they do not give good returns. But if we invest in companies that are actually generating proper sales all the time, naturally we get more money.

Recently, I was writing a paper on the compounding effect of sales, instead of the compounding interest that this world has been made to believe. And I believe that investing in the real economy as part of the qualifying instrument for this investment is key. I am also happy that they have also requested for other guarantees to protect it as well. I believe that when we start earning more, the youth of this country will feel the impact, especially in job creating opportunities where this investment will go.

But I believe that in the long term, Mr Speaker, apart from looking at West Africa and the rest of the world, maybe it is time we also start looking at home, because there are a lot of investment opportunities in this country. Now, cocoa is doing very well. Why can we not look at cocoa companies and invest in them? This is because if you put in GH¢5 billion and people are getting GH¢140 billion, why not put them in the cocoa factories and get some of the money as part of the qualifying instruments for this fund?

So, with these few words, Mr Speaker, I would like to support the Report, and I believe that all Members will support us to change and expand the qualifying instruments for this.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Leadership?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, if I may, I wish to yield to Hon Samuel Abdulai Jinapor.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Samuel Abdulai Jinapor, you have the floor.

Mr Samuel Abdulai Jinapor (NPP –Damongo): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to this very important Report, which will go to the heart of our efforts of national development.

Mr Speaker, I support the effort that is being made to broaden the investment policy and management of the Ghana Petroleum Fund in accordance with Section 31 (a) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2021 (Act 815). If we take a careful look at the Report, we will see that at paragraph 5.0 on page 5, the Committee did a very excellent job on their observations, specifically on the rationale for the request. The Committee states, and I quote:

“that the Committee noted that currently the Ghana Petroleum Fund were being invested in the following instruments...”,
And it lists them from (a) to (h).

3:56 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I think it is important that this House makes the point to the Ministry and Government to ensure that measures and policies are put in place to maximise these Instruments, which are being alluded to.

Mr Speaker, then at paragraph 5.2, the Committee makes an in-depth analysis under the caption, “types of additional instruments to be issued”, and there I have a little concern. We will see that on page 7, the Committee observed, and with your permission, I quote,

“In response to the types of additional instruments to be issued, the Minister stated that the specific instruments will be decided only after Parliament has approved the request. He, however, assured the committee that according to the advice from the investment advisory committee, the proposed instruments will comply with the following criteria...”

And the criteria are set out from A to B.

Mr Speaker, I think that Parliament should continue to keep an eye on the criteria that would be used and the specific investment Instruments which are going to be deployed by the Ministry, and for that matter, the Government, to ensure that we maximise the additional Instrument, the additional investment, which will accrue to this firm.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, I also think that the Ministry and the Government should pay attention to the data we have today. The data shows that if one takes, for example, 2024, the petroleum revenue which accrued to the Government of Ghana stood at US\$840.7 million. As we speak, we are talking about the petroleum revenue of US\$370.34 million. That is a reduction of 56 per cent of our petroleum revenue receipts.

In 2025, we have had a reduction of production of 25.9 per cent reduction as compared to 2024, and therefore, I believe that the Government will have to pay attention to the upstream industry when it comes to the petroleum sector, and to put in place measures such as making exploration more incentivising and getting to a lot more petroleum agreement to ensure that ultimately our production will inch up moving forward. This will eventually result in an increment in revenue accruing to the State, and which, obviously, Mr Speaker, as one can well imagine, will populate this fund and its management for the betterment of our country.

Mr Speaker, with these words, I support the request that has been made to the House. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leadership. Yes, Minister for Finance.

Minister for Finance (Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson) (MP): Mr Speaker, I presented a memo to Parliament for approval in line with Section 27(1) and 2. Section 27(1) of Act 815 states that:

“(1) The resources of the Ghana Petroleum Funds and subsequently the Ghana Petroleum Wealth Fund shall be invested in qualifying instruments prescribed by Executive Instrument.

(2) The range of instruments designated as qualifying instruments shall be reviewed every three years or sooner by the Minister on the advice of the Investment Advisory Committee.”

Mr Speaker, since 2011, this provision has not been adhered to. As a result, our petroleum resources, as invested, are yielding only about one per cent in interest. Unfortunately, our petroleum resources have not worked hard enough for us, and we believe that the time has come for us to review how we invest this resource.

Mr Speaker, if we are to look at Section 39 of the same Act 815, it says that:

“The Minister shall provide Parliament with any advice given by the Investment Advisory Committee within seven days.”

On 11th November 2025, the Investment Advisory Committee advised me to take action by amending the qualifying Instrument. In line with Section 39, I am compelled to come before this House and provide the advice and seek further approval.

Mr Speaker, if we are to look at Section 30 of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, Act 815, it goes on to say that:

“The functions of the Investment Advisory Committee are to (a) formulate and propose to the Minister the investment policy and management of the Ghana Stabilisation Fund and the Ghana Heritage Fund, and the Minister shall submit it for approval by Parliament.”

Mr Speaker, it does not only say seven days, but after receiving the advice in seven days, I have to come before the House. The law is quite a strict one; if we look at Section 38, I have only 48 hours to review this and appear before the House. And so, today being the seventh day since I received the advice, it is important to bring this to the notice of the House. What I like about this amendment is the fact that it recommends a two-track approach, which is as follows: “(a) to retain the existing base of Foreign Investment-Grade Sovereign Instrument.”

So, we are not running away from the existing base, but we are to retain it. Mr Speaker, “(b) expressly include additional categories of assets subject to strict criteria and caps.” They also clarified that any Domestic Instrument held by the Ghana Petroleum Funds does not constitute borrowings against the Petroleum Holding Fund or petroleum reserves in line with Section 5.2 of the amendment of the amended Act 815.

Again, it says that:

“This does not contradict Section 10.4, which provides that every 15 years Parliament may review

restrictions placed on the Ghana Heritage Fund and transfer accrued interest into any other funds established under the Petroleum Revenue Management Act (PRMA)."

Mr Speaker, it went further to say that:

"This will be subject to explicit portfolio caps to be determined by the Investment Advisory Committee following regular rigorous benchmark assessment."

So, even though the amendment seeks to add on, they have provided very strict criteria to ensure that, at the minimum, our Petroleum Funds are protected and at the same time, yield the necessary income to grow the fund over a period of time.

In so doing, Mr Speaker, the advice is to include the following:

"(a) foreign currency-denominated debt instrument issued under a government-approved framework to finance national energy investment in the following areas. Electricity generation and natural gas processing.

(b) sovereign and multilateral energy instruments, which are denominated in internationally convertible currencies and hold investment-grade or equivalent ratings. And these are as follows. Bonds or notes issued by or fully guaranteed by sovereign states other than the Republic of Ghana or by

multilateral or regional development or energy institutions such as the ECOWAS Bank for Investment and Development, African Development Bank, Africa Finance Corporation, and West Africa Power Pool (WAPP)."

Mr Speaker, finally, it says that:

"Participation in pooled Africa energy transitions or infrastructure funds led by the African Continental Free Trade Area, the Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) or the Africa Development Bank."

Mr Speaker, all of these are to ensure that, at a minimum, our Petroleum Funds will not yield only 1 per cent, but will yield in excess of 8 per cent. This will mean that in the future, we will be able to come here and celebrate the amount of income that our Petroleum Funds have been able to accrue.

Mr Speaker, today we have about GH¢1.456 billion in our Petroleum Funds being invested. Unfortunately, we are yielding only one per cent.

4:06 p.m.

Mr Speaker, largely, the instruments we have benefited from and invested in, are largely IMF-issued bonds or World Bank-issued bonds: 1 per cent, we believe is too small and on the advice of the Investment Advisory Council and the Petroleum Revenue Management Act 815, I am before this House, to provide that advice and seek your approval.

Mr Speaker, I so submit.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Majority Leader, before I come to you, let me take two minutes suspension.

4:06 p.m. – *Sitting suspended.*

4:08 p.m. – *Sitting resumed.*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 25; it is a procedural Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Chief Whip, the item numbered 25?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, in the spirit of cooperation, we are not opposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairperson of the Committee, take item 25.

MOTIONS

Suspension of Standing Order 104 (1)

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two

sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the motion is given, the motion for the adoption of the Report of the Finance Committee on the Master Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Tata Consultancy Services Limited for Professional Services may be moved today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved. Any seconder?

Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

The First Deputy Speaker: Now, consequential Motion number 26. Chairperson of the Committee?

Report of the Finance Committee on the Master Agreement between the GoG and Tata Consultancy Services Limited for Professional Services

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Finance Committee on the Master Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry

of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Tata Consultancy Services Limited for Professional Services.

Introduction

The Master Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd for professional services and the request for waiver of 20 per cent Withholding Tax on the income of Tata Consultancy Service Limited (as service provider) and Value Added Tax (VAT) amounting to the Ghana Cedi equivalent of US\$10,460,000.00 on imported services under the implementation of the Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS) Project and was presented to Parliament by Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, in accordance with Article 181 of the 1992 Constitution on Thursday, 13th November, 2025.

Subsequently, the Agreement was referred to the Finance Committee for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 226 of Parliament.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Agreement, met with the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, Hon Deputy Minister of Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem, Commissioner-General of the Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA), Mr Anthony Sarpong and the

technical teams from the Ministry of Finance and GRA.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents in the consideration of the Agreement:

- i The 1992 Constitution
- ii The Standing Orders of Parliament
- iii The Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921)

Object of the Agreement

The object of the agreement is to implement ITAS to improve compliance, expand the tax base, reduce leakages and enhance revenue from the digital economy.

Background

Over the years, GRA's legacy systems have served mainly to automate basic tax functions such as taxpayer registration, return filing and account management. However, the systems have become outdated, fragmented and increasingly inadequate to support the demands of a dynamic economy and the evolving complexity of domestic and international tax administration.

Currently, GRA operates multiple standalone systems that do not provide a unified view of taxpayers or enable efficient compliance monitoring. The multiple systems that exist now limits GRA's ability to deliver quality taxpayer

services, track and enforce compliance effectively. As part of broader reforms to address these challenges and improve domestic revenue mobilisation, GRA prioritised the implementation of modern Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS) which led to the signing of the Agreement on 28th May, 2024. The agreement was signed for the reason that ITAS will automate and streamline core tax administration functions such as taxpayer registration, return filing, payments, auditing, and enforcement. The automation will enhance the accuracy, timeliness and integrity of taxpayer data. As work progresses to expand the revenue base and improve service delivery across sectors, ITS will serve as a critical tool in supporting data-driven compliance strategies, enabling risk-based taxpayer profiling, promoting inter-agency collaboration and reducing the administrative burden on taxpayers.

Consequently, the International Monetary Fund (IMF) made ITAS a key structural benchmark under the ongoing Extended Credit Facility (ECF) Programme. The IMF has identified the implementation of ITAS as essential for enhancing tax compliance, boosting revenue performance and improving the business environment.

The procurement of ITAS Project initially commenced through a competitive bidding process. However, the process was cancelled towards its conclusion due to the transition in leadership within the GRA in 2024. The new leadership opted to proceed with Tata Consultancy Services – a non-resident service provider based in India

that had received the highest technical score under the cancelled process. The final selection was made through a single-sourced procurement, with approval from the Public Procurement Authority (copy attached).

The Project is expected to span three to four years and will be executed in three phases. A key provision in the contract stipulates that GRA is supposed to grant a tax waiver of 20 per cent withholding tax on the income of the service provider and Value Added Tax imported services. The ITAS will provide a 360-degree view of taxpayers' obligations and interaction risk-based compliance management, timely enforcement and targeted taxpayer support. It will integrate the domestic tax administration system with the existing Customs platform - the Integrated Customs Management System (ICUMS), as well as with key stakeholders including Office of the Registrar of Companies (ORC) and Financial Institutions. The implementation of the Project will enable GRA achieve its vision of operating a fully digital, paperless and data-driven tax administration system.

In line with Article 181(5) of the 1992 Constitution, any international business or economic transaction to which Government is a party, must be approved by Parliament. In addition, Section 33(1) of the Public Financial Management Act 2016 (Act 921) requires that any multi-year expenditure commitment must receive prior written approval from the Minister for Finance and be authorised by Parliament in accordance with Article 181 of the

Constitution and this is the reason for the request by the Minister for Finance.

Cost of the Project

The total cost of the Project as revised amounted to US\$44.24million.

Out of this amount, an amount of US\$**10.46m** is in respect of withholding tax, VAT and other levies. Details of the breakdown are as follows:

Description	Initial Cost US\$ million	Revised Costs US\$ million
Cost software and related items	25.3	20.00
20 per cent WHT	6.2	5.00
VAT and Levies	6.9	5.46
Sub Total	38.4	30.46
Hardware and related items (Including VAT)	15.0	13.78
TOTAL	53.4	44.24

Observations and Recommendations

Reduction in the Cost of the project

The Committee observed that the initial total cost of the project amounted to US\$ 53.4 million. However, after further negotiations with the Service Provider in the course of the year, the Ministry was able to renegotiate the initial amount downwards to US\$ 44.24 million.

The Committee commended the Ministry for the savings and urged the Ministry to continue to take pragmatic measures to ensure value for money.

Quantitative Gains

The Committee also observed that the implementation of ITAS as a modern end-to-end digital platform for tax administration, will have a significant positive impact on domestic tax revenue

mobilization because it is designed to address key inefficiencies and leakages in the current system. It will also broaden the tax base and enhance taxpayer compliance in the Country. The improvements are projected to yield substantial incremental growth in tax revenue in both the short and medium terms. The projection is based on the fact that international benchmarks on the implementation of similar systems in other jurisdictions, have yielded revenue increases of between 15 per cent to 30 per cent over a three to five-year period.

Improved Compliance and Reduced Leakages

The Committee noted the System will automate and integrate all core tax processes, such as registration, filing, assessment, payment, accounting, audit and enforcement; thereby eliminating the plethora of manual and fragmented

procedures that create room for discretion, inefficiency, and revenue loss. The automation will improve case selection for audit through a risk-based approach, ensure accurate real-time taxpayer account management and make tax evasion more difficult. These enhancements will also contribute to reducing revenue leakages and increasing net collections.

Expansion of Tax Base

The ITAS will facilitate greater integration of the domestic tax administration system with ICUMS and third-party data sources such as the National Identification Authority (NIA), Office of the Registrar of Companies (ORC) and financial institutions. The integration will provide GRA with access to broader, more accurate datasets for taxpayer identification and profiling in order to bring previously informal or non-compliant taxpayers into the tax net. The integration will also significantly increase the number of registered and active taxpayers, ultimately boosting revenue.

Enhanced Revenue from the Digital Economy

The ITAS will also provide GRA with tools to monitor and capture revenue from emerging and fast-growing sectors such as e-commerce, digital services and cross-border transactions which have proven to be difficult to track under legacy systems. Hence, ITAS will enable effective monitoring using real-time data analytics and automated

compliance features embedded in the system.

Recommendation and Conclusion

The successful implementation of the Integrated Tax Administration System is a transformative step in bringing Ghana's tax administration in line with global standards. The Project is a crucial structural benchmark under the ongoing programme with the IMF.

The Committee by consensus recommends the House to adopt this report and by resolution, ratify the Master Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd for Professional Services in line with Article 181 (5) of the Constitution and Section 33(1) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921)

The Committee also recommends to the House to approve the request for waiver of 20 per cent Withholding Tax on the income of Tata Consultancy Service Limited (as service provider) and Value Added Tax (VAT) amounting to the Ghana Cedi equivalent of US\$10,460,000.00 on imported services under the implementation of the Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS) Project, in accordance with Article 174(1) of the 1992 Constitution of Ghana and the Exemptions Act 2022 (Act 1083).

Respectfully Submitted.

Mr Speaker, this Agreement was signed in 2024. The Ministry inherited it. But at the time the Ministry inherited it, the IMF, having looked at the Agreement and having looked at the services that Tata Services was going to provide, had decided that it was so crucial to the implementation on the ongoing Programme. Therefore, they made it a structural benchmark.

Unfortunately, the implementation could not happen before the Government left office, and the current Minister for Finance took over. By which time the IMF had progressed this arrangement to become a prior action for our subsequent reviews.

As a result, the Minister has come to us to seek approval for, one, the master Agreement, and two, the withholding taxes of US\$10.46 million, so that he can go ahead and implement the Programme.

Mr Speaker, the Committee therefore recommends to this House to adopt the Report and grant the Minister the permission to proceed with this Agreement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, thank you.

The Motion has been moved and the Report presented. Any seconder? Yes, Mr Richard Acheampong.

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion and speak to the Report before us.

Mr Speaker, we are all crying for revenue mobilisation, so if there is any solution that will help us generate more revenue, I think that is the way to go. This a new solution which will bring efficiency and help us generate more revenue for our national development. So, the Committee met and the explanation they gave to us, got us convinced that if we get this solution approved, it would enhance our revenue mobilisation.

They implemented this in other jurisdictions, which has given them between 15 to 30 per cent revenue increase. So, we believe that if we are able to procure this solution, it is going to enhance our revenue generation, and we can get more resources for national development. I think this is a very good solution that we need to approve.

Then the original Agreement was 53.4 million and it was revised to 44.24 million, making a savings of 9.16 million. So, I think the Minister has done well by way of renegotiating the numbers for us to get value for money.

I call on my Colleagues to support this Report so that we get it done and then the Minister can move to collect more revenue for us.

Thank you very much for the opportunity.

Question Proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib?

4:16 p.m.

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker, thank you for this opportunity. I have been thinking that 20 per cent exemption is humongous for a company like Tata Consultancy Service Limited. I think that it does not provide us a level playing field against the backdrop that we know that this is a tax on account. The Government is granting Tata an exemption of the withholding tax of 20 per cent. Mr Speaker, withholding tax is a tax on account. What it means is that it will help the Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA) to determine the income of the business and the amount of moneys that will be accrued will now be diverted. What would have come to Ghana if it is US\$10 million? That is huge.

This is now what we are diversifying as a result of this waiver. If we should go this route and we are not very careful in providing a level playing field for Ghanaian companies – because if you are talking about Tata, it is not a small company; it is a big company. They have the wherewithal, they have the capacity, and they have the resources. This is something that I think that, to a larger extent, is not a bad step, but the company in perspective is not a company that is now wobbling. It is a company that is already on its feet and has the resources. What are we doing to other businesses who are not in the same position to, as it were, compete with them?

Mr Speaker, I think that we should have a relook at this, and see if we can still look at some amendments and

maybe even the amount involved before we proceed to have a finality on this matter.

Mr Speaker, respectfully submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, let the record reflect that same was discussed at the Committee that it was a majority decision, and our dissenting view is premised on principle. I am happy my Friend, the Minister, is here. Last year, in his other world, he was the Minority Leader. I witnessed the passion with which he spoke against exemption generally. After much back and forth, this House had to pass the Exemption Bill into law. Even at the point when we were bringing exemptions that were related to One District One Factory (1D1F), with the intention of creating jobs; the 1D1F concept, creating jobs, tax waiver, our Friend held the red flag and was all over the country. I do not know what has changed. We are opposed, and *ab initio* we have to make this point. We are opposed to this exemption of a whopping amount of US\$10 million being given to Tata. We are opposed. The reasons are not farfetched. We want to appeal to our Colleagues to stay on principle. They espoused this principle last year. He was then Minority Leader, now he is Minister for Finance, one would have thought that he is empowered to ensure that his principle that he believed in will be put into force. Now he is picking and choosing. When it is about Tata, he is bringing the exemption. When it is about

something else, we hear a different story. It is disappointing.

Mr Speaker, I see the Committee Chairman staring at me, and I know he agrees with me. His world has changed therefore his narrative has also changed. It is very interesting and truly revealing. I do not know what he will be telling Ghanaians, that in one breath, tax exemptions that were brought into this Chamber by the New Patriotic Party (NPP) administration to create jobs for the youth—One can imagine the number of jobs that were lost by the youth at that time when about 47 tax exemptions were opposed. The Minister for Roads and Highways is also looking at me. They were opposed. I feel sad. Today, we have been invited to be part of an illegality, something that they spoke against. Anyway, we are opposed.

It is interesting that even the Income Tax Act, 2015 (Act 896), itself gives the Commissioner General of the Ghana Revenue Authority some powers. This application should rather be made to him and not to this House, especially, knowing their track record; what they stood for. Mr Speaker, we are opposed. I urge my Side, and I see very principled Members on their Backside. They should leave them alone. They are on their own. They should go by principle. He was saying that we should oppose tax exemptions. Mr Speaker, I recall how passionate the Dr Ato Forson argued then. Today, he is picking and choosing and veering off.

We are opposed. Let the record reflect that the mighty Minority is

opposed to this tax waiver. We are opposed to this tax waiver. I do not know what justification they are going to give to Ghanaians who voted for them massively based on principle. Now, they are shying away from the very principle by which they were voted into office. God will judge them.

Mr Speaker, having said this, I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister for Finance?

Minister for Finance (Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson): Mr Speaker, on 28th May, 2024, the Ghana Revenue Authority signed a contract between Tata and GRA. The procurement of the Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS) project initially commenced through a competitive bidding in January, 2024. However, this process was cancelled towards its conclusion due to a transition between Commissioner-General Dr Ammishaddai Owusu-Amoah and Commissioner-General Julie Essiam. When Commissioner-General Julie Essiam took office, the new leadership of GRA awarded this contract on sole sourcing basis, even though there was a running competitive sourcing. It did not stop there. About one month to the general elections, in fact, on the 4th November 2024, an *addendum* was signed by Tata Consultancy Services Limited and GRA. Commissioner-General Julie Essiam signed on behalf of the GRA.

Mr Speaker, the details are as follows. It says that:

“subject to approval provided by Parliament of Ghana, Tata Consultancy Services is entitled to 20 per cent withholding tax exemption from 1st of January 2025, till the end date as set out under clause 4 of the SOW. GRA ‘shall’ be responsible and do all such act required for obtaining such approval from Parliament.”

Mr Speaker, my principle still holds. My position on tax is unwavering. Everyone knows my views about tax exemptions. But this is an agreement that was signed by the Ghana Revenue Authority, by the previous administration imposing an obligation on the people of Ghana. The key point here is that the GRA is entitled to ensure that 20 per cent withholding tax is given to Tata Consultancy Services. I have not signed this contract. In fact, the new Commissioner-General, Mr Anthony Kwasi Sarpong, never signed this contract.

Mr Speaker, the only reason I am bringing this to Parliament is that Tata Consultancy Services first is a foreign company. Before this contract should have been signed they should have come to Parliament under Article 181 (5). Mr Speaker, they did not come under Article 181(5) of the 1992 Constitution. I am here to make sure the right thing is done. I am cleaning their mess; that is what I am doing.

4:26 p.m.

Mr Speaker, apart from that, the Ministry of Finance cannot sit at the

office and approve this tax obligation. I am bringing it for approval, because if we look at the wording in the *addendum*, it further states that the “GRA shall be responsible and do all such acts required for obtaining such approvals from the Parliament of Ghana and immediately notify Tata Consultancy Services of such approval.” Mr Speaker, I am only doing my work. I am only doing what I have been asked to do. I thought my Colleague would rather applaud me. I did not only stop there. Let me tell the House what I did again.

Mr Speaker, because the process of competitive sourcing was truncated, I asked the Commissioner-General of the Ghana Revenue Authority to further renegotiate the programme. In renegotiating it, this is the outcome. Accordingly, we were able to reduce the cost of software and related items from \$25.3 million to \$20 million, saving \$5.3 million on one line alone. I did not end there. I also negotiated downwards hardware and related items from \$15 million to \$13.7 million. Everything put together, we saved more than \$9 million for renegotiating this Agreement.

The reason I renegotiated this Agreement and ensured that we implemented it well, firstly, is to be legal and stay within the remits of the law. Most importantly, the International Monetary Fund (IMF) has identified the implementation of this particular ITAS software as a structural benchmark that has been turned to prior action, so it is critical for the Republic of Ghana to implement it. Let me put on record that in spite of all the challenges around this

ITAS software, it is obvious that the ITAS software will provide a 360-degree view of taxpayers' obligations and interactions to enable risk-based compliance management, timely enforcement and targeted taxpayer support. It will also integrate the domestic tax administration system with existing Customs platforms such as the Integrated Customs Management System (ICUMS).

Aside that, it will also integrate with the Registrar of Companies so that we will be able to know who is behind every single transaction. The IMF has encountered this ITAS software somewhere and they believe that it is a good software that will work for the people of Ghana. I am here identifying that the software is good. The previous administration took the software, thought it was good and the IMF has confirmed that the software is good, so I have to implement it. But before I implement it, I have to come and clean everything else that I believe was wrong and that includes seeking parliamentary approval and renegotiating the rate down.

All that I have done is just to be legal and to implement the programme as has been renegotiated and as we have reduced the cost by about \$9 million. That is the reality. My position on taxes has not changed and it will never change.

Thank you very much. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let me reiterate the fact that it is right if you give the opportunity to Leadership to speak last. After giving the opportunity to the Leadership to speak, I have a difficulty looking back. As I am here, if the rules are breached and you are up on point of order, I would know. Until I realise that the rules are breached and you are up on point of order, I will not. Yes, consequential Resolution 27?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 27, the consequential Resolution.

RESOLUTIONS

Master Agreement between GoG and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd for Professional Services

Minister for Finance (Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

WHEREAS by the provisions of Article 181(5) of the Constitution the terms and conditions of any international business or economic transaction to which the Government of Ghana is a party shall not come into operation unless the said terms and conditions have been laid before Parliament and approved by Parliament by a Resolution supported by the votes of a majority of all Members of Parliament.

PURSUANT to the provisions of the said article 181(5) of the Constitution, and at the request of the Government of Ghana acting through the Minister

responsible for Finance, there has been laid before Parliament the terms and conditions of a Master Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd for Professional Services.

This honourable House hereby resolve as follows:

IN ACCORDANCE with the provisions of the said article 181(5) of the Constitution this House approves, by resolution, the Master Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd for Professional Services.

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, we still have Resolution 30 outstanding because I only moved Resolution 27, so I have to add Resolution 30.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, I think we have to take Motion numbered 28, 29 and then the consequential Resolution numbered 30.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, let us just take 28.

Ratification of Master Agreement between GoG and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd for Professional Services

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

WHEREAS by the provisions of Article 75 of the Constitution any treaty, Agreement, or convention executed by or under the Authority of the President in the name of Ghana is made subject to ratification either by an Act of Parliament or by a resolution of Parliament supported by the votes of more than one-half of all the Members of Parliament.

IN ACCORDANCE with the said Article 75 of the Constitution the President has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Finance, the Master Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd for Professional Services.

NOW THEREFORE, this Honourable House hereby resolves to ratify the said Master Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Finance/Ghana Revenue Authority) and Tata Consultancy Services Ltd for Professional Services.

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The consequential Motion numbered 29?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Report for the exemption was incorporated in the earlier Report that we adopted. So, Motion numbered 29 is not necessary. What we need is the consequential Resolution that is item number 30.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I want the Chairman to move and give this explanation. Once it is seconded, because we have debated already, I will put a question and then we will move to the consequential Resolution.

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, in moving the earlier Resolution, the Motion we inadvertently discussed and requested this House to adopt the Report of the Committee with respect to the withholding tax Agreement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee, move this Motion and then indicate that the Report has already been taken by the House.

MOTIONS

Suspension of Standing Order 104 (1)

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr. Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a motion

shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the motion is given, the motion for the adoption of the Report of the Finance Committee on Request for Waiver of 20 percent Withholding Tax on the Income of Tata Consultancy Service Limited (as Service Provider) and Value Added Tax (VAT) amounting to the Ghana Cedi equivalent of ten million, four hundred and sixty thousand United States dollars (US\$10,460,000.00) on Imported Services under the implementation of the Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS) Project may be *moved* today.

I have already presented the Report of the Committee.

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly

Request for Tax Waiver on the Income of Tata Consultancy Service and on Imported Services under the ITAS Project

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Finance Committee on the Request for Waiver of 20 percent Withholding Tax on the Income of Tata Consultancy Service Limited (as Service Provider) and Value Added Tax (VAT) amounting to the Ghana

Waiver of 20% WHT and VAT on Imported Services under ITAS Project

Cedi equivalent of ten million, four hundred and sixty thousand United States dollars (US\$10,460,000.00) on Imported Services under the implementation of the Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS) Project.

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, consequential Resolution numbered 30. Minister for Finance?

RESOLUTION

Request for Tax Waiver on the Income of Tata Consultancy Service and on Imported Services under the ITAS Project

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

WHEREAS by the provisions of article 174 (2) of the Constitution, Parliament is empowered to confer power on any person or authority to waive or vary a tax imposed by an Act of Parliament;

THE EXERCISE of any power conferred on any person or authority to waive or vary a tax in favour of any person or authority is by the said provisions made subject to the prior approval of Parliament by resolution;

BY THE COMBINED operation of the provisions of section 150(i) of the, the Value Added Tax Act, 2013 (Act 870), the Value Added Tax (Amendment) Act, 2015 (Act 890), the Value Added Tax (Amendment) Act, 2017 (Act 948) and other existing Laws and Regulations applicable to the collection of Customs duties and other taxes on the importation of goods into Ghana, the Minister for Finance may exempt any statutory corporation, institution or individual from the payment of duties and taxes otherwise payable under the said Laws and Regulations or waive or vary the requirement of such statutory corporation, institution or individual to pay such duties and taxes;

BY THE PROVISIONS of paragraphs (a) and (b) of subsection (2) of section 36 of the Exemptions Act, 2022 (Act 1083),

- (a) an exemption-related Agreement signed between the Government and a person on the basis of a provision repealed by the Exemptions Act, 2022 or
- (b) an exemption-related resolution of Parliament passed on the basis of a provision repealed by the Exemptions Act, 2022 (Act 1083) shall continue to be valid for the term of the Agreement or resolution

IN ACCORDANCE with the provisions of the Constitution and at the request of the Government of

Ghana acting through the Minister responsible for Finance, there has been laid before Parliament a request by the Minister for Finance for the prior approval of Parliament the exercise by him of the power conferred under the Laws and Regulations relating to the Waiver of 20 percent Withholding Tax on the Income of Tata Consultancy Service Limited (as Service Provider) and Value Added Tax (VAT) amounting to the Ghana cedi equivalent of ten million, four hundred and sixty thousand United States dollars (US\$10,460,000.00) on Imported Services under the implementation of the Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS) Project.

NOW THEREFORE, this honourable House hereby approves, by resolution, the exercise by the Minister responsible for Finance of the power conferred on the Minister by Statute to waive of 20 percent Withholding Tax on the Income of Tata Consultancy Service Limited (as Service Provider) and Value Added Tax (VAT) amounting to the Ghana cedi equivalent of ten million, four hundred and sixty thousand United States dollars (US\$10,460,000.00) on Imported Services under the implementation of the Integrated Tax Administration System (ITAS) Project.

Mr Adongo: Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

4:36 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Consequential Resolution numbered 30 at pages 12 and 13 of today's *Order Paper* is accordingly adopted.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: We would resume the comments on the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

I would then proceed to give the floor to Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko.

Yes, Alhaji Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I can see that the Minister for Finance is packing his books. I can see that after passing Resolutions and Motions, he is packing his books to leave the Chamber. He should sit down and listen to the commentary on the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy. He should not leave the Chamber. His Deputy is not the Minister; he is. He should sit down and listen.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: I thought the nice suit and tie would have changed his mind—*[Laughter]*. Or he is aspiring to be a Minister for Finance. He is always in a *jalabiya*—*[Laughter]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Tetteh Nyarko, you have the floor. Your time is five minutes.

STATEMENT

Government's Financial Policy, 2026

[Resumption of Debate from Column 202]

Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko (NDC — Upper Manya Krobo): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity to, within the next five minutes, comment on the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy that was presented to us by the Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson.

Mr Speaker, the theme for the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy is Resetting for Growth, Jobs and Economic Transformation. This is a Budget that responds to the realities of today, and it is anchored on the solid foundations that were built during this fiscal year. The figures tell us that the economy is doing very well. The figures show that the economy is growing at 6.3 per cent. The figures also indicate that inflation has fallen from about 40 per cent to 8 per cent. The cedi has remained stable, and it is giving confidence to the investment community.

Mr Speaker, public debt has stabilised below 50 per cent of GDP. And that is why today, we can assure ourselves that Ghana has met almost all the ECOWAS convergence criteria. That is a sign of restored macroeconomic discipline. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Speaker, these gains and other indicators are the foundations for the transformational agenda outlined in this 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy. The Government projects to raise GH¢268.1 billion to finance its many projects and ambitious programmes in 2026.

Mr Speaker, at the centre of the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy is a commitment to job creation, livelihood, and inclusive growth. That is why the Government is expecting to spend over GH¢300 billion for the coming year. A big portion of this amount is channeled into capital expenditure. This is a strategic investment that is going to see massive infrastructural development to create thousands of direct and indirect jobs for the Ghanaian people.

Mr Speaker, this is a job-focused budget with a real solution for the Ghanaian youth. But this budget is not only about growth, Mr Speaker, it is about the people. That is why the Ghana Medical Trust Fund, the MahamaCares, has come to reduce the cost of healthcare and to strengthen the National Health Insurance Scheme.

Mr Speaker, the 2026 Budget is bold, credible, and future-oriented. It is a budget of hope and opportunities. It is a budget for every Ghanaian. It is a budget for raising Ghana. For that reason, I call on this House, I call upon all well-meaning Ghanaians, I call upon all fair-minded Ghanaians to support this 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy.

[Hear! Hear!]

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I would proceed to give the floor to Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo. You have 10 minutes.

Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (NPP — Manso Nkwanta): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise to address the 2026 Budget, a document that at first glance presents itself like a roadmap to economic stability of this country. But Mr Speaker, we cannot rely only on lofty numbers and some optimistic projections.

Mr Speaker, unfortunately, the 2026 Budget continues to rely on intentions; intentions without clear practical measures to secure economic transformation. The 2026 Budget does not genuinely empower our people, it does not drive innovation, and it does not develop the human capital of this country.

Mr Speaker, the Minister sitting across was boastful of his Government's achievements as having stabilised this economy. But the big question that we should be asking is what specifically has the Minister or the Government done to claim all this praise that he is wishing for? The recent S&P Global Ratings, the Standard and Poor's Report, that upgraded Ghana, has been talked about a lot. Yes, they have upgraded Ghana to B- for the long term and B for the short term.

But Mr Speaker, if you read the report right from the beginning, it says the upgrade is based on the fact that Ghana has benefited from our commodities, and they mentioned gold and cocoa, that the price has been good in the international market, and based on that we have gotten some good revenues. These revenues have built our reserves so well, and they have supported the cedi and by extension the inflation that we have seen going down.

So Mr Speaker, if indeed we have benefited from our natural resources, the commodities that are doing well in the international market, what really is our contribution to this? Really, this is the international market that is playing in our favour. It could go either direction at any point in time. So, we should not praise ourselves.

Mr Speaker, the second point of this S&P upgrade is that they said that in October 2024, Ghana restructured an amount of US\$13.1 billion, and this is what has created the fiscal space that we have now. So, when the Minister is talking about bringing fiscal stability, this is where it started; October 2024. We restructured this, and it created the fiscal space.

Mr Speaker, now, the other issue that we see going on, and we saw it in the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, is that the Minister is pushing towards a short-term approach, trying to achieve some figures in the short term, forgetting about sustainable growth. But what this country needs is sustainable growth and not short-term achievement

for praise. Based on this, we have seen the Minister rationing expenditure just for short-term achievements.

4:46 p.m.

The figures are clear. So, you see major expenditure lines all lagging behind budgeted figures.

Mr Speaker, our CAPEX line – and CAPEX is what turns an economy around; this is capital expenditure. We budgeted 1.5 per cent of GDP. How much has the Hon Minister spent so far? Just about 0.5 per cent of GDP was spent. Why is it so? This is because the Hon Minister is looking at short-term achievement.

Mr Speaker, in a similar way, the Big Push Agenda, this programme that has been touted so much, one would ask themselves, what has happened to it? GH¢13 billion was allocated. How much has been committed? Less than GH¢8 billion has been spent. Why? Because we are looking at short-term achievements. The Big Push is not moving, so, Ghanaians should watch out. This year, in the 2026 Budget, the Hon Minister allocated GH¢30 billion towards this programme. What level of expense is going to come from this GH¢30 billion? If you look at our primary expenditure, same way, from quarter one to quarter three, we are behind by 13.6 per cent. If you look at other expenditures, total expenditure as at quarter three, we are behind by 15 per cent.

One other area that we should be looking at is the growth of our GDP.

Currently, the economy is growing at 6.3 per cent and the Hon Minister is projecting to grow at 4.8 per cent for 2026. This is depressing. Why should we be projecting to grow at 4.8 per cent when we are growing at 6.3 per cent now? Mr Speaker, I can give you 10 years of GDP growth in this country. The NDC left office in 2016 with 3.37 per cent; in 2017, we moved it to 8.13 per cent; 2018, 6.20 per cent; 2019, 6.51 per cent. Of course, 2020 to 2023 was the COVID era. In 2024, we grew the economy and handed it over at 5.7 per cent. So why is the Hon Minister projecting to grow at 4.8 per cent? This economy should grow beyond 4.8 per cent. The economy is at a standstill.

Mr Speaker, I have some provisional figures for revenue shortfalls. This year, our revenue has had shortfalls, and this is serious for this country. If you look at our tax revenue, we are short by GH¢8.9 billion; our domestic revenue, we are short by GH¢6.8 billion; total revenue, we are short by GH¢7.7 billion. I want Ghanaians to know that when you have these revenue shortfalls, what you should anticipate is that there is going to be further cuts in expenditure, and this is going to hurt this country. Beyond that, the country should be expecting some subtle introduction of taxes of a sort, because the Hon Minister is falling behind in expenditure revenue.

Mr Speaker, as we go on, one would ask themselves what is in for the youth of this country. The youth of this country are disappointed. What they were promised, the 24-Hour Economy, the 1-3-3 formation, is never happening. The

youth of this country will be calling the Hon Minister for Finance. There is a lot of rhetoric on this 24-Hour Economy, but the big question I will ask before my time is up is why is the Hon Minister or the Government delaying in the rollout of its major programmes? All major programmes have delayed. This *Nkoko Nkitinkiti* Programme was only launched a day prior to the reading of the Budget. Why are all the programmes delaying?

Mr Speaker, when the government of Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo promised certain programmes, he went right away to work. The Free SHS, we went right away to work; Planting for Food and Jobs, right away; One district, one factory, right away; Zongo Development Fund, right away; National Identification, right away; National Builders Corps (NABCO), right away; Infrastructure for Poverty Eradication, right away; Ghana CARES Obaatanpa Programme, right away. All these programmes, we went right away to deliver. Why are the programmes now delaying? That is the question.

Mr Speaker, to conclude, the Budget that we have now is not transformative at all. It is like this Budget is stuck in the past; we are running a Budget that is stuck in the past. What has been the talk about innovation? There is no statement on innovation; no statement on digital transformation; no statement on human capital development.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, your time is up.

Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take Questions to the Ministers. The Ministers are all here. We finished the commentary for the day. I think we have exhausted the list. *[Interruption]* We have not? I got a signal from Mr Speaker that the list given to him has been exhausted. Unless you have a different list.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, I had nine from the Minority and six from the Majority. If I want to go by taking six apiece, then the list is exhausted. Unless I am to do otherwise.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, humbly, the Hon Minority Chief Whip in the morning suggested that we take ten apiece, and I said we have other Businesses for today. So, I propose that we take six apiece. So, we can take Questions and Statements, and so, we submitted six each even though he initially proposed nine. So, I am surprised that they went ahead to submit nine. It is not as if we are not capable. We are too capable, but we need to be able to accommodate other Businesses. Ministers have been here since morning, waiting for their time to answer the Questions which they have filed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip, I think that is why the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice and the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture are here, so that they can respond to the Questions slated for them. But Hon Members, going forward, if the cases that will not take Questions and Statements and we would go straightly to

take comment on the debate; I think the Leadership must agree.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, what the Hon Majority Chief Whip is saying cannot be true, because the agreement that was to do 10 from each Side, to which they said no. Then they agreed on nine. That is why the Hon Minority Chief Whip has given you a list of nine, and the three other Members, that is, Professor, the Hon Collins and then Hon Nana Addo-Kenneth. They are all seated here. They know they are ready to debate. I do not know why the Hon Majority Chief Whip should be—It is their Budget that they have presented. They have 189 Members and they cannot bring nine to debate for the first day.

So, add the three. We will be able to do the debates and still listen to the Questions from the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. Our Members are prepared and they are seated here, the three of them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But the Question is not coming from the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice; it is rather the Answers that are coming from him.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Very well, Mr Speaker.

The Majority Chief Whip has a large number so he should just add a capable three.

Mr Speaker, these are not people who speak for long. You see, the number is coming down. So let us just get the three

each then we would be reducing the number. But if we do six today, how many are we doing tomorrow? How many are we doing the day after tomorrow? They have the numbers. Six is still not adequate. Our Members are ready to debate, so let the three of them debate. Then we can have the Ministers answer the Questions.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Hon First Deputy Minority Whip is in Leadership, so sometimes he should not rise and react to matters this way. He cannot say that what I am saying is not true. I engaged him and the Minority Chief Whip. I told them that we cannot go beyond six Members because of this other Business. He can say that we agreed on it, but now he insists that we take more. He should not say that what I said was not discussed. We discussed it—Yes, but we were not supposed to submit nine; we were supposed to submit six.

So, he should not say that. He should not let it go into the record that what I said is not accurate.

4:56 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I mean, these are matters normally arranged by the Whips. They organise their Sides to prepare and participate in the debate. I can understand that the Hon Members have prepared and would want to make comments, but we must appreciate that we have Government Business. We also

have, apart from the debate, the personal Business of Members. A number of Questions have been asked, and the Ministers are here.

Ordinarily, I think we should have even taken the Questions before the comments on the Budget. That is what we should have done. But we allowed the comments to start, and the Ministers have been sitting in the whole day listening to us; it would not be fair to them. So let us take the Questions and for the Members, once they have prepared today, they will remain prepared till tomorrow. We can enhance the numbers.

It means that we have an understanding that perhaps we would not take many Questions tomorrow, because we also do not want that constant complaint that we have a backlog of Questions and we are not giving room for Question Time, *et cetera*. So let us have the Ministers answer the Questions today, and then tomorrow we will add the three to the list. We know that if we want the debate to be rich, we need to give the Members enough notice so that they can prepare; we do not want Members unprepared for debate. So I think that we should keep to the arrangement.

Let the Whips try and be firm on the numbers per day. They should indicate how many people they want to debate for the entire period, and also agree on the number of people who will be commenting each day. But for now, I plead with my Colleagues on the other Side to have the Ministers answer the Questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, in this House, we have often agreed to disagree. And when the Majority Leader is making pleadings, one does not want to disagree with him.

But for the record, early in the morning, I approached my respected Whip and told him to do 10 on each Side for a reason. Now, oftentimes when it is time to comment on the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, a number of our Colleagues are unable to speak to the Budget. They do not get the opportunity to participate in the debate. So I thought that if we do 10, at least, many Members could have access. Then he mentioned that he would get back to me.

Mr Speaker, you recall that at Conclave, I brought our list to you and then you signalled to Hon Acheampong that our list had been submitted and that he should bring his. When he brought it, it was six. And I recall that the Speaker indicated to him that he had brought six, and the Minority had brought 10. All they needed to do was to get a difference of four to be added so that it becomes 10 apiece. I do not want to be doing this, that even a number of people who will speak to the Budget, we are disagreeing on it. That should not be the case.

So I accede to the call of the Majority Leader. Except to add that, as we are attempting to accede to his call, he should also make an attempt so that we can meet each other midway. Now, we have programmed our Colleagues, 10 per

day, all of them have been given prior notification. So, we would not disagree with the Leader, except to say that if we are doing six, a difference of four, we could offload the four to some other day. We do not have a problem. So that all those who have been given notice and who have prepared adequately, would be given the chance to speak.

But on a more serious note, they have more Members on their Side. It is quite ironic that we are pushing for more Members to comment.

Mr Speaker, let me conclude—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Chief Whip, where you are going is dangerous for you. I know, but where you are going may be dangerous for you. If you want to do it that way, you will be the very person who will complain. That is why we are not doing it on a proportion basis. So take a cue.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I take a cue. We plead with the Majority Leader to find a way of accommodating Members outstanding for today. On that score, we do not have a problem. We can go ahead and take the other Business on the Government Side.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Members, on this note, I would ask the Whips to engage. Now, when they engage, they should advert to whether or not we are taking Questions or Statements, because other Government Business must be taken in addition to the commentary. So if you are not taking Questions, then we are clear we are not

taking Questions. If you are not taking Statements, then we are clear that we are not taking Statements. So that there will be a clear road map for tomorrow.

In the meantime, Hon Members, we have scheduled Questions for the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. May I humbly ask him to take the designated seat, and I will call on the questioners to pose the Questions to him. So, we are now on the item numbered 7— Urgent Questions.

The first Urgent Question stands in the name of Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin, Member of Parliament for Effutu.

Yes, Alhaji Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I rise under Order 88(3). I have the authorisation to ask the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You are permitted to ask the Question.

URGENT QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF JUSTICE AND ATTORNEY-GENERAL'S DEPARTMENT

Basis for the Administrative Decision by EOCO to Demand Justification as a Bail Condition for Suspects

**Alhaji Habib Iddrisu on behalf of
Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-
Markin (NPP — Effutu):** Mr Speaker,
I beg to ask the Attorney-General and

Minister for Justice the basis for the administrative decision by EOCO to demand justification as a bail condition for suspects in recent times, particularly appointees of the previous Government.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Attorney-General and Minister for Justice?

Attorney-General and Minister for Justice (Dr Dominic Akurintinga Ayine): Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Article 14, Clause 4 of the Constitution, the Economic and Organised Office (EOCO) and other law enforcement agencies are mandated to effect arrests and release persons who have been arrested either unconditionally or upon reasonable conditions necessary to ensure that the accused persons or suspects appear at a later date to stand trial.

The justification for bail conditions, even if on an administrative basis in the recent cases, is not new, and there is no intent on the part of the EOCO and the Office of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice to impose arbitrary bail conditions on government appointees of the previous Government. The grant of bail with adequate justification ensures that suspects will attend court when they are needed to stand trial.

Mr Speaker, this is my answer to the first Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

5:06 p.m.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I would like to find out from the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice whether he thinks that the bail conditions currently set by EOCO is the right way bails should be set for any Ghanaian, not necessarily people in the political class.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, I have already made it abundantly clear that the Economic and Organised Crime Office and other law enforcement agencies under my Ministry are not acting arbitrarily. Bails depends on the gravity of crime. What we are seeing now is that the sums involved in the criminal investigations are very huge. Because they are very huge, if you set very low bail conditions, in terms of the sums, the likelihood is that, when the suspect escapes or is unavailable to stand trial, whatever you are able to extort in justification will not be able to offset the criminal liability that is involved. For instance, if you have a situation where the suspect is accused of, let us say, causing financial loss to the state in the sum of GHC1billion, or stealing in the sum of GHC31.1 million, you cannot set bail terms that are unjustifiably low. So, it is the magnitude of the offences we are dealing with that dictates the we set bail sums that reasonably justify the crimes that have been committed or alleged to have been committed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further question?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Yes, Mr Speaker. Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, from my little reading of bail conditions, will you consider other forms of conditions for granting bail to former appointees if you reasonably believe that the person will be available when needed? I might be wrong but my thinking is that bail is set out in many cases so that the person can still be available, or maybe the person will not run away. After taking the passport of the person, asking for landed property, justifiable surety, do you think you will consider—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are violating Standing Order 88.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, my question is, will you consider other forms of bail conditions rather than this current form EOCO is implementing?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, the First Deputy Minority Whip is asking me about other forms of bail conditions. As a lawyer, I have been trained to do what is traditionally and legally acceptable before the courts of law. Usually bail conditions are either tied to the sums of money to be justified by landed property and so on and so forth. We have not done anything that is out of the ordinary. We have followed strictly what is permissible under the law, and then of course practice. So I have not done anything out of the ordinary. I do not know what other forms of bail conditions

he has in contemplation. Maybe if he has any advice that he wants to give in respect of alternative ways of doing this, I am willing to consider them.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, will the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice review the current bail conditions imposed on people under custody of EOCO, considering that the courts have varied some of the conditions that EOCO have imposed? For example, the former boss of Bulk Oil Storage and Transportation Company (BOST), EOCO gave a bail of GH¢60 million. The court today reviewed it to GH¢30 million. Will he consider reviewing the current bail conditions on people who are still in the custody of EOCO and are unable to meet the condition of the bail?

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, the First Deputy Minority Whip himself has used the word review. Usually when the bail is set by law enforcement and the suspect feels that the bail conditions are onerous, they go to court. That is why they hire lawyers. The lawyers apply to court for a downward adjustment of the bail conditions. That is what has happened. In the instance that he rightly pointed out, that was what happened. The bail was set by EOCO, I think, at GH¢60 million, with sureties to be justified, and the Human Rights Court, upon an application being made by the suspect, reviewed the condition downward to GH¢30 million. That is for the court to decide.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Nitiwul?

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul (NPP — Bimbilla) Mr Speaker, the administrative decision by the Economic and Organised Crime Office to demand justification as a bail condition, is it a new phenomenon or has it always existed? If it is a new phenomenon, as the chief advisor to Government, will he recommend it to be used for future crime-related issues as we go on as a country?

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, remember that the EOCO is a law enforcement agency with the same powers as the Police. What they are doing now is not new. It is the same thing that the Police do sometimes when one is granted bail by the Police on what they call police enquiry bail. What they are doing now is not new, and I do not think that it should change, because it is a system that has been put in place to ensure that people are available to stand trial. You can imagine a situation where the bail conditions were lax and then people— For instance, currently there are some people that we are looking for to stand trial, whose names I will not mention, who are out of the jurisdiction. They have basically absconded and we cannot get them except through an extradition process.

I think that what is happening now should stay, and it is nothing out of the ordinary. In all common law jurisdictions that I know, in the United States of America, in the United Kingdom, in Australia, in Canada, in our common law sister countries in Nigeria and so on, those are the methods well known to the law that are used to ensure

that persons suspected of criminal conduct are available to stand trial.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Leadership, in view of the fact that we have nine Questions to deal with, how many supplementary questions do I take? Leaders, get together and advise me.

I will then come to the Leadership. Mr Ahmed Shaib, you have the floor.

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, I will yield to my Colleague, Mr Baffour Awuah.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Awuah, you have the floor.

Mr Nana Agyei Baffour Awuah (NPP — Manhyia South): Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

Mr Speaker, considering that the Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice is also the Minister for Justice, would he say that when he wears his other hat, with what suspects are currently going through, would he say that it is fair and consistent with the requirements of human rights protection? Would he say that?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice?

5:16 p.m.

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker the Economic and Organised Crime Office is one of the key law enforcement agencies under my

Ministry. In my capacity as Minister of Justice and Attorney General, those are two positions that have been merged by both the 1992 Constitution and decision of the President.

Mr Speaker, there is nothing unjust or unfair with respect to what is happening. I am standing on firm ground in saying this because the sums of money and the criminal enterprise that are the subject matter of the bail conditions that are being imposed have never before been seen in our country. That is the reason it is important that we take stringent steps to continue to do what we are doing. This is because unless we do so and unless we make it impossible for criminals to escape from the grips of the law, then it means that the criminal justice system can be undermined. So, I think that there is nothing wrong or unjust with what is happening.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, it is just a matter of information, if I have your pleasure.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Second Deputy Minority Whip, when it is time for supplementary questions, tell me the rules that I will apply to let you give information.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, this was because the Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice made a—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I believe you are holding the rules. So, guide me by the rules under which you would be permitted.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I am holding the Constitution.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Deputy Minority Leader is holding the rules, so you can also guide me with the rules under which I would permit you to give me information.

Mr Shaib: I am looking at the Constitution. If we come and say that the amount involved in a matter is the basis for which the bail conditions are considered, I am only here to let us understand that that would be just a one-sided information from the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. We need to have everybody —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I am sorry to say that you are completely out of order.

Let us move to the Question numbered 7(b), standing in the name of Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni, Member of Parliament for Nalerigu/Gambaga.

Extradition of Sedinam Tamakloe

Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni (NPP — Nalerigu/Gambaga): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice the plans of the Ministry to extradite Sedinam Tamakloe who was convicted for misappropriating funds.

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, the request for the extradition of Sedinam Christine Tamakloe Attionu was dispatched on 19th July, 2024 through the Ministry of Foreign Affairs to the Department of Justice of the United States of America

for execution. Our office, that is the office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice, is awaiting the execution of our request to have her extradited to serve her prison sentence in Ghana. The International Cooperation Unit of the Attorney-General's Department followed up on our request from the Department of Justice of the United States of America in September, 2025.

So, if there is any impression being created that I am not taking any steps, this is the evidence that in September, that is just a month ago, I took the step of enquiring from the United States Department of Justice the steps that they were taking in respect of the extradition. They indicated that they are following their extradition procedures in executing the request and that the fugitive will be extradited as soon as they have satisfied all the procedures. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Alhaji N. M. Mumuni: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I want to find out from the Minister if there has been any request for notice of International Criminal Police Organization (Interpol)?

Dr Ayine: No, Mr Speaker. In the case of Sedinam Attionu, she has been tried and convicted. She is not a fugitive from justice in the same sense as the Hon Kenneth Ofori-Atta who is a fugitive from justice that we are seeking to bring back to trial. In her case, she has been

tried and convicted and all we want is for her to be extradited to serve the sentence. So, there is no need for us to serve an Interpol notice in that respect.

Alhaji N. M. Mumuni: Mr Speaker, I want to find out the amount involved in the case.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please file a specific Question.

Alhaji N. M. Mumuni: Mr Speaker, it is the same thing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, look at your Question and see whether it relates to anything regarding the amount to enable the Minister to do so, in coming to answer the Question.

Alhaji N. M. Mumuni: Mr Speaker, I do not have any other question. What I have is an appeal. He should do whatever he can—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are completely out of order; resume your seat. Yes, Hon Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I want to thank my Senior for the answers he has provided. Writing to the U.S. State Department of Justice in September was a little too late, but it is better than nothing. I want to find out from him, what steps he has put in place to ensure that the extradition process takes place to the benefit of the nation?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It flows from the answer, but I will give the opportunity to the Minister.

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, once an extradition request is made, it is left to the authorities under the Mutual Legal Assistance Arrangement. The competent authorities in the United States of America are the ones who have to take the steps. We cannot do anything to quicken the process.

For instance, I cannot go to the USA and then ask to be joined to the action to quicken the process. It is the Department of Justice that must comply with American law in extraditing her to come and serve her sentence in Ghana. It is out of my hands. All I can do is to constantly remind them that we want her extradited to stand trial. That is all that I can do at this point in time.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. According to the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, he indicated that they have written to the United States of America, he did a follow-up. I just want to find out if, beyond USA, he has information as to where the suspect is currently. If the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice has knowledge of the country that she is in.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Your question should be, does the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice have information on whether the convict is in the USA or in any other country?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: That is so, Mr Speaker.

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, point of correction. She is no longer a suspect;

she has been convicted. But I can confirm, without any fear of contradiction, that she is in the United States of America.

5:26 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Leadership?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, please, I would yield to Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh, you have the floor.

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I want to seek clarification from the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. The clarification is on the fugitive of justice; a person, such as a criminal suspect or witness, who tries to elude law enforcement or flee the jurisdiction, based on law enforcement or justice.

When you say Sedinam is not a fugitive of justice, I am a bit unclear, so if you can clarify who a fugitive of justice is— Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are completely out of order.

You can look at the rule, whether the rules allow you, instead of supplementary questions, you ask for clarification. This is a House guided by rules.

Hon Members, we would move to the Question numbered 7(c). It stands in the name of Rev John Ntim Fordjour.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, with deference to you, I wish to apply, with your permission, and with the authority of Rev Ntim Fordjour —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please do.

Measures to Ensure Expeditious Prosecution of Criminal Narcotic Cases

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib *on behalf of Rev John Ntim Fordjour (NPP — Assin South)*: Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, what steps the Ministry is taking to ensure expeditious prosecution of criminal narcotic cases.

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, narcotic cases, like all other criminal cases, received by the Attorney General's Department are assigned to attorneys for advice and possible prosecution. The Prosecution Division has a dedicated team of attorneys for handling narcotic cases, and the numerical strength of this team, in the early part of 2025, has increased from six to 15 attorneys to adequately cater for the increasing number of narcotic cases effected by the Narcotic Control Commission (NACOC) officers. The team currently handles narcotic cases within and outside Accra.

The Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice, as part of its continuous learning and training policy

for attorneys, made arrangements for its narcotic team in June 2025 to join officers from other stakeholder institutions like NACOC, Ghana Police Service, and Food and Drugs Authority to participate in a training that was dubbed: “Combating Fentanyl and International Narcotic Trafficking”, which was organised by the Embassy of the United States of America in Accra. The training was to create awareness about evolving narcotic drugs and effective investigation and prosecution skills to combat their usage. The Office of the Attorney General and Ministry of Justice presents cases for trial, and from then on, the courts are in charge of the progress of the case.

The judiciary, together with the parties, ensure expeditious prosecution of cases, including narcotic cases. That said, the Director of Public Prosecutions (DPP) has effective internal procedures to ensure that attorneys handling all criminal cases, including narcotics, work assiduously to dispose of these cases timeously. This includes remanding suspects within 48 hours of arrest and advising on narcotic cases quickly in line with the protocols of the Office.

The Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice has, between the period July to September 2025, experienced delays in receiving analytical reports from the Ghana Standards Authority and Food and Drugs Authority in respect of seized items suspected to be narcotics. This has caused unprecedented delays in proffering the appropriate charges against the suspects who were arrested within that period. The Office is reliably

informed by officials of the Narcotics Control Commission, responsible for assisting the prosecution of narcotic cases, that the impasse has been resolved, and they are working assiduously to submit recent documents to the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice for the commencement of prosecutions.

Mr Speaker, the Department is in receipt of requests for a fiat from the Narcotics Control Commission to enable NACOC lawyers to prosecute narcotic cases, and I am consulting other stakeholders to make a decision in that regard. Granting these requests would prevent submitting narcotic dockets to the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice for advice and possible prosecution, and thereby reduce the delays in prosecuting narcotic cases.

Additionally, having the NACOC arresting officers, investigators, and prosecutors under one umbrella to combat the threats that narcotics pose to national security is an ideal situation that I am hoping will be achieved in the shortest possible time.

Mr Speaker, my office has been reliably informed that the NACOC has also approached the Acting Chief Justice and requested costs that would be dedicated to specifically handling narcotic cases, and the Acting Chief Justice, now the Chief Justice, as he was sworn in yesterday, has agreed to meet NACOC executives for further discussions in that respect.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Shaib: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Is the respected Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, respectfully, able to tell this House, since he took office, the number of narcotic cases that he has dealt with?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my Brother, Mr Shaib, knows that if he intends to elicit an answer to this Question from the Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, he needs to file a substantive Question. The rules frown on the introduction of a matter that was not contained in the original Question. If he wants a new matter, he should file a substantive Question.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I can abandon that question and proceed to another question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr Shaib: Does the respected Attorney-General and Minister for Justice have other means of training lawyers and the police in dealing with issues of narcotics to expedite prosecution on narcotics? Does he have any new means?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So long as your question is not limited to prosecution, it will be overruled.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I limited it to prosecution.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You know the rules, so frame the question well.

Mr Shaib: Will the Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice be able to tell this House the exact steps that the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice has taken to deal with issues of narcotics, in other words, to expedite prosecution on narcotics?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is the exact Question that has been asked. The Question says the steps the Ministry is taking to ensure expeditious prosecution of criminal narcotic cases, which has been answered.

So, are you repeating the same Question for an answer?

5:36 p.m.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, honestly, I did not get the exact answers. I listened attentively, in silence, and I thought that maybe the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice would be given the opportunity to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, by the rules, it is not the answer you want, but the answer that is given.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, that would be all.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Members, let us move on to the Question numbered 349 which is standing in the name of Prof Kingsley Nyarko, Member of Parliament for Kwadaso. Hon Member, you have the floor.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF JUSTICE AND ATTORNEY-GENERAL'S DEPARTMENT

Protection of the Integrity of the Judiciary

Prof Kingsley Nyarko (NPP — Kwadaso): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice how the Ministry intends to protect the integrity of the Judiciary and also exude confidence in the citizenry in our judicial system.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice?

Attorney-General and Minister for Justice (Dr Dominic Akuritinga Ayine): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the Office of the Attorney General and Ministry of Justice, which the Hon Member knows, is a creature of the Constitution and also part of the Executive branch of government. As part of the Executive branch of government, we have a distinct mandate under Article 88 of the 1992 Constitution and we are unable to directly protect the integrity of the

Judiciary or meddle in the affairs of the Judicial arm of government. However, when the Office of the Attorney-General conducts its business before the courts, the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, either by himself or through his officers, strives to uphold the integrity of the Judiciary by complying with the timelines, orders and decisions of the courts.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary questions?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, this is a smart Answer which is not giving me any space to manoeuvre. However, per the Answer, is the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, the principal legal advisor to the Government, suggesting that he cannot even make recommendations that will positively impact the integrity of the Judiciary?

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, as you ask supplementary questions, you should have in mind that the Judiciary is an independent arm of government.

Yes, Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice?

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, I was asked a Question with respect to the steps I am taking to protect the integrity of the Judiciary. Now, the Hon Member is asking me for advice on what steps can be taken to protect the integrity of the

Judiciary. I think that the answer to that question lies in what I said earlier, which is that the Judiciary is a separate, independent but equal arm of government and that the Judiciary is capable of protecting its own integrity. It does not need the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice to protect its integrity.

However, the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice is the chief law enforcement officer of the Republic. If there are any matters that relate to ethical or legal breaches that occur in the Judiciary, it is my duty, both under law and in accordance with the ethics of my Office, to investigate and prosecute those breaches. So, until any such breaches have occurred, my powers are not triggered, and my mandate will be exceeded if I interfere in the affairs of the Judiciary.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further supplementary questions?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, that is fair. The Question was in two folds. Apart from the first one that the Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice has answered, the second one that talks about how he can exude confidence in the citizenry was not captured within his response.

Can he speak to that? Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Prof Kingsley Nyarko, the Judiciary is an independent arm of government, the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice is part of the Executives. What exactly do you have in mind?

Prof Nyarko: The second part was, “and also exude confidence in the citizenry”. We are all teachers, so we try to ask questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, I think I will go back to my Answer, which is that as an independent arm of government, the Judiciary is capable of taking steps that will inspire confidence in the citizenry. It is not the duty of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. Of course, I should not act in a way that undermines the integrity of the Judiciary which also lowers the confidence of the citizens in the Judiciary of our country. But other than that, I think the Judiciary has the power and the authority to act in a way that will inspire confidence in the citizens of this country.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, can we move to the Question numbered 440, standing in the name of Hon Member of Parliament for Suame, Mr John Darko.

Yes, let me hear from you, Hon Member for Bekwai.

Mr Ralph Poku-Adusei: Mr Speaker, I have the authorisation of the Hon Member for Suame to, subject to your permission under Order 88(3), to ask the Question on his behalf.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, are you sure you have his authority?

Mr Poku-Adusei: That is so, Mr Speaker. He is in Brazil at the moment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. You have the floor.

Mr Poku-Adusei: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Immediate Measures to Safeguard and Promote the Human Rights of Suspects

Mr Ralph Poku-Adusei on behalf of Mr John Darko (NPP — Suame): I beg to ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice the immediate measures the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice is implementing to safeguard and promote fundamental human rights particularly in response to recent reports of arbitrary arrests, prolonged pre-trial detention and alleged abuses of suspects.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice?

Dr Ayine: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Constitution of the Republic, in the context of Chapter 5, guarantees the fundamental rights of all citizens of our Republic. With specific reference to the issue raised in the Question, Article 14 of the Constitution has provided adequate safeguards for persons arrested and detained for more than the stated minimum period. Persons whose rights have been violated in this regard could invoke their rights as enshrined under the Constitution.

Mr Speaker, my Office has not received any complaints about arbitrary arrest, prolonged pre-trial detention, and alleged abuses of suspects. That said, law enforcement officers are not above the law, and where any such complaints are reported to my Office, as the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, I will act swiftly to ensure that such flagrant abuses by law enforcement officers are stopped.

Thank you, Mr Speaker

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary questions?

Mr Poku-Adusei: Mr Speaker, there will be no supplementary questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Yes, Hon Second Deputy Minority Whip?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, may I know from the respected Attorney-General and Minister for Justice what he means by he would act swiftly to deal with those kinds of arbitrary arrests and the people who have been detained longer than the minimum required period? We have a lot of such cases pending, so I want to find out from the respected Attorney-General—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Pending where?

Mr Shaib: Both at—Mr Speaker, I know that there are institutions that still have—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: He said he has not received any such complaint. It is only upon receipt of the complaint that he will be able to act swiftly. So, without a complaint, you are asking what it means?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, he does not have to receive the complaint before I can ask him how swiftly he may be dealing with such cases, in case it comes before him.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes, Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice?

5:46 p.m.

Dr Ayine: Mr Speaker, I do not know whether the Hon Member did not understand the word “swiftly” because what it means is that I will act quickly in order to deal with the matter.

Now, Mr Speaker, if a complaint is made or where there is a report of rampant abuses or flagrant abuses of rights, I will take steps to investigate. First, because these are agencies under my Ministry, I will take steps quickly, within a day, to investigate administratively. And if there is a need to raise the investigation to a criminal one and then to proceed to prosecute, I will do so. That is what I meant by I will take swift action in order to deal with a type of complaint.

But of course, he is perfectly right. I do not necessarily need a complaint to be able to do that. As a public law enforcement officer, if there are reported acts of abuse taking place, I am ethically and legally bound to take steps in order to investigate and prosecute.

So I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I thank the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice for answering the question. Just to let him know, I understand the word “swiftly” very well. It is in this conversation that I needed him to bring to bear what he meant by “swiftly”, and he has done so. So, there is no need to throw jabs at some of us.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. Hon Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, you have exhausted the Questions. I thank you very much for attending upon the House and providing Answers to Questions.

The rest of the Questions are slated for the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture. She has been seated for some time, so I will ask her to take the designated seats before I call on the questioner to pose the Question.

Hon Minister, you are welcome. I will refer to Question numbered 348, which stands in the name of Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta, Member of Parliament for Fanteakwa South.

MINISTRY OF FISHERIES AND AQUACULTURE

Measures to Ensure a Targeted Tonne Increase in Aquaculture Production

Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (NPP—Fanteakwa South): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture how the Ministry intends to ensure the targeted 38,604.32 metric tonnes increase in Aquaculture production in 2025 is achieved and what monitoring mechanisms are put in place to track output by regions.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture (Mrs Emelia Arthur): Thank you very much.

Mr Speaker, to achieve the targeted 38,604.32 metric tonnes increase in aquaculture production for 2025, the Ministry has adopted a focused and results-driven strategy built on capacity building, targeted support, and rigorous monitoring. Through collaboration with aquaculture training institutions, associations, and partners, we are expanding the technical capacity of Ghanaians entering the sector. Beyond training, the Ministry has made direct production-enhancing interventions. Under the Youth in Aquaculture Programme, 4,372 youth and women were trained and supported with 4,112 fish-holding facilities (ponds,

tanks and cages), 3,341,900 fingerlings and 34,103 bags of feed across the country. With this intervention and the work of the private fish farmers' activities, and based on standard production parameters, including a 10 per cent mortality allowance and good water conditions, the expected output from these facilities positions us to meet the 2025 target.

Mr Speaker, to ensure effective tracking of regional output, the Ministry maintains a nationwide monitoring system. Our regional and zonal fisheries officers undertake routine field assessments and collect verified aquaculture production data. This information is collated at the regional level and transmitted to the head office for analysis, enabling timely management decisions and targeted interventions where required.

In summary, the Ministry's combined efforts, strategic capacity building, direct production support and a structured, data-driven monitoring framework, provide a solid basis for achieving the aquaculture production increase set for 2025.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any supplementary questions?

Mr Ofori-Atta: Mr Speaker, there has been an uptick in tank farms in the Eastern Region. I want to know what plans the Minister has put in place to provide logistics to the experts to support

these youth, especially the youth who require machinery for smoking and packaging.

Mrs Arthur: If he paid attention to the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy that was read recently in this House, he would realise that allocation has been made for aquaculture development, and it is sizeable enough. The strategic approach is to engage youth and women in cooperatives to support that.

In terms of machinery or equipment to give to them for processing, I think what I heard is that for fish processing and perhaps even canning, we do not have that yet. But that exercise will be best implemented in partnership with the private sector, and so we are looking into that.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any other questions?

Mr Ofori-Atta: No more questions, Mr Speaker. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, in view of the fact that Question numbered 348 is similar to Question numbered 363, may I give the floor to Hon Rudolf Amoako-Gyampah to probably ask a follow-up?

Mr Fredrick Addy: Mr Speaker, I come under Order 88(3). I have the authority, by the Hon Member, to ask a Question on his behalf. May I seek your permission?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What I am saying is that Questions numbered 363 and 348 are similar, and the Answer that the Minister provided applies to this particular Question. Because if you look at the Answers, the Minister makes reference to the Answer to Question numbered 348.

So that is why I am giving you the opportunity to ask any supplementary question because it is the same Question that has been answered.

So, if you have a supplementary, you can ask.

Mr Addy: No, we would come under Order 90 (2) to withdraw that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Let me call the Question numbered 361, which also stands in the name of Rudolf Amoako-Gyampah.

Mr Addy: Mr Speaker, I come under Order 88(3). I have the authority, by the Hon Member, to ask the Question on his behalf. May I seek your leave?

6:06 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please do.

Addressing Hoarding and Diversion with Premix Fuel Automation Project

Mr Frederick Addy on behalf of Mr Rudolf Amoako-Gyampah (NPP—Upper Denkyira West): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Fisheries and

Aquaculture how the Premix Fuel Automation Project is addressing issues of diversion, hoarding and safety and the solutions strategy the Ministry is developing to improve transparency and distribution efficiency.

Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture (Mrs Emelia Arthur) (MP): Mr Speaker, the Premix Fuel Automation Project is being progressively rolled out nationwide, and when fully operationalised, will help to reduce diversion, limit hoarding and improve safety at automated outlets. The installed sites are equipped with calibrated fuel-level sensors and controlled dispensing units linked to a central server, providing near real-time visibility of fuel stocks, deliveries and transactions. Digital display screens at dispensing points ensure accurate issuance. When the full network is operational, these measures will deliver complete end-to-end transparency across the entire premix supply chain.

Hoarding challenges persist primarily because the Canoe Identification Card (CIC) system requires updating. The Ministry has therefore initiated a nationwide audit and clean-up of the CIC registry to ensure that only verified and legitimate fisherfolk are aligned with the automated system. Until the process is completed, beneficiary validation continues to be supported by the oversight of chief fishermen and their secretaries.

On safety, the automated sites already upgraded now feature double-walled tanks, pressure relief valves,

overflow alarms, fire-suppression equipment and secure control panels, significantly reducing operational risks. These standards will be extended to all outlets as the rollout advances.

Mr Speaker, the automation project is central to the Ministry's long-term strategy for a transparent, efficient and accountable premix distribution system. As more sites come online, the system's tracking, reporting and monitoring capabilities will strengthen further. Full operationalisation, including integration with digital payment systems will minimise cash-handling risks, improve governance and ensure timely, equitable supply based on real-time consumption data. Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any supplementary?

Mr Addy: Mr Speaker, no other supplementary question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Second Deputy Minority Whip?

Mr Shaib: Thank you very much. Mr Speaker, respectfully, I want to find out from the Hon Minister of Fisheries and Aquaculture when was the last time they updated the Canoe Identification Cards (CIC)?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mrs Arthur: Mr Speaker, as the automation project is being rolled out, we are forced to have this done on a site-by-site basis because what we realised

was that there were individuals— So to explain, the canoe identification system allows a fisherman to be registered on the card with the number of canoes that they have, and that allows them to get premix from the automation outlet. What we are realising is that there are some individuals who do not own canoes, who do not know how to paddle on the sea, yet they got the cards. Therefore, they were getting premix, hoarding and selling at a higher price and diverting. We are actually in the process now validating the CIC on site-by-site basis as soon as an outlet is ready. Thank you.

Mr Shaib: Thank you very much, Mr. Speaker.

I further want to find out from the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture if they have arrested any culprits with reference to hoarding or diversions, and what the Ministry has done about these culprits.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You want to find out whether somebody has been arrested? If they have arrested somebody who is hoarding?

Very well, Hon Minister?

Mrs Arthur: Mr Speaker, yes, there has been an arrest of two individuals who were involved in hoarding and selling at a higher price. The matter is before the court now. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, the Question numbered 363, standing in the name—

Yes?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, that is the Question that has been withdrawn.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I was given the opportunity, in view of the fact that the questions are similar, to ask him whether he has a supplementary question. The indication was that he will withdraw it when we get there. So, now that we are there, I need to formally give him the opportunity to have the Question withdrawn.

Hon Member with the permission from Mr Amoako-Gyampah. Yes?

Mr Addy: Mr Speaker, I come under Order 90(2). May I seek your leave to withdraw the Question?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Leave accordingly granted. The Question is hereby withdrawn has been similar to an earlier Question.

Hon Members, Question time has ended. I will use the opportunity to thank

the Minister for attending upon the House and answering Questions. Minister, you are discharged.

Hon Members, by the power vested in me by Standing Order 56(2), and in view of the fact that we have sat in excess of five hours, I will then proceed to have the House adjourned.

Hon Members the House is accordingly adjourned till Wednesday 19th November 2025 at — Leader, at?

Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, adjourned to midday.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 6:03 p.m. till Wednesday, 19th November, 2025 at 12 noon.

